IELTS ACADEMIC READING

Volume 1

10 complete Academic Reading tests — three full passages and 40 questions each — with a complete answer key and passage evidence for every answer

IB

10
FULL TESTS

400
QUESTIONS

Full
ANSWER KEY

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Created by Teacher: Ibodullaev Bekhruz

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Introduction

Welcome to **IELTS Academic Reading — Volume 1**, a printable practice book of 10 complete Reading tests, compiled and prepared by Teacher Ibodullaev Bekhruz.

Every test follows the real exam format: three passages of increasing difficulty and 40 questions covering the full range of IELTS question types — True/False/Not Given, Matching Headings, Matching Information, Multiple Choice, Summary and Sentence Completion, and more. Answer circles and blank lines are left for you to write your answers, just like on test day.

Part One contains all 10 tests with questions only, so you can practise without seeing any answers. **Part Two** contains the complete Answer Key for each test, with the keywords from each question and the exact sentence in the passage that proves the correct answer.

How to use this book:

- Sit each test in one go, under timed conditions — 60 minutes for all three passages.
- Write your answers directly in the circles and blanks provided.
- Check your answers in Part Two and read the passage evidence for every question you got wrong.
- Use the band-score table on the answer key pages to estimate your result, then revisit weak question types.

Good luck with your preparation, and follow **@bekhruzposts** for more free IELTS materials.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 1

Volume 1 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

The development of the silk industry

Silk, a natural fibre produced by a particular worm called a silkworm, has been used in clothing for many centuries.

When silk was first discovered in China over 4,500 years ago, it was reserved exclusively for the use of the emperor, his close relations and the very highest of his dignitaries. Within the palace, the emperor is believed to have worn a robe of white silk; outside, he, his principal wife, and the heir to the throne wore yellow, the colour of the earth.

Gradually silk came into more general use, and the various classes of Chinese society began wearing tunics of silk. As well as being used for clothing and decoration, silk was quite quickly put to industrial use, and rapidly became one of the principal elements of the Chinese economy. It was used in the production of musical instruments, as string for fishing, and even as the world's first luxury paper. Eventually even the common people were able to wear garments of silk.

During the Han dynasty (206 BC–220 AD), silk ceased to be a mere fabric and became a form of currency. Farmers paid their taxes in grain and silk, and silk was used to pay civil servants and to reward subjects for outstanding services. Values were calculated in lengths of silk as they had previously been calculated in weight of gold. Before long, silk became a currency used in trade with foreign countries, which continued into the Tang dynasty (616–907 AD). It is possible that this added importance was the result of a major increase in production. Silk also found its way so thoroughly into the Chinese language that 230 of the 5,000 most common characters of Mandarin have 'silk' as their key component. Silk became a precious commodity, highly sought after by other countries from an early date, and it is believed that the silk trade actually existed before the Silk Road was officially opened in the second century BC.

An Egyptian mummy with a silk thread in her hair, dating from 1070 BC, has been discovered in the village of Deir el Medina near the Valley of the Kings, and is probably the earliest evidence of the silk trade. During the second century BC, the Chinese emperor Han Wu Di's ambassadors travelled as far west as Persia and Mesopotamia, bearing gifts including silks. A range of important finds of Chinese silks have also been made along the Silk Road. One of the most dramatic of these finds was some Tang silk discovered in 1900. It is believed that around 1015 AD Buddhist monks, possibly alarmed by the threat of

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invasion by Tibetan people, had sealed more than ten thousand manuscripts and silk paintings, silk banners and textiles in caves near Dunhuang, a trading station on the Silk Road in north-west China.

Some historians believe the first Europeans to set eyes upon the fabulous fabric were the Roman legions of Marcus Licinius Crassus, Governor of Syria. According to certain accounts of the period, at an important battle near the Euphrates River in 53 BC, the Roman soldiers were so startled by the bright silken banners of the enemy that they fled in panic. Yet, within decades Chinese silks were widely worn by the rich and noble families of Rome. The Roman Emperor Heliogabalus (218–222 AD) wore nothing but silk. By 380 AD, the Roman historian Marcellinnus Ammianus reported that the use of silk, which was once confined to the nobility, has now spread to all classes without distinction – even to the lowest. The desire for silk continued to increase over the centuries. Despite this demand, the price of silk remained very high.

In spite of their secrecy about production methods, the Chinese eventually lost their monopoly on silk production. Knowledge of silk production methods reached Korea around 200 BC, when waves of Chinese immigrants arrived there. Shortly after 300 AD, it travelled westward, and the cultivation of the silkworm was established in India.

Around 550 AD silk production reached the Middle East. Records indicate that two monks from Constantinople (modern-day Istanbul), capital of the Byzantine Empire, appeared at their emperor's court with silkworm eggs which they had obtained secretly, and hidden in their hollow bamboo walking sticks. Under their supervision the eggs hatched into worms, and the worms spun silk threads. Byzantium was in the silk business at last. The Byzantine church and state created imperial workshops, monopolising production and keeping the secret to themselves. This allowed a silk industry to be established, undercutting the market for ordinary-grade Chinese silk. However, high quality silk textiles, woven in China especially for the Middle Eastern market, continued to achieve high prices in the West, and trade along the Silk Road continued as before. By the sixth century the Persians, too, had mastered the art of silk weaving, developing their own rich patterns and techniques. But it wasn't until the 13th century that Italy began silk production, with the introduction of 2,000 skilled silk weavers from Constantinople. Eventually, silk production became widespread throughout Europe.

World silk production has approximately doubled during the last 30 years in spite of man-made fibres replacing certain uses of silk. Before this period, China and Japan were the two main producers, together manufacturing more than 50 per cent of world production each year. After the late 1970s, however, China dramatically increased its silk production, and once again became the world's leading producer.

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Questions 1–7

Complete the notes below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Chinese Silk

EARLY USES — CLOTHING

- at first, silk only available to Chinese of high rank
- emperor wore (1) _____ silk indoors

IN INDUSTRY

- silk items included parts of musical instruments, fishing strings and (2) _____

CURRENCY

- silk was used as payment of (3) _____ as well as for wages and rewards
- silk replaced (4) _____ as a unit of value
- silk soon used as payment in (5) _____ trade

EVIDENCE OF SILK TRADE

- **1070 BC, Egypt:** hair of a (6) _____ contained silk
- **2nd century BC, Persia & Mesopotamia:** gifts of silk were presented by Chinese ambassadors
- **1015 AD, north-west China:** silk objects were hidden inside (7) _____

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Questions 8–13

Do the following statements agree with the information in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

8 Their first sight of silk created fear among Roman soldiers.

9 The quality of Chinese silk imported by the early Romans varied widely.

10 The Byzantine emperor first acquired silkworm eggs from the Chinese emperor.

11 The price of high-grade Chinese silk fell due to competition from Middle-Eastern producers.

12 Silk was produced in the Middle East several centuries before it was produced in Europe.

13 Global silk production has declined in recent years.

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Reading Passage 2

The discovery of a baby mammoth

A near-perfect frozen mammoth offers clues to a great vanished species

A On a May morning in 2007, on the Yamal Peninsula in northwestern Siberia, a Nenets reindeer herder named Yuri Khudi stood on a sandbar on the Yuribey River, looking carefully at a diminutive corpse. Although he'd never seen such an animal before, Khudi had seen many mammoth tusks, the thick corkscrew shafts that his people found each summer, and this persuaded him the corpse was a baby mammoth. It was eerily well preserved. Apart from its missing hair and toenails, it was perfectly intact. Khudi realised the find might be significant and he knew he couldn't just return home and forget all about it. He therefore decided to travel to the small town of Yar Sale to consult an old friend named Kirill Serotetto. His friend took him to meet the director of the local museum, who persuaded the local authorities to fly Khudi and Serotetto back to the Yuribey River to collect the baby mammoth.

B Mammoths became extinct between 14,000 and 10,000 years ago and since the extinctions coincided with the end of the most recent Ice age, many researchers believe that the primary cause of the great die-off was the sharp rise in temperature, which dramatically altered the vegetation. 'We have strong evidence that the temperature rise played a significant part in their extinction,' says Adrian Lister, a palaeontologist and mammoth expert at London's Natural History Museum. 'In Eurasia, the timing of the two events matches closely.' The extinctions also coincided, however, with the arrival of modern humans. In addition to exploiting mammoths for food, they used their bones and tusks to make weapons, tools, and even dwellings. Some scientists believe humans were as much to blame as the temperature rise for the great die-off. Some say they caused it.

C The body of the baby mammoth was eventually sent to the St Petersburg Zoological Museum in Russia. Alexei Tikhonov, the museum's director, was one of the first scientists to view the baby, a female. According to Tikhonov, Khudi had rescued 'the best preserved mammoth to come down to us from the Ice Age', and he gratefully named her Lyuba, after Khudi's wife. Tikhonov knew that no-one would be more excited by the find than Dan Fisher, an American colleague at the University of Michigan who had spent 30 years researching the lives of mammoths. Tikhonov invited Fisher, along with Bernard Buigues, a French mammoth hunter, to come and view the baby mammoth. Fisher and Buigues had examined other specimens together, including infants, but these had been in a relatively poor state. Lyuba was another story entirely. Other than the missing hair and toenails, the only flaw in her pristine appearance was a curious dent above the trunk.

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D Fisher was particularly excited about one specific part of Lyuba's anatomy: her milk tusks. Through his career, Fisher has taken hundreds of tusk samples. Most of these came from the Great Lakes region of North America, and his research showed that these animals continued to thrive, despite the late Pleistocene temperature change. On the other hand, to Fisher the tusks often revealed telltale evidence of human hunting. His samples frequently came from animals that had died in the autumn, when they should have been at their peak after summer grazing, and less likely to die of natural causes, but also when humans would have been most eager to stockpile meat for the coming winter. He has done limited work in Siberia, but his analysis of tusks from Wrangel Island, off the coast of Siberia, suggests the same conclusion.

E In December 2007, Buigues arranged for the specimen to be transported to Japan to undergo a CT scan by Naoki Suzuki of the Jikei University School of Medicine. The test confirmed her skeleton was undamaged, and her internal organs seemed largely intact. It also showed that the end of her trunk, and her throat, mouth, and windpipe were filled with dense sediment. Six months later, in a laboratory in St Petersburg, Fisher, Buigues, Suzuki, Tikhonov and other colleagues began a three-day series of tests on Lyuba. During these, Fisher noted a dense mix of clay and sand in her trunk, mouth and throat, which had been indicated earlier by the scan. In fact, the sediment in Lyuba's trunk was packed so tightly that Fisher saw it as a possible explanation for the dent above her trunk. If she was frantically fighting for breath and inhaled convulsively, perhaps a partial vacuum was created in the base of her trunk, which would have flattened surrounding soft tissue. To Fisher, the circumstances of Lyuba's death were clear: she had asphyxiated. Suzuki, however, proposed a different interpretation, seeing more evidence for drowning than asphyxiation.

F Studies are ongoing, but Lyuba has begun to shed the secrets of her short life and some clues to the fate of her kind. Her good general health was shown in the record of her dental development, a confirmation for Fisher that dental research is useful for evaluating health and thus key to investigating the causes of mammoth extinction. Analysis of her well-preserved DNA has revealed that she belonged to a distinct population of Mammuthus primigenius and that, soon after her time, another population migrating to Siberia from North America would take their place. Finally, Lyuba's premolars and tusks revealed that she had been born in late spring and was only a month old when she died.

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Questions 14–18

Reading Passage 2 has six paragraphs, **A–F**. *Which paragraph contains the following information?*

Q	Statement	Answer
14	Similarities between studies of mammoth remains from different parts of the world.	
15	Details of the uses to which mammoth body parts were put.	
16	A theory that accounts for the damage to Lyuba's face.	
17	An explanation of how an individual was able to identify a small corpse.	
18	A comparison between Lyuba and other young mammoth corpses.	

Questions 19–23

Match each statement with the correct person, **A–G**. **NB** *You may use any letter more than once.*

LIST OF PEOPLE

A Yuri Khudi
B Kirill Serotetto
C Adrian Lister
D Alexei Tikhonov
E Dan Fisher
F Bernard Buigues
G Naoki Suzuki

Q	Statement	Answer
19	The indications are that mammoths died as a result of climate change.	
20	Teeth analysis is important in discovering why mammoths died out.	
21	The corpse of the baby mammoth is in better condition than any other that has been discovered.	
22	It would be a mistake to ignore the baby mammoth's discovery, because of its potential importance.	
23	Mammoths often died at a time of year when they should have been in good physical condition.	

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Questions 24–26

Complete the sentences. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage.*

Some researchers say that a marked rise in temperature impacted on mammoths by changing the type of (24) _____ available.

Fisher concluded that many of the mammoth tusks he looked at displayed signs of (25) _____.

Not long after Lyuba's death, the *Mammuthus primigenius* group she belonged to was replaced by another group that came from (26) _____.

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Reading Passage 3

What makes a musical expert?

How does someone become expert in music? And IS it really possible to have a 'talent' for music?

Does that class of people acknowledged to be musical experts just have more of the same basic skills we are all endowed with, or do they have a set of abilities – or neural structures – that are totally different from those of the rest of us? Are high levels of musical achievement simply the result of training and practice, or are they based on innate brain structure – what we refer to as 'talent'? Talent can be defined as something that originates in genetic structures and that is identifiable by trained people who can recognize its existence before a person has achieved exceptional levels of performance. The emphasis on early identification means that to investigate it, we study the development of skills in children.

It is evident that some children acquire skills more rapidly than others: the age of onset for walking and talking varies widely, even between children in the same household. There may be genetic factors at work, but these are closely linked with other factors – with a presumably environmental component – such as motivation and family dynamics. Similar factors can influence musical development and can mask the contribution of genetics to musical ability.

Brain studies, so far, haven't been of much use in sorting out the issues. Gottfried Schlaug at Harvard collected brain scans of individuals with absolute pitch (AP) and showed that a region in the brain called the planum temporale is larger in these people than in others. This suggests that the planum is involved in AP, but it's not clear if it starts out larger in people who eventually acquire AP, or if the acquisition of AP makes the planum increase in size.

Results of research into the areas of the brain involved in skilled motor movement are more conclusive. Studies of violin players have shown that the region of the brain responsible for controlling the movement of the left hand (the hand that requires greater precision in violin playing) increases in size as a result of practice. We do not know yet if the propensity for increase pre-exists in some people and not others.

The evidence against talent comes from research on how much training the experts do. Like experts in mathematics, chess, or sports, experts in music require lengthy periods of instruction and practice. In several studies, the very best music students were found to have practiced more than twice as much as the others. In another study, students were secretly divided into two groups based on teachers' perceptions of their talent. Several

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years later, it was found that the students who achieved the highest performance ratings had practiced the most, irrespective of which 'talent' group they had been assigned to, suggesting that practice does not merely correlate with achievement, but causes it.

Anders Ericsson, at Florida State University, approaches the topic of musical expertise as a general problem in cognitive psychology. He takes as a starting point the assumption that there are certain issues involved in becoming an expert at *anything*; that we can learn about musical expertise by studying expert chess players, athletes, artists, mathematicians, as well as the musicians themselves. The emerging picture from such studies is that ten thousand hours of practice is required to achieve the level of mastery associated with being a world-class expert – in anything. In study after study, of composers, ice skaters, concert pianists, chess players and master criminals, this number comes up again and again. Someone would do this amount of practice if they practiced, for example, roughly 20 hours a week for ten years. Of course, this does not address why some people do not seem to get anywhere when they practice, and why some people get more out of their practice sessions than others. But no-one has yet found a case in which true world-class expertise was accomplished in less time. It seems that it takes the brain this long to assimilate all that it needs to know to achieve true mastery.

The ten-thousand-hour theory is consistent with what we know about how the brain learns. Learning requires the assimilation and consolidation of information in neural tissue. The more experiences we have with something, the stronger the memory/learning trace for that experience becomes. Although people differ in how long it takes them to consolidate information neutrally, it remains true that increased practice leads to a greater number of neural traces, which create stronger memory representation.

The classic rebuttal to this theory goes something like this: 'What about Mozart? I hear that he composed his first symphony at the age of four!' First, there is a factual error here: Mozart did not write it until he was eight. Still, this is unusual, to say the least. However, this early work received little acclaim and was not performed very often. In fact, the only reason we know about it is because the child who wrote it grew up to become Mozart. And Mozart had an expert teacher in his father, who was renowned as a teacher of musicians all over Europe. We do not know how much Mozart practiced, but if he started at age two and worked thirty-two hours a week (quite possible, given that his father was a stern taskmaster) he would have made his ten thousand hours by the time he composed his first symphony. This does not mean that there are no genetic factors involved in Mozart's greatness, but that inborn traits may not be the only cause.

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Questions 27–30

Choose the correct letter, **A, B, C** *or* **D**.

27 In the first paragraph, the writer suggests that a musician who IS talented is someone

A who is aware of being set apart from other people.
B whose brain structure is unlike that of other people.
C who can perform extremely well in early childhood.
D whose essential skills are more varied than those of ordinary people.

28 According to the writer, what is unclear about the findings of Gottfried Schlaug?

A which part of the brain is linked to a particular musical skill.
B which type of musical skill leads to the greatest change in the brain.
C whether a feature of the brain is a cause or an effect of a musical skill.
D whether the acquisition of a musical skill is easier for some people than others.

29 According to the writer, what has been established by studies of violin players?

A Changes may occur in the brain following violin practice.
B Left-handed violinists have a different brain structure from other people.
C A violinist's hand size is not due to practice but to genetic factors.
D Violinists are born with brains that have a particular structure.

30 According to the writer, findings on the amount of practice done by expert musicians suggest that

A talent may have little to do with expertise.
B practice may actually prevent the development of talent.
C talent may not be recognised by teachers.
D expertise may be related to quality of instruction.

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Questions 31–36

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

YES *if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this*

31 Anders Ericsson's work with cognitive psychology has influenced other researchers.

32 Different areas of expertise seem to have one specific thing in common.

33 In order to be useful, practice must be carried out regularly every day.

34 Anyone who practices for long enough can reach the level of a world-class expert.

35 Occasionally, someone can become an expert at global level with fewer than 10,000 hours' practice.

36 Existing knowledge of learning and cognitive skills supports the importance of practice.

Questions 37–40

Complete the summary using the list of words, **A–J**, *below.*

Mozart

A popular **B** artistic **C** completed **D** eight **E** tuition **F** encouragement
G inherited **H** four **I** practice **J** two

The case of Mozart could be quoted as evidence against the 10,000-hour-practice theory. However, the writer points out that the young Mozart received a lot of 37 _____ from his father, and that the symphony he wrote at the age of 38 _____ was not 39 _____ and may be of only academic interest. The case therefore supports the view that expertise is not solely the result of 40 _____ characteristics.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 2

Volume 1 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

The Clipper Races: an era of competition between cargo ships

During the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries, the British East India Company had the monopoly on trade with China and India. This meant that because no rival could legally import tea or other goods from these countries at this time, the company was rarely in a hurry to transport its merchandise. Instead, its priority was to minimise costs by carrying as much as possible on each ship. This meant that its ships – known as East Indiamen – were enormous, strong and very slow.

By 1800, the average East Indiaman could carry 1,200 tons of merchandise. The trading pattern for China tea usually meant the East Indiamen set sail from Britain in January, sailed round the Cape of Good Hope at the southernmost tip of Africa, and arrived in China in September. There they would load up that year's tea harvest, set off again and, depending on the wind and weather, aim to arrive back by the following September. So even with favourable sailing conditions, the round trip lasted almost two years, and if anything went wrong it could take a lot longer.

However, by 1834 the company had lost its trading monopolies, and tea had become a freely traded item. Having no more use for its great ships, the company sold them off, and many were bought by merchants or their captains, who continued to plough the seas between Britain and China. But now that tea could be traded freely, a few smart sailors began to realise that whoever brought each new harvest of tea to Britain first, stood to make the most money.

This was partly because if you were home first, you could sell your shipment of tea before your competitors even arrived, and partly because consumers in Britain in the nineteenth century believed that the fresher and earlier-picked the tea, the better the resulting drink. Tea traders now needed faster, sleeker ships to bring their precious cargo back. Nevertheless, in Britain this idea only caught on slowly, and while the 1840s saw a few faster ships launched, for the time being many merchants remained satisfied with the slow but reliable East Indiamen.

In fact it was the Americans who pioneered the first clipper ships. These vessels were fast and slender, with a narrow hull that was deeper at the back than at the front and masses of sails on tall masts. They earned their name from the way that they clipped off journey times. British merchants resolved to build their own clippers to rival the Americans and

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the first British tea clipper, *Stornaway*, was built in Aberdeen in 1850. More tea clippers were designed and built in Britain throughout the 1850s and 1860s; they had a narrower beam than their American equivalents, making them less powerful during storms, but faster in calmer weather.

There was a great spirit of competition between the British and American ships plying the tea trade, but to begin with the Americans had the edge. Then in 1851 a British ship owner, Richard Green, built the aptly named clipper *Challenger*, with the stated intention of beating the American ships. Loaded with tea, *Challenger* left China for London in 1852 at the same time as the American clipper *Challenge*, a much larger, older ship, already greatly admired for its speed. Large sums were bet on which would complete the journey first. In the event, the British ship beat its rival to London by two days, amid much jubilation. From then on, such international races grew in popularity.

After 1855, American participation in the British tea trade gradually stopped. But even without the Anglo-American rivalry, the competitive spirit continued. It was really ignited when new ports were opened up for trade in China. These included Fouchow, which was much closer to the tea-producing areas than Canton, the port used previously. As a result, tea could be loaded onboard earlier and fresher, and the clippers could set off in late May or early June – sometimes not even taking time to fill out the official paperwork – racing back to Britain whatever the difficulties.

They sped down through the South China Sea and into the Indian Ocean, then raced to get round the southernmost tip of Africa at the Cape of Good Hope. Then it was north across the vast Atlantic, past the Azores, through the English Channel and into the estuary of the River Thames. Once there, they would be towed by tugs, up the river and into the docks.

The cargo of the winning ship could earn a premium of up to sixpence per pound – and so the captain and crew were rewarded by the owners of the cargo. But the races were about more than just money. The crews, about 40 men on each clipper, were expert sailors, proud of their ships, and they delighted in competing against each other. Without their enthusiasm, the races would never have happened, since getting the ship home as fast as possible required the crew to be totally dedicated and to sacrifice much of their rest for the duration of the race.

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Questions 1–6

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

1 In the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries, the British East India Company faced a lot of competition.

2 Before 1800, cargo size was the most important consideration for the East India Company.

3 At best, voyages of the East Indiamen to China and back took nearly two years to complete.

4 Before 1834, voyages to and from China were considered to be highly dangerous.

5 After 1834, the ships which had served the East India Company stopped being used for commercial purposes.

6 In the nineteenth century, British drinkers preferred tea made from mature leaves to that made from younger leaves.

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Questions 7–13

Complete the notes below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Clipper races

THE SHIPS

- Clipper ships were first used for trading by American merchants.
- The ships were remarkable for the number of (7) _____ they had.
- The performance of British tea clippers was particularly affected when there were (8) _____ at sea.

THE RACES

- It was in a ship called (9) _____ that the British first competed successfully against the Americans.
- Richard Green's ship arrived two days ahead of its competitor.
- Competition increased when additional Chinese trading (10) _____ were established.
- Merchants were occasionally in such a hurry that they failed to complete the (11) _____ before leaving China.
- At the end of their journey, the ships needed the help of (12) _____.

THE REWARDS

- The crews were motivated by both (13) _____ and their enthusiasm for the competition.

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Reading Passage 2

Orientation of birds

A For many of us, the way birds are able to orientate is both astounding and difficult to appreciate fully. For instance, the annual migration of the golden plover of the Pacific takes it from Alaska to Hawaii on a flight of well over 3000 kilometres, and if it were to deviate by only one degree, it would miss the island on which it nests.

B The first systematic studies on orientation in birds were made possible by the 'homing instinct' exhibited by so many species. Birds are caught at a time when they show an attachment to their territory, especially during the nesting season. They are taken to some spot, released, and the percentage of returns is recorded. The distance can be varied, and the direction, as well as the method of transporting them, and then the influence of climatic and other factors on their ability to find their way home can be studied. These experiments have shown a wide variation in ability to home, and three types of homing behaviour have been identified.

C In the first type, birds methodically explore the area in which they are released until they pick up some familiar feature, and then they quickly find their way back to the nest. Such birds possess a highly developed visual memory, as experiments with pigeons have shown. Domestic pigeons have been trained to peck at a certain point on an aerial photograph, with a system of rewards, and four years later the birds were still able to respond to this training when placed on the aerial photograph. Birds' eyes have a power of resolution two to three times greater than ours, enabling them to pick up very fine details. If a bird uses only this type of homing behaviour, however, it can only succeed if the point of release is not too far away. If the birds are transported 800 kilometres from their nest, it is only by good fortune that they find their way back as a result of long exploratory flights. Usually, the area known to a bird is its feeding territory. Released within this area, the birds soon make their return; release them outside it and far fewer return. However, if a bird is released for a second time in the same place, its visual memory comes into play, and the bird, no longer requiring tedious exploratory flights, will return much more quickly.

D The second type of homing behaviour is shown by birds that are capable of choosing their flight direction and holding to it for the rest of their journey. How do they decide what direction to take? They appear to choose their normal migration direction even if they are released in a different place from their usual starting point. If, for example, birds which normally fly to the north-east to reach latitude 45 degrees north are released at that latitude, they will immediately start flying north-east anyway. So if they're released further to the west, they'll maintain the correct direction, but fly west of their destination, and so fail to arrive.

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E The third type of homing behaviour shows the highest degree of orientation. Released at one point, the birds immediately take stock of it, compare its position with that of the nest, decide on the direction and fly off. This happens even if the birds are in a country right off their migration routes, where they have never been before. In one example, a laysan albatross returned to its nesting area on Midway Island in the middle of the Pacific, having flown over 5000 kilometres from the west coast of the USA in just over ten days. This is a perfect example of the third type of homing, for the albatross clearly couldn't rely on any landmarks over the vast expanse of the Pacific Ocean.

F The percentage of successful birds varies greatly, being highest in those species with a strong migratory behaviour. Thus the lesser black-backed gull is more migratory than the herring gull and more often reaches 'home'. Great migrants such as the swift have the highest percentage of returns. In one case, seven out of nine alpine swifts were recaptured at their nests after being displaced some 1400 kilometres; one made the journey in three days.

G What part does heredity play in all this? Two research studies suggest that instinctive, i.e. genetically inherited, behaviour patterns play a part in navigation. The first was carried out by Ernst Schuz and it is highly significant. Schuz caught first year European storks and released them later, after the departure of the adult storks at a time when they normally make their south-west autumn migration to Africa. The recaptures showed that, in spite of the fact that there were no adults to guide them, the birds unanimously headed south-west. This was a most striking finding, for it showed that the birds had an innate and unlearned attraction for the African wintering area that they have occupied for thousands of years.

H The case of starlings is a little different. These birds have a great aptitude for homing, but this behaviour differs in the different age groups. Birds that were shifted to the south-east of their normal migration route split into two lots. The adults, in full possession of their gift for orientation, found their wintering area by modifying their direction by 90 degrees, whereas the juveniles sought their winter quarters to the south-east of their real position.

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Questions 14–18

Complete the summary below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

Types of homing behaviour

FIRST TYPE

Birds rely on their sophisticated (14) _____. However, they are generally most successful if they are released within their feeding territory.

SECOND TYPE

Birds select their accustomed (15) _____, no matter where they are released. As a result, they may miss their (16) _____.

THIRD TYPE

Birds orientate correctly, even when they are released in an unfamiliar place and have no (17) _____ to make use of. One bird with this type of skill is the (18) _____.

Questions 19–22

Reading Passage 2 has eight paragraphs, **A–H**. *Which paragraph contains the following information?*

Q	Statement	Answer
19	The effects of distance on some birds' ability to find their nests.	
20	A methodology for testing the general ability of birds to find their nests.	
21	One aspect of physical ability in humans and birds.	
22	How some birds' migration was delayed for experimental purposes.	

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Questions 23–26

Match each bird with the point which it illustrates, **A–G**.

LIST OF POINTS WHICH THE AUTHOR WISHES TO ILLUSTRATE

A an ability to orientate without previous training
B the speed at which birds can fly
C the ability to remember things seen previously
D the effect of age on homing ability
E the strength required to fly a great distance
F a high success rate in finding nests
G the importance of seasonal cues for migrating birds

Q	Statement	Answer
23	domestic pigeon	
24	alpine swift	
25	European stork	
26	starling	

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Reading Passage 3

The role of accidents in business

In 1894 Dr John Kellogg and his brother Will were supervising a hospital and health spa in Michigan. The patients were on a restricted diet. One day, the brothers left cooked wheat untended for more than 24 hours. When they returned, they saw what they had done. It was no good to eat, but they decided to run the stale wheat through rollers, just to see how it would turn out. Normally, the process produced long sheets, but they were surprised to discover that this time the rollers created flat flakes. They baked them, and then tried the same thing with corn. From this accidental discovery came the cornflakes that generations have now been eating for breakfast.

Accidents happen; there is nothing predictable and orderly about innovation. Nobel laureate Sir Alan Hodgkin, who discovered how nerve cells transmit electrical impulses between the skin and the brain, commented: 'I believe that the record of my published papers conveys an impression of directedness and planning which does not at all coincide with the actual sequence of events.'

The same rule applies in business. The mistake that gave us cornflakes keeps repeating itself in the history of disruptive innovation, the kind that transforms markets. Louis Daguerre, for instance, discovered the technique that gave us photography in the 1830s, when drops of mercury from a shattered thermometer produced a photographic image. The microwave was discovered when Percy Spencer, a scientist with Raytheon, was testing a new vacuum tube and discovered that the sweet in his pocket had melted. The artificial sweetener, saccharin, was the unintentional result of a medical scientist's work on a chemical treatment for gastric ulcers. While working for the firm 3M, researcher Art Fry had no idea he was taking the first steps towards Post-It Notes when he used bits of adhesive office paper that could be easily lifted off the page to replace the scrap paper bookmarks that kept falling out of his hymn book.

Breakthrough and disruptive innovation are rarely driven by orderly process. Usually they come out of a chaotic, haphazard mess, which is why big companies, full of managers schooled in business programmes designed to eliminate random variation and mistakes, struggle with them. In these sorts of environments, accidents are called failures and are discouraged.

It is no surprise then that research from the late British economist Paul Geroski and London Business School's Constantinos Markides found that companies that were skilled at innovation were usually not that skilled when it came to commercialisation, and vice versa. Their book, *Fast Second*, divides businesses into 'colonists' and 'consolidators'. Small and nimble, colonists are adept at creating market niches but are terrible institution

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builders. Consolidators, with their strong cultures of discipline and cost control, know how to take clever ideas from other firms and turn them into mass-market items. Microsoft is a prime instance of this.

With companies spending hundreds of billions of dollars on research and development, US academics Robert Austin and Lee Devin examined how managers can encourage productive slip-ups. In their article *Accident, Intention and Expectation in the Innovation Process*, they argue that business processes actually prevent helpful mis-steps from occurring. According to their catalogue of accidents, not all false steps and mishaps are equal. Accidents, they say, come from unlikely mental associations such as memories and vague connections, looking for something and finding it in an unexpected way, looking for one thing and finding something else, and not looking for anything but finding something valuable.

Accident-prone innovation, they say, requires companies to get outside the 'cone of expectation'. It means throwing together groups from diverse backgrounds, and combining ideas in unpredictable ways. Other strategies also include having systems that watch out for accidents and examine them for value, generating them when they do not happen often enough, seizing the useful ones, capturing their valuable features, and building on them to add value and give potential for useful accidents.

All this, however, requires thinking that is often counter-intuitive to the way businesses operate. In other words, it is the kind of thinking that goes against the beliefs of most business managers. It runs counter to the notion frequently pushed by consultants that you can 'harness' creativity and direct it to line up with intention. 'The cost of accidents in business, people tend to call such efforts failure.'

There are tentative signs that more companies are starting to realise that failure can lead to commercial gain, and that this is part of the risk-taking that underpins innovation. Australia's largest brewing company, for example, made a bad error when it launched a new beer called Empire Lager, pitched at younger consumers. Having spent a fortune creating a beer with a sweeter taste, designing a great-looking bottle and a television campaign, Foster's was left with a drink that no-one wanted to buy. The target market was more interested in brands built up by word of mouth.

Instead of wiping the unsuccessful product launch, Fosters used this lesson learned to go on and develop other brands instead. One of them, Pure Blonde, is now ranked as Australia's fifth-largest beer brand. Unlike Empire Lager, there has been almost no promotion and its sales are generated more by word of mouth.

Other companies are taking similar steps to study their own slip-ups. Intuit, the company behind financial tools such as Quicken, holds regular 'When Learning Hurts' sessions. But this sort of transformation is never easy. In a market that focuses on the short-term,

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convincing employees and shareholders to tolerate failure and not play it safe is a big thing to ask.

Questions 27–31

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

YES *if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this*

27 The delay in the process used by the Kellogg brothers affected the final product.

28 Sir Alan Hodgkin is an example of someone whose work proceeded in a logical and systematic way.

29 Daguerre is an exception to the general rule of innovation.

30 The discovery of saccharin occurred by accident during drug research.

31 The company 3M should have supported Art Fry by funding his idea of Post-It Notes.

Questions 32–35

Complete each sentence with the correct ending, **A–H**, *below.*

SENTENCE ENDINGS

A can be found in unusual thoughts and chance events.
B can be taught in business schools.
C has made a success from someone else's invention.
D is designed to nurture differences.
E is unlikely to lead to creative innovation.
F says that all mistakes are the same.
G shows that businesses are good at either inventing or selling.
H suggests ways of increasing the number of mistakes.

32 The usual business environment ____

33 Geroski and Markides's book ____

34 Microsoft is an example of a company which ____

35 The origin of useful accidents ____

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Questions 36–40

Choose the correct letter, **A, B, C** *or* **D**.

36 How do Austin and Devin advise companies to get out of the 'cone of expectation'?

A by decreasing the number of company systems
B by forming teams of different types of people
C by hiring new and creative people
D by holding regular brainstorming meetings

37 In recommending 'counter-intuitive' thinking, what do Austin and Devin imply?

A that failing at business is bad for staff morale
B that innovation cannot be planned for
C that most businesses should be devoted to avoiding mistakes
D that the cost of mistakes is an important consideration

38 The writer describes the Empire Lager disaster in order to show that

A success can come out of a business failure
B the majority of companies now value risk-taking
C TV advertising works better on older people
D young beer drinkers do not like a sweet taste

39 Pure Blonde has been more successful than Empire Lager because

A digital media other than TV were used.
B it was advertised under a different brand name.
C it was launched with very little advertising.
D the advertising budget was larger.

40 The writer concludes that creating a culture that learns from mistakes

A brings short-term financial gains.
B can be very difficult for some companies.
C holds no risk for workers.
D is a popular move with shareholders.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 3

Volume 1 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

An important language development

Cuneiform, the world's first known system of handwriting, originated some 6,000 years ago in Sumer in what is now southern Iraq. It was most often inscribed on palm-sized, rectangular clay tablets measuring several centimetres across, although occasionally, larger tablets or cylinders were used. Clay was an excellent medium for writing. Other surfaces which have been employed – for example, parchment, papyrus and paper – are not long-lasting and are easily destroyed by fire and water. But clay has proved to be resistant to those particular kinds of damage.

The word 'cuneiform' actually refers to the marks or signs inscribed in the clay. The original cuneiform signs consisted of a series of lines – triangular, vertical, diagonal and horizontal. Sumerian writers would impress these lines into the wet clay with a stylus – a long, thin, pointed instrument which looked somewhat like a pen. Oddly, the signs were often almost too small to see with the naked eye. Cuneiform signs were used for the writing of at least a dozen languages. This is similar to how the Latin alphabet is used today for writing English, French, Spanish and German for example.

Before the development of cuneiform, tokens were used by the Sumerians to record certain information. For example, they might take small stones and use them as tokens or representations of something else, like a goat. A number of tokens, then, might mean a herd of goat. These tokens might then be placed in a cloth container and provided to a buyer as a receipt for a transaction, perhaps five tokens for five animals. It was not that different from what we do today when we buy some bread and the clerk gives us back a piece of paper with numbers on it to confirm the exchange.

By the 4th century BCE, the Sumerians had adapted this system to a form of writing. They began putting tokens in a container resembling an envelope, and now made of clay instead of cloth. They then stamped the outside to indicate the number and type of tokens inside. A person could then 'read' what was stamped on the container and know what was inside.

Gradually, Sumerians developed symbols for words. When first developed, each symbol looked like the concrete thing it represented. For example, an image which resembled the drawing of a sheep meant just that. Then another level of abstraction was introduced when symbols were developed for intangible ideas such as 'female' or 'hot' or 'God'. Cuneiform, in other words, evolved from a way used primarily to track and store information into a

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way to represent the world symbolically. Over the centuries, the marks became ever more abstract, finally evolving into signs that looked nothing like what they referred to, just as the letters 'h-o-u-s-e' have no visual connection to the place we live in. At this last stage in the evolution of cuneiform, the signs took the form of triangles, which became common cuneiform signs.

As the marks became more abstract, the system became more efficient because there were fewer marks a 'reader' needed to learn. But cuneiform also became more complex because society itself was becoming more complex, so there were more ideas and concepts that needed to be expressed. However, most linguists and historians agree cuneiform developed primarily as a tool for accounting. Of the cuneiform tablets that have been discovered, excavated and translated, about 75 percent contain this type of practical information, rather than artistic or imaginative work.

Cuneiform writing was used for thousands of years, but it eventually ceased to be used in everyday life. In fact, it died out and remained unintelligible for almost 2,000 years. In the late 19th century, a British army officer, Henry Rawlinson, discovered cuneiform inscriptions which had been carved in the surface of rocks in the Behistun mountains in what is present-day Iran. Rawlinson made impressions of the marks on large pieces of paper, as he balanced dangerously on the surrounding rocks.

Rawlinson took his copies home to Britain and studied them for years to determine what each line stood for, and what each group of symbols meant. He found that in the writing on those particular rocks every word was repeated three times in three languages: Old Persian, Elamite and Babylonian. Since the meanings in these languages were already known to linguists, he could thus translate the cuneiform. Eventually, he fully decoded the cuneiform marks and he discovered that they described the life of Darius, a king of the Persian Empire in the 5th century BCE.

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Questions 1–5

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

1. Cuneiform tablets were produced in different shapes and sizes.
2. When Sumerian writers marked on the clay tablets, the tablets were dry.
3. Cuneiform was often difficult to read because of its size.
4. A number of languages adopted cuneiform.
5. Cuneiform signs can be found in some modern alphabets.

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Questions 6–13

Complete the notes below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

The development and translation of cuneiform

BEFORE CUNEIFORM

- tokens, for example, (6) _____ were often used
- the first tokens were kept in containers made of (7) _____
- tokens were used as a (8) _____ to give when selling something

BY 4TH CENTURY BCE

- tokens were put in a container that looked like a clay (9) _____

COMPLEX, ABSTRACT SYMBOLS DEVELOPED

- at first, signs looked like what they indicated, e.g. (10) _____
- then signs became more abstract
- eventually, cuneiform signs shaped like (11) _____ were developed
- according to experts, cuneiform was mainly used for (12) _____

19TH-CENTURY TRANSLATION OF CUNEIFORM BY HENRY RAWLINSON

- Rawlinson found cuneiform inscriptions in the Behistun mountains
- Rawlinson copied inscriptions onto (13) _____
- Rawlinson realised that each word of the inscriptions appeared in different languages
- When translated, Rawlinson found the writings were about a 5th-century BCE king

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Reading Passage 2

Children's comprehension of television advertising

A In 1874, long before the advent of television, the English Parliament passed a law to protect children 'from their own lack of experience and from the wiles of pushing tradesmen and moneylenders' (James, 1965). The act is one of the earliest governmental policies to address children's vulnerability to commercial exploitation and was produced before major corporations earned huge profits by marketing products directly to children. Yet the issues underlying this 19th-century policy remain much the same in the 21st century.

B Television has long been the predominant medium that advertisers have chosen for marketing products to children. It is estimated that the average child sees more than 40,000 television commercials a year, most of which are 15 to 30 seconds in length (Kunkel, 2001). According to another estimate, children aged 14 years and under make $24 billion in direct purchases and influence $190 billion in family purchases, underscoring the high stakes involved (McNeal, 1987).

C A number of factors have contributed to an unprecedented growth in both the amount and type of advertising directed at children. First and foremost among these are changes in the media environment. In decades past, television programming targeted at children was limited and relegated to time slots unpopular with their parents, such as Saturday mornings (Turow, 1981). Today, the number of channels received in the average US home has escalated with the diffusion of cable television and satellite technologies. In this new multi-channel era, there are numerous national program services devoted exclusively to children. Naturally, these channels deliver significant amounts of child-oriented marketing messages. Although parent may be pleased that their youngsters can now watch children's programming at any hour of the day, they may not recognize that such viewing opportunities entail much greater exposure to advertising than any previous generation of youth has experienced.

D Approximately 80% of all advertising targeted at children falls within four product categories: toys, cereals, candies, and fast-food restaurants (Kunkel et al, 1992). Commercials are highly effective at employing specific features designed to attract children's attention. For example, they use the strategy of introducing unique sound effects and rapidly moving images (Greer et al, 1982). The other most common persuasive strategy employed in advertising to children is to associate the product with playfulness and happiness, rather than to provide any actual product-related information (Kunkel et al, 1992). For example, a commercial featuring Ronald McDonald dancing, singing, and smiling in McDonald's restaurants without any mention of the actual food products

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available reflects a playful or happy theme. This strategy is also found frequently with cereal ads, which often include cartoon characters to help children identify the product. In contrast, most commercials fail to mention even the major grain used in each cereal.

E Another common feature of advertising to children is the use of product disclosures such as 'batteries not included' or 'each part sold separately'. Studies make clear that young children do not comprehend the intended meaning of these disclaimers. For example, fewer than one in four kindergarten through second grade children could grasp the meaning of 'some assembly required' in a commercial. In contrast, the use of child-friendly language such as 'you have to put it together' more than doubled the proportion of children who understood the qualifying message (Liebert et al, 1977). The phrase 'part of a balanced breakfast' is also a frequent disclosure included in most cereal ads to combat the concern that sugared cereal holds little nutritional value for children. Research shows that most children below age 7 years have no idea what the term 'balanced breakfast' means (Palmer & McDowell, 1981). Rather than informing young viewers about the importance of a nutritious breakfast, this common disclaimer actually leaves many children with the misimpression that cereal alone is sufficient for a meal. This pattern of employing creative terminology in advertising content so as to obscure certain information that might be unhelpful to the sponsor is a long-standing practice that often misleads the consumer (Geis, 1982).

F Very young children do not recognize that there are two fundamentally different categories of television content: programs and commercials. Most children below the age of 4 or 6 exhibit low awareness of the concept of commercials, frequently explaining them as if they were a scene in the program itself. Once this confusion diminishes, children first recognize the difference between programs and commercials based on either affective ('commercials are funnier than TV programs') or perceptual ('commercials are short and programs are long') cues (Blatt et al, 1972).

G Although most children's programs indicate that a commercial break is coming (e.g. by saying 'We'll be right back after these messages'), research reveals that these 'separators' generally do not help children to recognize advertising content (Palmer & McDowell, 1979). This likely occurs because they are not perceptually distinct from the adjacent programming that surrounds them; in fact, many separators feature characters that appear in the same show that the commercial has just interrupted. When an ad includes one of the characters featured in a program, this is known as host-selling. This type of advertising makes the task of discriminating between program and commercial content particularly difficult for young children (Kunkel, 1988) and is thus restricted in the US by the Federal Communications Commission during children's programs.

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H In sum, because young children lack the cognitive skills and abilities of older children and adults, they do not comprehend commercial messages in the same way as more mature audiences, and are therefore uniquely susceptible to advertising influence.

Questions 14–18

Reading Passage 2 has eight paragraphs, **A–H**. *Which paragraph contains the following information?* **NB** *You may use any letter more than once.*

Q	Statement	Answer
14	A description of recent innovations in TV broadcasting.	
15	A mention of the main goods and services advertised to children.	
16	A reference to a current limitation on television advertising aimed at children.	
17	Two techniques used to encourage children to watch TV commercials.	
18	A type of advertisement that may make children believe the opposite of what is true.	

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Questions 19–22

Match each statement with the correct researcher(s), **A–H**.

LIST OF RESEARCHERS

A Kunkel
B Kunkel et al
C McNeal
D Turow
E Greer et al
F Liebert et al
G Palmer & McDowell
H Geis

Q	Statement	Answer
19	Ads often aim to teach children that a brand is fun rather than telling them about what is being sold.	
20	Originally, children's programmes were only broadcast when adults rarely watched TV.	
21	Children have a significant impact on what adults buy.	
22	Tests showed that children can follow information if simple words are used.	

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Questions 23–26

Complete the summary below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

How very young children perceive commercials

Children below the age of 4 or 6 do not understand the difference between television programmes and commercials. In fact, these children often mistake an advertisement for a (23) _____ from the programme they are watching. This is despite the fact that children's TV programmes usually include announcements called (24) _____ to show that there is going to be a commercial break. The problem is made more difficult because of a technique called (25) _____, whereby a person or cartoon figure from the programme is used to sell a product during the commercial break. From the age of 4 or 6, children begin to realise that commercials are different from TV programmes; for example, they may recognise that advertisements are (26) _____ than actual TV.

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Reading Passage 3

A New Voyage Round the World

A very old travel book that holds an unusual place in English literature

Part travelogue, part historical record of the Caribbean pirates, part scientific treatise, *A New Voyage Round the World* was William Dampier's account of his twelve-year series of journeys around the globe from 1679 to 1691. The wealth and novelty of Dampier's descriptions, combined with the highly colourful accounts of his comrades' escapades, proved so popular with a public hungry for tales of discovery and adventure that *A New Voyage* went into its third reprint within a year of publication. So ground-breaking was Dampier's account that the writers Swift and Defoe were inspired to create two of the most famous books in the English language, *Gulliver's Travels* and *Robinson Crusoe*.

Dampier's commentators have portrayed him as an unusual, not to say peculiar, man. Notwithstanding his undoubted qualities as an observer, he has been variously characterised as aloof, arrogant, hot-tempered and a weak leader of men. When he arrived on the western coast of Australia, he promptly elected to leave and head north out of dislike for the cold of more southerly latitudes. This physical sensitivity has often been seized on by his detractors, who point out that, as a result, Dampier missed out on becoming the name forever associated with the European discovery of Australia, that honour instead going to Captain James Cook some 80 years later. Yet it should be remembered that he was able to endure a never-ending plague of discomforts and ailments in the tropics. And once, wrecked off Ascension Island in the South Atlantic Ocean, he managed with his crew to survive for five weeks without help, living entirely on turtles and goats.

What of his early life, then? Dampier was born in 1651 in Somerset, England, the son of a tenant farmer, George, and his wife Ann. His birthplace, Hymerford House, stands to this day. His parents died before he reached seniority and his guardians apprenticed the young William to a ship's captain, the boy having shown very early inclinations to 'see the world'. There was nothing in his childhood to set Dampier apart from the numerous other young boys who were sent to sea at this time.

Having made brief passages to France and Newfoundland, he completed a more extended voyage to Java, where he began to learn the art of navigation. Returning briefly to Somerset, a neighbour offered Dampier a position overseeing his plantation in Jamaica, which he took up for a time, but he soon returned to sea on a trading voyage among the Caribbean islands. From the viewpoint of posterity, the most significant aspect of this time was that, as plantation manager, Dampier first started to keep a journal.

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Although Dampier wrote several books, *A New Voyage Round the World* is the most important and it is worth considering just why this text met with such success. Certainly, the book would not have done so well purely on the merits of Dampier's findings regarding meteorology and natural history, even though they broke new ground at the time. What appealed more to book buyers of this era was his narrative of life among the pirates of the Caribbean islands, whom he joined for several years after leaving Jamaica. These tales of adventure among rogues and villains who had no regard for the law sparked widespread interest among his countrymen back home. More important even than this, however, is the superb nature of Dampier's prose, and his ability to communicate so vividly that raised the book above the common lot.

Dampier himself admits in the book's preface that he received help with the writing of the book, and other evidence exists to suggest that he was assisted by an unknown source. But whatever outside assistance he may have had, the book still has certain problems. In particular, his observations about nature are sometimes roughly dropped into the narrative at very odd junctures and these asides can sometimes interrupt the flow of the story. Dampier himself kept his observations about nature entirely separate from the main body of his travels, and we should therefore hold James Knapton responsible, as he was in charge of checking and revising Dampier's text, and his publishing company brought the finished book to a wider audience.

Dampier's life has been chronicled in full by numerous biographers, and I refer the reader in particular to Clennell Wilkinson's excellent (and sadly out-of-print) 1929 biography, as well as the recent portrait by Anton Gill. In short, despite wide acclaim for his writing, Dampier was not blessed in the art of wealth accumulation. Travelling with the pirates, while providing subsistence and adventure, never netted him the treasure chest that a more astute financial operative might have acquired. He died in 1715, aged sixty-three, in Colerman Street, London.

We have then a man of myriad and colourful parts, and perhaps not always the easiest of sailors to get along with because of his arrogance and hot temper. But to dwell on these aspects today is to miss the point: it is *A New Voyage Round the World* that should provide the most illuminating and entertaining of Dampier's legacies. Above all, the text is studded with some wonderfully colourful expressions, and readers will enjoy some of the finest descriptions of storms in the English language, and the liberal wit throughout.

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Questions 27–31

Choose the correct letter, **A, B, C** *or* **D**.

27 Which of the following best summarises the writer's point in the first paragraph?

A Dampier's book does not fall into a single category.
B Readers were not interested in books on the subject of travel.
C Today's readers do not appreciate the style of Dampier's writing.
D Dampier sailed round the world more quickly than anyone before.

28 The writer refers to Swift and Defoe in order to

A provide information regarding Dampier's sources.
B compare Dampier to two earlier writers.
C give an example of Dampier's influence.
D highlight two of Dampier's critics.

29 Dampier left the western coast of Australia because

A He wanted to get to the north before Cook arrived.
B He found the temperature there unpleasant.
C He had problems with his crews.
D He requested medical attention.

30 What does the writer say more about Dampier in the second paragraph?

A He could cope with physical hardship.
B He was a more adventurous explorer than Cook was.
C He had a kinder personality than he is given credit for.
D He was calm in a crisis.

31 What information is given about Dampier's early life?

A He had a difficult relationship with the people looking after him.
B He was different from other youths who went to sea.
C He wanted to travel from a young age.
D He came from a family of sailors.

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Questions 32–35

Complete the summary using the words below.

The Text of A New Voyage Round the World

A Detailed illustrations **B** Traveller **C** Nature **D** Editor **E** Writer
F Scientific observations **G** The crew **H** Artist **I** Plain language

The success of the book cannot solely be attributed to the originality of Dampier's (32) ————————. Readers of the time were fascinated with his stories of the time he spent with outlaws and his colourful way of writing. It seems certain that Dampier worked on the book with a mystery (33) ————————. Some aspects of *A New Voyage Round the World* are problematic; descriptions of (34) ———————— were inserted into the account of Dampier's adventures in a way that distracted the reader. It seems that the responsibility for the final version of the book lies with the (35) ————————.

Questions 36–40

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

YES *if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this*

(36) Many people wrote biographies of Dampier as a result of personal contact with him.

(37) Dampier was skilled at making money.

(38) Dampier's patience was represented by the writer.

(39) A New Voyage Round the World is considered as one of the most modern books.

(40) Dampier supervised his neighbour's plantation in Jamaica.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 4

Volume 1 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Why good ideas fail

As part of a marketing course, two marketing experts comment on a hypothetical case study involving TF, a fiction retail giant specializing in home furnishing.

Hypothetical case study:

TF became a retail success in the 1970s when it succeeded in spotting homeware trends and meeting the needs of its then trendy young customers. However, by 2004, the TF stores were failing and a rethink was clearly necessary. Tibal Fisher, TF's founder and CEO, decided to change its focus under the new brand name of TF's NextStage. His aim was to recapture the now ageing customers that had given him his early success and target consumers aged 60+ with devices and gadgets specifically designed to assist them with the problems associated with ageing: mobile phones with screens that were easy to read; kitchen gadgets with comfortable grips; electronic devices that were easy to set and adjust. TF's market research proved to be very positive, showing strong consumer support for the products.

In 2007, the stores were remodelled at a cost of US $40 million and the new brand was launched. Each store was made more comfortable and featured a coffee shop to help increase traffic – Tibal had predicted that if they could get customers into the stores then the products would sell themselves. However, by 2009 it was clear that the idea was a failure and the stores consistently remained empty. Customers complained that the new stores felt like a senior center and reminded them that they were growing old.

Expert 1: Donna Sturgess, global head of innovation, GlaxoSmithKline

The TF team's customer research efforts are a classic case of missing the subconscious associations at work in consumers' minds. Tibal and his executives looked only at surface attitudes. Since those attitudes make up a relatively small part of the total consumer response, the executives are clueless about the reason for the poor sales. It's critical for companies to understand that every customer relates to a brand emotionally, and it's those emotions that trigger – or block – purchases.

That's why we've focused on using emotional strategies behind branding for a number of years now. A great example is Alli (pronounced 'ally'), a drug to aid weight loss. The product deals with a highly emotional issue, so in marketing it, we faced the same

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challenge that the new TF stores are facing: the very thought of buying the product reminds customers that they have problems they feel negatively. In the case of TF's NextStage, the problems are age and infirmity. In the case of Alli, the problems are excessive weight and its consequences. There's always a risk that consumers' negative feelings will discourage them from starting or staying on a diet. So, after extensive market research, we took a number of steps to inject emotions into the whole process of using the product.

First we came up with a name that sounds like a helpful partner. We also aimed to make the container both beautiful and functional — something that didn't just hold pills but could later be used to store diet guides and recipes. Traditional market research is unlikely to uncover ideas like this, so we use a wide variety of techniques. Even simple techniques such as one-on-one interviews, or ethnographical observation that involves going into people's houses to examine their behaviour, can provide valuable data.

Expert 2: Alex Lee, president of OXO International, maker of OXO Good Grips household products

This retailer can get back on track by remembering a principle that applies to consumers in general and those aged 60+ in particular: they're attracted by brands they associate with the type of people they'd like to be – not the type they really are. That's why marketing campaigns for surf gear feature surfers, not the city dwellers who will wear the products while doing their shopping.

I was reminded of this principle few years ago when we wanted to find out how far we could apply our design philosophy of making things easier to use in order to move from our core business, kitchen tools, into other products. We conducted what are known as focus groups, where participants were asked to look at photos of people and pick those they are perceived to be users and nonusers of our products. Consistently they picked people who looked fit as the sort who would use our products, and people who look old and boring as the sort who wouldn't. Yet the participants, all owners of our products, looked a lot more like the latter than the former.

Although the needs of elderly users and those with deteriorating vision or dexterity are very much taken into consideration when we develop new designs, we try to offer that appeal to 20- and 30-year-olds. We believe that referring to these products as helping tools would serve only to harm the brand in our customers' eyes. That's why our philosophy of universal design, which involves creating products that are comfortably useable by the largest possible range of people, is never explicitly stated as part of our marketing position.

We've found that market research does not need to be very sophisticated. For instance, we have conducted simple surveys in the lobby of our building offering free products in exchange for people's opinions. Some may call this unscientific but we have uncovered

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great insights this way. Sometimes the most important signals come from an executive's own instincts. In Tibal Fisher's case, this could have told him what his surveys and focus groups didn't: 60-plus-year-olds won't support a business that expects them to act their age.

Questions 1–5

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

1. The *TF NextStage* stores planned to sell products to make life easier for older people.
2. TF's market research indicated that people liked the products.
3. It cost more than expected to remodel the TF stores.
4. The *TF NextStage* coffee shops sold their own brand of food and drink.
5. *TF NextStage* customers liked the atmosphere in the new stores.

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Questions 6–13

Complete the notes below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

Feedback from experts

DONNA STURGESS

Problems with customer research:

- TF team limited their research to attitudes that occur at a (6) _____ level in customers' minds
- TF didn't consider customers' emotions

How my company dealt with a similar problem:

- Product: Alli
- Use: help people achieve (7) _____
- Marketing aim: help customers see the product in a positive way by:
  - Giving the product a (8) _____ that seems helpful and supportive
  - Giving the product a reusable (9) _____

Market research

- Does not need to be complex
- Good information can come from interviews or studying the (10) _____ of consumers in the home

ALEX LEE

Problem:

- Customers are attracted to the ideal not the reality, e.g. ads for surf gear

How my company dealt with a similar problem:

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- We organised (11) _____ to find out what images customers associate with our products
- We do not call our products helping tools in our marketing campaigns

Market research:

- Can be basic, e.g. by doing (12) _____
- Company executives should follow their (13) _____

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Reading Passage 2

Keeping the water away

New approaches to flood control

A Recently, winter floods on the rivers of central Europe have been among the worst for 600 to 700 years, and dams and dykes (protective sea walls) have failed to solve the problem. Traditionally, river engineers have tried to get rid of the water quickly, draining it off the land and down to the sea in rivers re-engineered as high-performance drains. But however high they build the artificial riverbanks, the floods keep coming back. And when they come, they seem to be worse than ever.

B Engineers are now turning to a different plan: to sap the water's destructive strength by dispersing it into fields, forgotten lakes and flood plains. They are reviving river bends and marshes to curb the flow, and even plugging city drains to encourage floodwater to use other means to go underground. Back in the days when rivers took a winding path to the sea, floodwaters lost force and volume while meandering across flood plains and inland deltas, but today the water tends to have a direct passage to the sea. This means that, when it rains in the uplands, the water comes down all at once.

C Worse, when the flood plains are closed off, the river's flow downstream becomes more violent and uncontrollable; by turning complex river systems into the simple mechanics of a water pipe, engineers have often created danger where they promised safety. The Rhine, Europe's most engineered river, is a good example. For a long time engineers have erased its backwaters and cut it off from its plain. The aim was partly to improve navigation, and partly to speed floodwaters out of Alps and down to the North Sea. Now, when it rains in the Alps, the peak flows from several branches of the Rhine coincide where once they arrived separately, and with four-fifths of the Lower Rhine's flood plain barricaded off, the waters rise. The result is more frequent flooding and greater damage. The same thing has happened in the US on the Mississippi river, which drains the world's second largest river catchment into the Gulf of Mexico. Despite some $7 billion spent over the last century on levees (embankments) the situation is growing worse.

D Specialists in water control now say that a new approach is needed – one which takes the whole landscape into consideration. To help keep London's feet dry, the UK Environment Agency is reflooding 10 square kilometres of the ancient flood plain of the River Thames outside Oxford. Nearer to London, it has spent £100 million creating new wetlands and a relief channel across 16 kilometres of flood plain. Similar ideas are being tested in Austria, in one of Europe's largest river restorations to date. The engineers calculate that the restored flood plain of the Drava River can now store up to 10 million

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cubic metres of floodwater, and slow down storm surges coming out of the Alps by more than an hour, protecting towns not only in Austria, but as far downstream as Slovenia and Croatia.

E The Dutch, for whom preventing floods is a matter of survival, have gone furthest. This nation, built largely on drained marshes and seabed, has had several severe shocks in the last two decades, when very large numbers of people have had to be evacuated. Since that time, the Dutch have broken one of their most enduring national stereotypes by allowing engineers to punch holes in dykes. They plan to return up to a sixth of the country to its former waterlogged state in order to better protect the rest.

F Water use in cities also needs to change. At the moment, cities seem to create floods; they are concreted and paved so that rains flow quickly into rivers. A new breed of 'soft engineers' wants cities to be porous, Berlin is one place where this is being done. Tough new rules for new developments mean that drains will be prevented from becoming overloaded after heavy rains. Architects of new urban buildings are diverting rainwater from the roofs for use in toilets and the irrigation of roof gardens, while water falling onto the ground is collected in ponds, or passes underground through porous paving. One high-tech urban development can store a sixth of its annual rainfall, and reuse most of the rest.

G Could this be expanded to protect a whole city? The test case could be Los Angeles. With non-porous surfaces covering 70% of the city, drainage is a huge challenge. Billions of dollars have been spent digging huge drains and concreting riverbeds, but many communities still flood regularly. Meanwhile this desert city ships water from hundreds of kilometres away to fill its taps and swimming pool. Los Angeles has recently launched a new scheme to utilise floodwater in the Sun Valley section of the city. The plan is to catch the rain that falls on thousands of driveways, parking lots and rooftops in the valley. Trees will soak up water from parking lots; houses and public buildings will capture roof water to irrigate gardens and parks, and road drains will empty into old gravel pits to recharge the city's underground water reserves. Result: less flooding and more water for the city. It may sound expensive, until we realise how much is spent trying to drain cities and protect areas from flooding, and how little this method achieves.

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Questions 14–19

Reading Passage 2 has seven paragraphs, **A–G**. *Which paragraph contains the following information?*

Q	Statement	Answer
14	How legislation has forced building designers to improve water use.	
15	Two reasons why one river was isolated from its flood plain.	
16	How natural water courses in the past assisted flood control.	
17	An example of flood control on one river, affecting three countries.	
18	A country which has partly destroyed one of its most typical features in order to control water.	
19	The writer's comment on the comparative cost effectiveness of traditional flood control and newer methods.	

Questions 20–21

Choose **TWO** *letters,* **A–E**. *According to the article, which* **TWO** *of these statements are true of the new approach to flood control?*

A It aims to slow the movement of water to the sea.
B It aims to channel water more directly into rivers.
C It will cost more than twice as much as former measures.
D It will involve the loss of some areas of land.
E It has been tested only in The Netherlands.

20 First correct letter

21 Second correct letter

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Questions 22–26

Complete the sentences below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

22 Some of the most severe floods for many centuries have recently occurred in parts of _____.

23 The Rhine and the _____ rivers have experienced similar problems with water control.

24 An area near Oxford will be flooded to protect the city of _____.

25 Planners who wish to allow water to pass more freely through city surfaces are called _____.

26 A proposal for part of the city of _____ could show whether small-scale water projects could apply on a large scale.

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Reading Passage 3

Australia's Megafauna Controversy

Just how long did humans live side by side with megafauna in Australia? Barry Brook, Richard Gillespie and Paul Martin dispute previous claims of a lengthy coexistence

Over the past 50 millennia, Australia has witnessed the extinction of many species of large animals, including a rhinoceros-sized wombat and goannas the size of crocodiles. Debate about the possible cause of these extinctions has continued for more than 150 years and one of the crucial questions raised is how long humans and megafauna coexisted in Australia. We need to know the overlap of time to make an informed choice between the two main theories regarding the causes of these extinctions. If humans and megafauna coexisted for a protracted period then climate change is the more likely cause. However, if the megafauna became extinct shortly after the arrival of humans, then humans are the likely culprits.

The archaeological site at Cuddie Springs in eastern Australia appears to be well preserved. This dusty claypan holds within its sediments a rich cache of flaked stone and seed-grinding tools, and side by side with these clear signals of human culture are the bones of a dozen or more species of megafauna. Drs Judith Field and Stephen Wroe of the University of Sydney, who excavated the site, claim that it provides unequivocal evidence of a long overlap of humans and megafauna, and conclude that aridity leading up to the last Ice Age brought about their eventual demise. In the long-standing explanation of this site, artefacts such as stone tools and extinct animal remains were deposited over many thousands of years in an ephemeral lake – a body of water existing for a relatively short time – and remained in place and undisturbed until the present day.

There is no disputing the close association of bones and stones at Cuddie Springs, as both are found 1 to 1.7 metres below the modern surface. The dating of these layers is accurate: ages for the sediments were obtained through radiocarbon dating of charcoal fragments and luminescence dating of sand grains from the same levels (revealing when a sample was last exposed to sunlight). Intriguingly, some of the stones show surface features indicating their use for processing plants, and a few even have well-preserved blood and hair residues suggesting they were used for butchering animals.

But is the case proposed by Field and Wroe clear-cut? We carried out a reanalysis of the scientific data from Cuddie Springs that brings into question their conclusions. The amount of anthropological evidence found at the site is remarkable: we estimate there are more than 3 tonnes of charcoal and more than 300 tonnes of stone buried there. Field and Wroe estimate that there are approximately 20 million artefacts. This plethora of tools is hard to reconcile with a site that was only available for occupation when the lake was dry.

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Furthermore, no cultural features such as oven pits have been discovered. If the sediment layers have remained undisturbed since being laid down, as Field and Wroe contend, then the ages of those sediments should increase with depth. However, our analysis revealed a number of inconsistencies.

First, the charcoal samples are all roughly 36,000 years old. Second, sand in the two upper levels is considerably younger than charcoal from the same levels. Third, Field and Wroe say that the tools and seed-grinding stones used for plant and animal processing are ancient, yet they are very similar to implements found elsewhere that were in use only a few thousand years ago. Also of interest is the fact that a deep drill core made a mere 60 metres from the site recovered no stone artefact or fossil bones whatsoever. These points suggest strongly that the sediments have been moved about and some of the old charcoal has been re-deposited in younger layers. Indeed, one sample of cow bone found 1 metre below the surface came from sediments where charcoal dated at 6,000 and 23,000 years old is mixed with 17,000-year-old sand. The megafauna bones themselves have not yet been dated, although new technological developments make this a possibility in the near future.

We propose that the archaeologists have actually been sampling the debris carried by ancient flood channels beneath the site, including charcoal transported from bushfires that intermittently occurred within the catchment. Flood events more likely explain the accumulation of megafauna remains, and could have mixed old bones with fresh deposits. European graziers also disturbed the site in 1876 by constructing a well to provide water for their cattle. Given the expense of well-digging, we speculate that the graziers made sure it was protected from the damage caused by cattle hooves by lining the surface with small stones collected from further afield, including prehistoric quarries. This idea is consistent with the thin layer of stones spread over a large area, with cattle occasionally breaking through the gravel surface and forcing the stone and even cattle bones deeper into the waterlogged soil.

The lack of conclusive evidence that humans and megafauna coexisted for a lengthy period casts doubt on Field and Wroe's assertion that climate change was responsible for the extinction of Australia's megafauna. However, we do not suggest that newly arrived, well-armed hunters systematically slaughtered all the large beasts they encountered. Recent studies based on the biology of modern-day large mammals, combined with observations of people who still practise a traditional hunter-gatherer lifestyle, reveal an unexpected paradox and suggest a further possible explanation as to what happened. Using a mathematical model, it was found that a group of 10 people killing only one juvenile Diprotodon each year would be sufficient to bring about the extinction of that species

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within 1,000 years. This suggests that here, as in other parts of the world, the arrival of humans in lands previously inhabited only by animals created a volatile combination in which large animals fared badly.

Questions 27–30

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

YES *if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this*

(27) Field and Wroe argue that findings at the Cuddie Springs site show that people lived in this area at the same time as megafauna.

(28) Field and Wroe believe it is likely that smaller megafauna species survived the last Ice Age.

(29) The writers believe that the dating of earth up to 1.7m below the present surface at Cuddie Springs is unreliable.

(30) Some artefacts found at Cuddie Springs were preserved well enough to reveal their function.

Questions 31–35

Complete the summary using the word list below.

The writers' arguments against Field and Wroe's analysis of the scientific data from Cuddie Springs

A seeds **B** stone **C** sand **D** cooking **E** deep drill core **F** water **G** fossil bones **H** sediment **I** storage

One objection to Field and Wroe's interpretation is the large quantity of charcoal, (31) _____ and artefacts found at Cuddie Springs. Such large numbers of artefacts would be impossible if the area had been covered with (32) _____ for a period. There is also a complete lack of man-made structures, for instance those used for (33) _____.

Other evidence that casts doubt on Field and Wroe's claim is the fact that while some material in the highest levels of sediment is 36,000 years old, the (34) _____ in the same levels is much more recent. The tools used to process plants and animals may also be newer than Field and Wroe believe. Further evidence against human occupation of the area is the absence of tools and (35) _____ a short distance away.

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Questions 36–40

Choose the correct letter, **A, B, C** *or* **D**.

36 What conclusions did the writers reach about the inconsistencies in the data from Cuddie Springs?

A The different layers of sediment have been mixed over time.

B The sand evidence is unhelpful and should be disregarded.

C The area needs to be re-examined when technology improves.

D The charcoal found in the area cannot be dated.

37 According to the writers, what impact could a natural phenomenon have had on this site?

A Floods could have caused the death of the megafauna.

B Floods could have disturbed the archaeological evidence.

C Bushfires could have prevented humans from settling in the area for any length of time.

D Bushfires could have destroyed much of the evidence left by megafauna and humans.

38 What did the writers speculate about the people who lived at this site in 1876?

A They bred cattle whose bones could have been confused with megafauna.

B They found that the soil was too waterlogged for farming.

C They allowed cattle to move around freely at the site.

D They brought stones there from another area.

39 In the final paragraph what suggestion do the writers make about Australia's megafauna?

A A rapid change in climate may have been responsible for the extinction of the megafauna.

B Megafauna could have died out as a result of small numbers being killed year after year.

C The population of humans at that time was probably insufficient to cause the extinction of the megafauna.

D The extinction of ancient animals should not be compared to that of modern-day species.

40 Which of the following best represents the writers' criticism of Field and Wroe?

A Their methods were not well thought out.

B Their excavations did not go deep enough.

C Their technology failed to obtain precise data.

D Their conclusions were based on inconsistent data.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 5

Volume 1 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Voyage of Going Beyond the Blue Line

THE VOYAGE OF THE MUNTJAC

A One feels a certain sympathy for Captain James Cook on the day in 1778 that he "discovered" Hawaii. Then on his third expedition to the Pacific, the British navigator had explored scores of islands across the breadth of the sea, from lush New Zealand to the lonely wastes of Easter Island. This latest voyage had taken him thousands of miles north from the Society Islands to an archipelago so remote that even the old Polynesians back on Tahiti knew nothing about it. Imagine Cook's surprise, then, when the natives of Hawaii came paddling out in their canoes and greeted him in a familiar tongue, one he had heard on virtually every scrap of inhabited land he had visited. Marveling at the ubiquity of this Pacific language and culture, he later wondered in his journal: "How shall we account for this Nation spreading itself so far over this Vast ocean?"

B Answers have been slow in coming. But now a startling archaeological find on the island of Efate, in the Pacific nation of Vanuatu, has revealed an ancient seafaring people, the distant ancestors of today's Polynesians, taking their first steps into the unknown. The discoveries there have also opened a window into the shadowy world of those early voyagers. At the same time, other pieces of this human puzzle are turning up in unlikely places. Climate data gleaned from slow-growing corals around the Pacific and from sediments in alpine lakes in South America may help explain how, more than a thousand years later, a second wave of seafarers beat their way across the entire Pacific.

C "What we have is a first-or second-generation site containing the graves of some of the Pacific's first explorers," says Spriggs, professor of archaeology at the Australian National University and co-leader of an international team excavating the site. It came to light only by luck. A backhoe operator, digging up topsoil on the grounds of a derelict coconut plantation, scraped open a grave – the first of dozens in a burial ground some 3,000 years old. It is the oldest cemetery ever found in the Pacific islands, and it harbors the bones of an ancient people archaeologists call the Lapita, a label that derives from a beach in New Caledonia where a landmark cache of their pottery was found in the 1950s. They were daring blue-water adventurers who roved the sea not just as explorers but also as pioneers, bringing along everything they would need to build new lives – their families and livestock, taro seedlings and stone tools.

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D Within the span of a few centuries the Lapita stretched the boundaries of their world from the jungle-clad volcanoes of Papua New Guinea to the loneliest coral outliers of Tonga, at least 2,000 miles eastward in the Pacific. Along the way they explored millions of square miles of unknown sea, discovering and colonizing scores of tropical islands never before seen by human eyes: Vanuatu, New Caledonia, Fiji, Samoa.

E What little is known or surmised about them has been pieced together from fragments of pottery, animal bones, obsidian flakes, and such oblique sources as comparative linguistics and geochemistry. Although their voyages can be traced back to the northern islands of Papua New Guinea, their language – variants of which are still spoken across the Pacific – came from Taiwan. And their peculiar style of pottery decoration, created by pressing a carved stamp into the clay, probably had its roots in the northern Philippines. With the discovery of the Lapita cemetery on Efate, the volume of data available to researchers has expanded dramatically. The bones of at least 62 individuals have been uncovered so far, including old men, young women, even babies – and more skeletons are known to be in the ground. Archaeologists were also thrilled to discover six complete Lapita pots. It's an important find, Spriggs says, for it conclusively identifies the remains as Lapita. "It would be hard for anyone to argue that these aren't Lapita when you have human bones enshrined inside what is unmistakably a Lapita urn."

F Several lines of evidence also undergird Spriggs's conclusion that this was a community of pioneers making their first voyages into the remote reaches of Oceania. For one thing, the radiocarbon dating of bones and charcoal places them early in the Lapita expansion. For another, the chemical makeup of the obsidian flakes littering the site indicates that the rock wasn't local; instead it was imported from a large island in Papua New Guinea's Bismarck Archipelago, the springboard for the Lapita's thrust into the Pacific. A particularly intriguing clue comes from chemical tests on the teeth of several skeletons. DNA teased from these ancient bones may also help answer one of the most puzzling questions in Pacific anthropology: Did all Pacific islanders spring from one source or many? Was there only one outward migration from a single point in Asia, or several from different points? "This represents the best opportunity we've had yet," says Spriggs, "to find out who the Lapita actually were, where they came from, and who their closest descendants are today."

G There is one stubborn question for which archaeology has yet to provide any answers: How did the Lapita accomplish the ancient equivalent of a moon landing, many times over? No one has found one of their canoes or any rigging, which could reveal how the canoes were sailed. Nor do the oral histories and traditions of later Polynesians offer any insights, for they segue into myth long before they reach as far back in time as the Lapita. "All we can say for certain is that the Lapita had canoes that were capable of ocean voyages, and they had the ability to sail them," says Geoff Irwin, a professor of archaeology at the

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University of Auckland and an avid yachtsman. Those sailing skills, he says, were developed and passed down over thousands of years by earlier mariners who worked their way through the archipelagoes of the western Pacific making short crossings to islands within sight of each other. Reaching Fiji, as they did a century or so later, meant crossing more than 500 miles of ocean, pressing on day after day into the great blue void of the Pacific. What gave them the courage to launch out on such a risky voyage?

H The Lapita's thrust into the Pacific was eastward, against the prevailing trade winds, Irwin notes. Those nagging headwinds, he argues, may have been the key to their success. "They could sail out for days into the unknown and reconnoiter, secure in the knowledge that if they didn't find anything, they could turn about and catch a swift ride home on the trade winds. It's what made the whole thing work." Once out there, skilled seafarers would detect abundant leads to follow to land: seabirds and turtles, coconuts and twigs carried out to sea by the tides, and the afternoon pileup of clouds on the horizon that often betokens an island in the distance. Some islands may have broadcast their presence with far less subtlety than a cloud bank. Some of the most violent eruptions anywhere on the planet during the past 10,000 years occurred in Melanesia, which sits nervously in one of the most explosive volcanic regions on Earth. Even less spectacular eruptions would have sent plumes of smoke billowing into the stratosphere and rained ash for hundreds of miles. It's possible that the Lapita saw these signs of distant islands and later sailed off in their direction, knowing they would find land. For returning explorers, successful or not, the geography of their own archipelagoes provided a safety net to keep them from overshooting their home ports and sailing off into eternity.

I However they did it, the Lapita spread themselves a third of the way across the Pacific, then called it quits for reasons known only to them. Ahead lay the vast emptiness of the central Pacific, and perhaps they were too thinly stretched to venture farther. They probably never numbered more than a few thousand in total, and in their rapid migration eastward they encountered hundreds of islands – more than 300 in Fiji alone. Still, more than a millennium would pass before the Lapita's descendants, a people we now call the Polynesians, struck out in search of new territory.

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Questions 1–7

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

YES *if the statement agrees with the information* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

1 Captain Cook once expected the Hawaiians might speak another language of people from other Pacific islands.

2 The Efate site was discovered intentionally by a team of researchers.

3 Professor Spriggs and his research team went to Efate to try to find the site of an ancient cemetery.

4 The Lapita completed a journey of around 2,000 miles in a period less than a centenary.

5 The Lapita were the first inhabitants in many Pacific islands.

6 The unknown pots discovered in Efate had once been used for cooking.

7 The urn buried in the Efate site was plain, as it was without any decoration.

Questions 8–10

Complete the following summary of the paragraphs of Reading Passage 1. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from Reading Passage 1 for each answer.*

SCIENTIFIC EVIDENCE FOUND IN EFATE SITE

Tests show the human remains and the charcoal found in the buried urn are from the start of the Lapita period. Yet the 8 ———— covering many of the Efate site did not come from that area. Then examinations carried out on the 9 ———— discovered at the Efate site reveal that not everyone buried there was a native living in the area. In fact, DNA could identify the Lapita's nearest 10 ———— present-day.

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Questions 11–13

Answer the questions below. Choose **NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** *from the passage for each answer.*

11 What did the Lapita travel in when they crossed the oceans?

12 In Irwin's view, what would the Lapita have relied on to bring them fast back to the base?

13 Which sea creatures would have been an indication to the Lapita of where to find land?

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Reading Passage 2

Multitasks

A Do you read while listening to music? Do you like to watch TV while finishing your homework? People who have these kinds of habits are called multi-taskers. Multitaskers are able to complete two tasks at the same time by dividing their focus. However, Thomas Lehman, a researcher in Psychology, believes people never really do multiple things simultaneously. Maybe a person is reading while listening to music, but in reality, the brain can only focus on one task. Reading the words in a book will cause you to ignore some of the words of the music. When people think they are accomplishing two different tasks efficiently, what they are really doing is dividing their focus. While listening to music, people become less able to focus on their surroundings. For example, we all have experience of times when we talk with friends and they are not responding properly. Maybe they are listening to someone else talk, or maybe they are reading a text on their smart phone and don't hear what you are saying. Lehman called this phenomenon "email voice".

B The world has been changed by computers and its spin offs like smart-phones or cellphones. Now that most individuals have a personal device, like a smart-phone or a laptop, they are frequently reading, watching or listening to virtual information. This raises the occurrence of multitasking in our day to day life. Now when you work, you work with your typewriter, your cellphone, and some colleagues who may drop by at any time to speak with you. In professional meetings, when one normally focuses and listens to one another, people are more likely to have a cell phone in their lap, reading or communicating silently with more people than ever. Even inventions such as the cordless phone has increased multitasking. In the old days, a traditional wall phone would ring, and then the housewife would have to stop her activities to answer it. When it rang, the housewife would sit down with her legs up and chat, with no laundry or sweeping or answering the door. In the modern era, our technology is convenient enough to not interrupt our daily tasks.

C Earl Miller, an expert at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology, studied the prefrontal cortex, which controls the brain while a person is multitasking. According to his studies, the size of this cortex varies between species. He found that for humans, the size of this part constitutes one third of the brain, while it is only 4 to 5 percent in dogs, and about 15% in monkeys. Given that this cortex is larger on a human, it allows a human to be more flexible and accurate in his or her multitasking. However, Miller wanted to look further into whether the cortex was truly processing information about two different tasks simultaneously. He designed an experiment where he presents visual stimulants to his subjects in a way that mimics multi-tasking. Miller then attached sensors to the patients'

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heads to pick up the electric patterns of the brain. This sensor would show if the brain particles, called neurons, were truly processing two different tasks. What he found is that the brain neurons only lit up in singular areas one at a time, and never simultaneously.

D David Meyer, a professor of University of Michigan, studied the young adults in a similar experiment. He instructed them to simultaneously do math problems and classify simple words into different categories. For this experiment, Meyer found that when you think you are doing several jobs at the same time, you are actually switching between jobs. Even though the people tried to do the tasks at the same time, and both tasks were eventually accomplished, overall, the tasks took more time than if the person focused on a single task one at a time.

E People sacrifice efficiency when multitasking. Gloria Mark set office workers as her subjects. He found that they were constantly multitasking. He observed that nearly every 11 minutes people at work were disrupted. He found that doing different jobs at the same time may actually save time. However, despite the fact that they are faster, it does not mean they are more efficient. And we are equally likely to self-interrupt as be interrupted by outside sources. He found that in office nearly every 12 minutes an employee would stop and with no reason at all, check a website on their computer, call someone or write an email. If they concentrated for more than 20 minutes, they would feel distressed. He suggested that the average person may suffer from a short concentration span. This short attention span might be natural, but others suggest that new technology may be the problem. With cellphones and computers at our sides at all times, people will never run out of distractions. The format of media, such as advertisements, music, news articles and TV shows are also shortening, so people are used to paying attention to information for a very short time.

F So even though focusing on one single task is the most efficient way for our brains to work, it is not practical to use this method in real life. According to human nature, people feel more comfortable and efficient in environments with a variety of tasks. Edward Hallowell said that people are losing a lot of efficiency in the workplace due to multitasking, outside distractions and self-distractions. As a matter of fact, the changes made to the workplace do not have to be dramatic. No one is suggesting we ban e-mail or make employees focus on only one task. However, certain common workplace tasks, such as group meetings, would be more efficient if we banned cell-phones, a common distraction. A person can also apply these tips to prevent self-distraction. Instead of arriving to your office and checking all of your e-mails for new tasks, a common workplace ritual, a person could dedicate an hour to a single task first thing in the morning. Self-timing is a great way to reduce distraction and efficiently finish tasks one by one, instead of slowing ourselves down with multi-tasking.

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Questions 14–18

Reading Passage 2 has six paragraphs, **A–F**. *Which paragraph contains the following information?*

Q	Statement	Answer
14	a reference to a domestic situation that does not require multitasking	
15	a possible explanation of why we always multitask together	
16	a practical solution to multitasking in a work environment	
17	relating multitasking to the size of the prefrontal cortex	
18	longer time spent doing two tasks at the same time than one at a time	

Questions 19–23

Look at the following statements and the list of scientists below. Match each statement with the correct scientist, **A–E**.

LIST OF SCIENTISTS

A Thomas Lehman
B Earl Miller
C David Meyer
D Gloria Mark
E Edward Hallowell

Q	Statement	Answer
19	When faced with multiple visual stimulants, one can only concentrate on one of them.	
20	Doing two things together may be faster but not better.	
21	People never really do two things together even if you think you do.	
22	The causes of multitasking lie in the environment.	
23	Even minor changes in the workplace will improve work efficiency.	

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Questions 24–26

Complete the sentences below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

A term used to refer to a situation when you are reading a text and cannot focus on your surroundings is (24) ————————.

The (25) ———————— part of the brain controls multitasking.

The practical solution to multitasking at work is not to allow use of cellphones in (26) ————————.

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Reading Passage 3

Grimm's Fairy Tales

A The Brothers Grimm, Jacob and Wilhelm, named their story collection Children's and Household Tales and published the first of its seven editions in Germany in 1812. The table of contents reads like an A-list of fairy-tale celebrities: Cinderella, Sleeping Beauty, Snow White, Little Red Riding Hood, Rapunzel, Rumpelstiltskin, Hansel and Gretel, the Frog King. Drawn mostly from oral narratives, the 210 stories in the Grimms' collection represent an anthology of fairy tales, animal fables, rustic farces, and religious allegories that remain unrivalled to this day.

B Such lasting fame would have shocked the humble Grimms. During their lifetimes the collection sold modestly in Germany, at first only a few hundred copies a year. The early editions were not even aimed at children. The brothers initially refused to consider illustrations, and scholarly footnotes took up almost as much space as the tales themselves. Jacob and Wilhelm viewed themselves as patriotic folklorists, not as entertainers of children. They began their work at a time when Germany had been overrun by the French under Napoleon, who were intent on suppressing local culture. As young, workaholic scholars, single and sharing a cramped flat, the Brothers Grimm undertook the fairy-tale collection with the goal of serving the endangered oral tradition of Germany.

C For much of the 19th century teachers, parents, and religious figures, particularly in the United States, deplored the Grimms' collection for its raw, uncivilized content. Offended adults objected to the gruesome punishments inflicted on the stories' villains. In the original "Snow White" the evil stepmother is forced to dance in red-hot iron shoes until she falls down dead. Even today some protective parents shy from the Grimms' tales because of their reputation for violence.

D Despite its sometimes rocky reception, Children's and Household Tales gradually took root with the public. The brothers had not foreseen that the appearance of their work would coincide with a great flowering of children's literature in Europe. English publishers led the way, issuing high-quality picture books such as Jack and the Beanstalk and handsome folktale collections, all to satisfy a newly literate audience seeking virtuous material for the nursery. Once the Brothers Grimm sighted this new public, they set about refining and softening their tales, which had originated centuries earlier as earthy peasant fare. In the Grimms' hands, cruel mothers became nasty stepmothers, unmarried lovers were made chaste, and the incestuous father was recast as the devil.

E In the 20th century the Grimms' fairy tales have come to rule the bookshelves of children's bedrooms. The stories read like dreams come true: handsome lads and beautiful damsels, armed with magic, triumph over giants and witches and wild beasts. They outwit

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mean, selfish adults. Inevitably the boy and girl fall in love and live happily ever after. And parents keep reading because they approve of the finger-wagging lessons inserted into the stories: keep your promises, don't talk to strangers, work hard, obey your parents. According to the Grimms, the collection served as "a manual of manners".

F Altogether some 40 persons delivered tales to the Grimms. Many of the storytellers came to the Grimms' house in Kassel. The brothers particularly welcomed the visits of Dorothea Viehmann, a widow who walked to town to sell produce from her garden. An innkeeper's daughter, Viehmann had grown up listening to stories from travellers on the road to Frankfurt. Among her treasure was "Aschenputtel" – Cinderella. Marie Hassenpflug was a 20-year-old friend of their sister, Charlotte, from a well-bred, French-speaking family. Marie's wonderful stories blended motifs from the oral tradition and from Perrault's influential 1697 book, Tales of My Mother Goose, which contained elaborate versions of "Little Red Riding Hood", "Snow White", and "Sleeping Beauty", among others. Many of these had been adapted from earlier Italian tales.

G Given that the origins of many of the Grimm fairy tales reach throughout Europe and into the Middle East and Orient, the question must be asked: How German are the Grimm tales? Very, says scholar Heinz Rolleke. Love of the underdog, rustic simplicity, creative energy – these are Teutonic traits. The coarse texture of life during medieval times in Germany, when many of the tales entered the oral tradition, also coloured the narratives. Throughout Europe children were often neglected and abandoned, like Hansel and Gretel. Accused witches were burned at the stake, like the evil mother-in-law in "The Six Swans". "The cruelty in the stories was not the Grimm's fantasy," Rolleke points out. "It reflected the law-and-order system of the old times."

H The editorial fingerprints left by the Grimms betray the specific values of 19th-century Christian, bourgeois German society. But that has not stopped the tales from being embraced by almost every culture and nationality in the world. What accounts for this widespread, enduring popularity? Bernhard Lauer points to the "universal style" of the writing: you have no concrete descriptions of the land, or the clothes, or the forest, or the castles. It makes the stories timeless and placeless. "The tales allow us to express our utopian longings," says Jack Zipes of the University of Minnesota, whose 1987 translation of the complete fairy tales captures the rustic vigour of the original text. "They show a striving for happiness that none of us knows but that we sense is possible. We can identify with the heroes of the tales and become in our mind the masters and mistresses of our own destinies."

I Fairy tales provide a workout for the unconscious, psychoanalysts maintain. Bruno Bettelheim famously promoted the therapeutic value of the Grimms' stories, calling fairy tales the "great comforters". By confronting fears and phobias, symbolized by witches,

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heartless stepmothers, and hungry wolves, children find they can master their anxieties. Bettelheim's theory continues to be hotly debated. But most young readers aren't interested in exercising their unconsciousness. The Grimm tales in fact please in an infinite number of ways, something about them seems to mirror whatever moods or interests we bring to our reading of them. The flexibility of interpretation suits them for almost any time and any culture.

Questions 27–32

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 3?

YES *if the statement agrees with the information* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

27 The Grimm brothers believed they would achieve international fame.

28 The Grimm brothers were forced to work in secret.

29 Some parents today still think Grimm fairy tales are not suitable for children.

30 The first edition of Grimm's fairy tales sold more widely in England than in Germany.

31 Adults like reading Grimm's fairy tales for reasons different from those of children.

32 The Grimm brothers based the story "Cinderella" on the life of Dorothea Viehmann.

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Questions 33–35

Choose the correct letter, **A, B, C** *or* **D**.

33 In paragraph 4, what changes happened at that time in Europe?

A Literacy levels of the population increased.

B The development of printing technology made it easier to publish.

C Schools were open to children.

D People were fond of collecting superb picture books.

34 What changes did the Grimm Brothers make in later editions?

A They made the stories shorter.

B They used more oral language.

C The content of the tales became less violent.

D They found other origins of the tales.

35 What did Marie Hassenpflug contribute to the Grimm's Fairy tales?

A She wrote stories.

B She discussed the stories with them.

C She translated a popular book for the brothers using her talent for languages.

D She told oral stories that were based on traditional Italian stories.

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Questions 36–40

Complete each sentence with the correct ending, **A–H**, *below.*

LIST OF ENDINGS

A reflect what life was like at that time
B help children deal with their problems
C demonstrate the outdated system
D tell of the simplicity of life in the German countryside
E encourage people to believe that they can do anything
F recognize the heroes in real life
G contribute to the belief in the power of nature
H avoid details about characters' social settings

36 Heinz Rolleke said the Grimms' tales are "German" because the tales...

37 Heinz Rolleke said the abandoned children in tales...

38 Bernhard Lauer said the writing style of the Grimm brothers is universal because they...

39 Jack Zipes said the pursuit of happiness in the tales means they...

40 Bruno Bettelheim said the therapeutic value of the tales means that the fairy tales...

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 6

Volume 1 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

History of Tea

The story of tea begins in China. According to legend, in 2737 BC, the Chinese emperor Shen Nung was sitting beneath a tree while his servant boiled drinking water, when some leaves from the tree blew into the water. Shen Nung, a renowned herbalist, decided to try the infusion that his servant had accidentally created. The tree was a Camellia sinensis, and the resulting drink was what we now call tea. It is impossible to know whether there is any truth in this story. But tea drinking certainly became established in China many centuries before it had even been heard of in the West. Containers for tea have been found in tombs dating from the Han Dynasty (206 BC—220 AD) but it was under the Tang Dynasty (618—906 AD), that tea became firmly established as the national drink of China.

It became such a favourite that during the late eighth century a writer called Lu Yu wrote the first book entirely about tea, the Ch'a Ching, or Tea Classic. It was shortly after this that tea was first introduced to Japan, by Japanese Buddhist monks who had travelled to China to study. Tea received almost instant imperial sponsorship and spread rapidly from the royal court and monasteries to the other sections of Japanese society.

So at this stage in the history of tea, Europe was rather lagging behind. In the latter half of the sixteenth century there are the first brief mentions of tea as a drink among Europeans. These are mostly from Portuguese who were living in the East as traders and missionaries. But although some of these individuals may have brought back samples of tea to their native country, it was not the Portuguese who were the first to ship back tea as a commercial import. This was done by the Dutch, who in the last years of the sixteenth century began to encroach on Portuguese trading routes in the East. By the turn of the century they had established a trading post on the island of Java, and it was via Java that in 1606 the first consignment of tea was shipped from China to Holland. Tea soon became a fashionable drink among the Dutch, and from there spread to other countries in continental western Europe, but because of its high price it remained a drink for the wealthy.

Britain, always a little suspicious of continental trends, had yet to become the nation of tea drinkers that it is today. Starting in 1600, the British East India Company had a monopoly on importing goods from outside Europe, and it is likely that sailors on these ships brought tea home as gifts. The first coffee house had been established in London in 1652, and tea

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was still somewhat unfamiliar to most readers, so it is fair to assume that the drink was still something of a curiosity. Gradually, it became a popular drink in coffee houses, which were as many locations for the transaction of business as they were for relaxation or pleasure. They were though the preserve of middle- and upper-class men; women drank tea in their own homes, and as yet tea was still too expensive to be widespread among the working classes. In part, its high price was due to a punitive system of taxation.

One unforeseen consequence of the taxation of tea was the growth of methods to avoid taxation—smuggling and adulteration. By the eighteenth century many Britons wanted to drink tea but could not afford the high prices, and their enthusiasm for the drink was matched by the enthusiasm of criminal gangs to smuggle it in. What began as a small time illegal trade, selling a few pounds of tea to personal contacts, developed by the late eighteenth century into an astonishing organised crime network, perhaps importing as much as 7 million lbs annually, compared to a legal import of 5 million lbs! Worse for the drinkers was that taxation also encouraged the adulteration of tea, particularly of smuggled tea which was not quality controlled through customs and excise. Leaves from other plants, or leaves which had already been brewed and then dried, were added to tea leaves. By 1784, the government realised that enough was enough, and that heavy taxation was creating more problems than it was worth. The new Prime Minister, William Pitt the Younger, slashed the tax from 119 per cent to 12.5 per cent. Suddenly legal tea was affordable, and smuggling stopped virtually overnight.

Another great impetus to tea drinking resulted from the end of the East India Company's monopoly on trade with China, in 1834. Before that date, China was the country of origin of the vast majority of the tea imported to Britain, but the end of its monopoly stimulated the East India Company to consider growing tea outside China. India had always been the centre of the Company's operations, which led to the increased cultivation of tea in India, beginning in Assam. There were a few false starts, including the destruction by cattle of one of the earliest tea nurseries, but by 1888 British tea imports from India were for the first time greater than those from China.

The end of the East India Company's monopoly on trade with China also had another result, which was more dramatic though less important in the long term: it ushered in the era of the tea clippers. While the Company had had the monopoly on trade, there was no rush to bring the tea from China to Britain, but after 1834 the tea trade became a virtual free for all. Individual merchants and sea captains with their own ships raced to bring home the tea and make the most money, using fast new clippers which had sleek lines, tall masts and huge sails. In particular there was a competition between British and American merchants, leading to the famous clipper races of the 1860s. But these races soon came to an end with the opening of the Suez Canal, which made the trade routes to China viable for steamships for the first time.

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Questions 1–7

Complete the sentences below with words taken from Reading Passage 1. Use **ONE WORD** *for each answer.*

Researchers believed the tea containers detected in (1) _____ from the Han Dynasty was the first evidence of the use of tea.

Lu Yu wrote a (2) _____ about tea before anyone else in the eighth century.

It was (3) _____ from Japan who brought tea to their native country from China.

Tea was carried from China to Europe actually by the (4) _____

The British government had to cut down the taxation on tea due to the serious crime of (5) _____

Tea was planted in (6) _____ besides China in the 19th century.

In order to compete in shipping speed, traders used (7) _____ for the race.

Questions 8–13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

(8) Tea was popular in Britain in the 16th century.

(9) Tea was more fashionable than coffee in Europe in the late 16th century.

(10) Tea was enjoyed by all classes in Britain in the seventeenth century.

(11) The adulteration of tea also prompted William Pitt the Younger to reduce the tax.

(12) Initial problems occurred when tea was planted outside China by the East India Company.

(13) The fastest vessels were owned by America during the 19th century clipper races.

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Reading Passage 2

Biodiversity

A It seems biodiversity has become a buzzword beloved of politicians, conservationists, protesters and scientists alike. But what exactly is it? The Convention on Biological Diversity, an international agreement to conserve and share the planet's biological riches, provides a good working definition: biodiversity comprises every form of life, from the smallest microbe to the largest animal or plant, the genes that give them their specific characteristics and the ecosystems of which they are a part.

B In October, the World Conservation Union (also known as the IUCN) published its updated Red List of Threatened Species, a roll call of 11,167 creatures facing extinction – 121 more than when the list was last published in 2000. But the new figures almost certainly underestimate the crisis. Some 1.2 million species of animal and 270,000 species of plant have been classified, but the well-being of only a fraction has been assessed. The resources are simply not available. The IUCN reports that 5714 plants are threatened, for example, but admits that only 4 per cent of known plants has been assessed. And, of course, there are thousands of species that we have yet to discover. Many of these could also be facing extinction.

C It is important to develop a picture of the diversity of life on Earth now so that comparisons can be made in the future and trends identified. But it isn't necessary to observe every single type of organism in an area to get a snapshot of the health of the ecosystem. In many habitats, there are species that are particularly susceptible to shifting conditions, and these can be used as indicator species.

D In the media, it is usually large, charismatic animals such as pandas, elephants, tigers and whales that get all the attention when a loss of biodiversity is discussed. However, animals or plants far lower down the food chain are often the ones vital for preserving habitats – in the process saving the skins of those more glamorous species. These are known as keystone species.

E By studying the complex feeding relationships within habitats, species can be identified that have a particularly important impact on the environment. For example, the members of the fig family are the staple food for hundreds of different species in many different countries, so important that scientists sometimes call figs "jungle burgers". A whole range of animals, from tiny insects to birds and large mammals, feed on everything from the tree's bark and leaves to its flowers and fruits. Many fig species have very specific pollinators. There are several dozen species of the fig tree in Costa Rica, and a different type of wasp has evolved to pollinate each one. Chris Lyle of the Natural History Museum

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in London – who is also involved in the Global Taxonomy Initiative of the Convention on Biological Diversity – points out that if fig trees are affected by global warming, pollution, disease or any other catastrophe, the loss of biodiversity will be enormous.

F Similarly, sea otters play a major role in the survival of giant kelp forests along the coasts of California and Alaska. These "marine rainforests" provide a home for a wide range of other species. The kelp itself is the main food of purple and red sea urchins and in turn, the urchins are eaten by predators, particularly sea otters. They detach an urchin from the seabed then float to the surface and lie on their backs with the urchin shell on their tummy, smashing it open with a stone before eating the contents. Urchins that are not eaten tend to spend their time in rock crevices to avoid the predators. This allows the kelp to grow – and it can grow many centimetres in a day. As the forests form, bits of kelp break off and fall to the bottom to provide food for the urchins in their crevices. The sea otters thrive hunting for sea urchins in the kelp, and many other fish and invertebrates live among the fronds. The problems start when the sea otter population declines. As large predators they are vulnerable – their numbers are relatively small to disease or human hunters can wipe them out. The result is that the sea urchin population grows unchecked and they roam the seafloor eating young kelp fronds. This tends to keep the kelp very short and stops forests developing, which has a huge impact on biodiversity.

G Conversely, keystone species can also make dangerous alien species: they can wreak havoc if they end up in the wrong ecosystem. The cactus moth, whose caterpillar is a voracious eater of prickly pear was introduced to Australia to control the rampant cacti. It was so successful that someone thought it would be a good idea to introduce it to Caribbean islands that had the same problem. It solved the cactus menace, but unfortunately, some of the moths have now reached the US mainland – borne on winds and in tourists' luggage – where they are devastating the native cactus populations of Florida.

H Organisations like the Convention on Biological Diversity work with groups such as the UN and with governments and scientists to raise awareness and fund research. A number of major international meetings – including the World Summit on Sustainable Development in Johannesburg this year – have set targets for governments around the world to slow the loss of biodiversity. And the CITES meeting in Santiago last month added several more names to its list of endangered species for which trade is controlled. Of course, these agreements will prove of limited value if some countries refuse to implement them.

I There is cause for optimism, however. There seems to be a growing understanding of the need for sustainable agriculture and sustainable tourism to conserve biodiversity. Problems such as illegal logging are being tackled through sustainable forestry

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programmes, with the emphasis on minimising the use of rainforest hardwoods in the developed world and on rigorous replanting of whatever trees are harvested. CITES is playing its part by controlling trade in wood from endangered tree species. In the same way, sustainable farming techniques that minimise environmental damage and avoid monoculture.

J Action at a national level often means investing in public education and awareness. Getting people like you and me involved can be very effective. Australia and many European countries are becoming increasingly efficient at recycling much of their domestic waste, for example, preserving natural resources and reducing the use of fossil fuels. This, in turn, has a direct effect on biodiversity by minimising pollution, and an indirect effect by reducing the number of greenhouse gases emitted from incinerators and landfill sites. Preserving ecosystems intact for future generations to enjoy is obviously important, but biodiversity is not some kind of optional extra. Variety may be "the spice of life", but biological variety is also our life-support system.

Questions 14–20

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 2?

TRUE *if the statement is true* • **FALSE** *if the statement is false* • **NOT GIVEN** *if the information is not given*

14 The term "biodiversity" consists of living creatures and the environment that they live in.

15 There are species that have not been researched because it's unnecessary to study all creatures.

16 It is not necessary to investigate all creatures in a certain place.

17 The press more often than not focuses on animals well-known.

18 There is a successful case that cactus moth plays a positive role in the US.

19 Usage of hardwoods is forbidden in some European countries.

20 Agriculture experts advise farmers to plant single crops in the field in terms of sustainable farming.

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Questions 21–26

Complete the following summary using **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from Reading Passage 2 for each answer.*

Because of the ignorance brought by media, people tend to neglect significant creatures called (21) _____ species. Every creature has diet connections with others, such as (22) _____, which provide a majority of foods for other species. In some states of America, the decline in a number of sea otters leads to the boom of (23) _____. An impressing case is that imported (24) _____ successfully tackles the plant cacti in (25) _____. However, the operation is needed for the government to increase its financial support in (26) _____.

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Reading Passage 3

Nature Works Polylactic Acid

A A dozen years ago, scientists at Cargill got the idea of converting lactic acid made from corn into plastic while examining possible new uses for materials produced from corn wet milling processes. In the past, several efforts had been made to develop plastics from lactic acid, but with limited success. Achieving this technological breakthrough didn't come easily, but in time the efforts did succeed. A fermentation and distillation process using corn was designed to create a polymer suitable for a broad variety of applications.

B As an agricultural based firm, Cargill had taken this product as far as it could by 1997. The company needed a partner with access to plastics markets and polymerization capabilities, and began discussions with The Dow Chemical Company. The next step was the formation of the joint venture that created Cargill Dow LLC. Cargill Dow's product is the world's first commercially available plastic made from annually renewable resources such as corn: NatureWorks™ PLA is a family of packaging polymers (carbon-based molecules) made from non-petroleum based resources. Ingeo is a family of polymers for fibers made in a similar manner.

C By applying their unique technology to the processing of natural plant sugars, Cargill Dow has created a more environmentally friendly material that reaches the consumer in clothes, cups, packaging and other products. While Cargill Dow is a stand-alone business, it continues to leverage the agricultural processing, manufacturing and polymer expertise of the two parent companies in order to bring the best possible products to market.

D The basic raw materials for PLA are carbon dioxide and water. Growing plants, like corn, take these building blocks from the atmosphere and the soil. They are combined in the plant to make carbohydrates (sucrose and starch) through a process driven by photosynthesis. The process for making NatureWorks PLA begins when a renewable resource such as corn is milled, separating starch from the raw material. Unrefined dextrose, in turn, is processed from the starch.

E Cargill Dow turns the unrefined dextrose into lactic acid using a fermentation process similar to that used by beer and wine producers. This is the same lactic acid that is used as a food additive and is found in muscle tissue in the human body. Through a special condensation process, a lactide is formed. This lactide is purified through vacuum distillation and becomes a polymer (the base for NatureWorks PLA) that is ready for use through a solvent-free melt process. Development of this new technology allows the company to "harvest" the carbon that living plants remove from the air through

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photosynthesis. Carbon is stored in plant starches, which can be broken down into natural plant sugars. The carbon and other elements in these natural sugars are then used to make NatureWorks PLA.

F NatureWorks PLA fits all disposal systems and is fully compostable in commercial composting facilities. With the proper infrastructure, products made from this polymer can be recycled back to a monomer and re-used as a polymer. Thus, at the end of its life cycle, a product made from NatureWorks PLA can be broken down into its simplest parts so that no sign of it remains.

G PLA is now actively competing with traditional materials in packaging and fiber applications throughout the world; based on the technology's success and promise, Cargill Dow is quickly becoming a premier player in the polymers market. This new polymer now competes head-on with petroleum-based materials like polyester. A wide range of products that vary in molecular weight and crystallinity can be produced, and the blend of physical properties of PLA makes it suited for a broad range of fiber and packaging applications. Fiber and non-woven applications include clothing, fiberfill, blankets and wipes. Packaging applications include packaging films and food and beverage containers.

H As NatureWorks PLA polymers are more oil- and grease-resistant and provide a better flavor and aroma barrier than existing petroleum-based polymers, grocery retailers are increasingly using this packaging for their fresh foods. As companies begin to explore this family of polymers, more potential applications are being identified. For example, PLA possess two properties that are particularly useful for drape fabrics and window furnishings. Their resistance to ultraviolet light is particularly appealing as this reduces the amount of fading in such fabrics, and their refractive index is low, which means fabrics constructed from these polymers can be made with deep colors without requiring large amounts of dye. In addition, sportswear makers have been drawn to the product as it has an inherent ability to take moisture away from the skin and when blended with cotton and wool, the result is garments that are lighter and better at absorbing moisture.

I PLA combines inexpensive large-scale fermentation with chemical processing to produce a value-added polymer product that improves the environment as well. The source material for PLA is a natural sugar found in plants such as corn and using such renewable feedstock presents several environmental benefits. As an alternative to traditional petroleum-based polymers, the production of PLA uses 20%-50% less fossil fuel and releases a lower amount of greenhouse gasses than comparable petroleum-based plastic; carbon dioxide in the atmosphere is removed when the feedstock is grown and is returned to the earth when the polymer is degraded. Because the company is using raw materials that can be regenerated year after year, it is both cost-competitive and environmentally responsible.

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Questions 27–30

Match each statement with the correct option, **A–F**.

A make things like clothes
B produce plastic from plant
C selling plastic in market
D fermentation process
E drape fabrics
F wrapping products

Q	Statement	Answer
27	scientists manage to	
28	Cargill needs to have contacts with	
29	NatureWorks is used for	
30	Ingeo is used to	

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Questions 31–34

Complete the diagram using **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from Reading Passage 3.*

Process: Polylactic Acid

Milling → Corn

↓

(31) _____

↓

unrefined dextrose

↓

(32) _____ → Lactic acid

↓

(33) _____ → Lactide

↓

Vacuum distillation → get (34) _____

↓

Solvent-free melting → NatureWorks PLA

Questions 35–36

Choose the correct letter, **A, B, C** *or* **D**.

(35) Why did they choose PLA as material for food packaging?

A It smells good

B It can save food freshness

C It can be used on other materials

D Some other things need to be revised about it.

(36) What is PLA packaging used for?

A absorbing moisture

B composting facilities

C Packaging fresh food

D manufacturing

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Questions 37–38

Which **TWO** *features of PLA are correct for clothing/fabric use?*

A It takes in moisture of skin
B It is waterproof
C comfortable sportswear
D It's fading under the sun
E It is only made in deep color

37 First correct letter

38 Second correct letter

Questions 39–40

Which **TWO** *features of PLA are correct for environmental benefits?*

A It is made of renewable raw materials
B It involves the removal of carbon dioxide
C It is no use of fossil fuel product
D It uses renewable raw resources
E It is sustenance which can absorb the CO_2 in the atmosphere

39 First correct letter

40 Second correct letter

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 7

Volume 1 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Leatherback Turtles

A Leatherback turtles follow the general sea turtle body plan of having a large, flattened, round body with two pairs of very large flippers and a short tail. Like other sea turtles, the leatherback's flattened forelimbs are adapted for swimming in the open ocean. Claws are absent from both pairs of flippers. The Leatherback's flippers are the largest in proportion to its body among extant sea turtles. Leatherback's front flippers can grow up to 2.7 meters (9 ft) in large specimens, the largest flippers (even in comparison to its body) of any sea turtle. As the last surviving member of its family, the leatherback turtle has several distinguishing characteristics that differentiate it from other sea turtles. Its most notable feature is that it lacks the bony carapace of the other extant sea turtles.

B During the past month, four turtles have washed up along Irish coasts from Wexford to Kerry. These turtles are more typical of warmer waters and only occur in Irish waters when they stray off course. It is likely that they may have originated from Florida, America. Two specimens have been taken to Coastal and Marine Resources Centre (stored at the National Maritime College), University College Cork, where a necropsy (post mortem for animals) will be conducted to establish their age, sex and their exact origin. During this same period, two leatherback turtles were found in Scotland, and a rare Kemp's Ridley turtle was found in Wales, thus making it an exceptional month for stranded turtles in Ireland and the UK.

C Actually, there has been extensive research conducted regarding the sea turtles' abilities to return to their nesting regions and sometimes exact locations from hundreds of miles away. In the water, their path is greatly affected by powerful currents. Despite their limited vision, and lack of landmarks in the open water, turtles are able to retrace their migratory paths. Some explanations of this phenomenon have found that sea turtles can detect the angle and intensity of the earth's magnetic fields.

D However, Loggerhead turtles are not normally found in Irish waters, because water temperatures here are far too cold for their survival. Instead, adult loggerheads prefer the warmer waters of the Mediterranean, the Caribbean and North America's east coast. The four turtles that were found have probably originated from the North American population of loggerheads. However it will require genetic analysis to confirm this assumption. It is thought that after leaving their nesting beach as hatchlings (when they measure 4.5 cm in

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length), these tiny turtles enter the North Atlantic Gyre (a giant circular ocean current) that takes them from America, across to Europe (Azores area), down towards North Africa, before being transported back again to America via a different current. This remarkable round trip may take many years during which these tiny turtles grow by several centimetres a year. Loggerheads may circulate around the North Atlantic several times before they settle in the coastal waters of Florida or the Caribbean.

E These four turtles were probably on their way around the Atlantic when they strayed a bit too far north from the Gulf Stream. Once they did, their fate was sealed, as the cooler waters of the North East Atlantic are too cold for loggerheads (unlike leatherback turtles which have many anatomical and physiological adaptations to enable them to swim in our seas). Once in cool waters, the body of a loggerhead begins to shut down as they get 'cold stunned', then get hypothermia and die.

F Leatherbacks are in imminent danger of extinction. A critical factor (among others) is the harvesting of eggs from nests. Valued as a food delicacy, Leatherback eggs are falsely touted to have aphrodisiacal properties in some cultures. The leatherback, unlike the Green Sea turtle, is not often killed for its meat; however, the increase in human populations coupled with the growing black market trade has escalated their egg depletion. Other critical factors causing the leatherbacks' decline are pollution such as plastics (leatherbacks eat this debris thinking it is jellyfish); fishing practices such as longline fishing and gill nets, and development on habitat areas. Scientists have estimated that there are only about 35,000 Leatherback turtles in the world.

G We are often unable to understand the critical impact a species has on the environment-that is, until that species becomes extinct. Even if we do not know the role a creature plays in the health of the environment, past lessons have taught us enough to know that every animal and plant is one important link in the integral chain of nature. Some scientists now speculate that the Leatherback may play an important role in the recovery of diminishing fish populations. Since the Leatherback consumes its weight in jellyfish per day, it helps to keep Jellyfish populations in check. Jellyfish consume large quantities of fish larvae. The rapid decline in Leatherback populations over the last 50 years has been accompanied by a significant increase in jellyfish and a marked decrease in fish in our oceans. Saving sea turtles is an International endeavor.

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Questions 1–6

Choose the most suitable headings for paragraphs B–G from the list of headings below.

LIST OF HEADINGS

i Sea turtles are found in unusual locations
ii Unique features of the Leatherbacks
iii The Leatherback's contribution
iv Methods used for routes tracking
v Predict the migration routes
vi Remains multiplicity within the species
vii The progress of hatching
viii The fate of the lost turtles
ix How trips suppose to look like?
x Factors leading to population decline

Q	Paragraph	Answer
1	Paragraph B	
2	Paragraph C	
3	Paragraph D	
4	Paragraph E	
5	Paragraph F	
6	Paragraph G	

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Questions 7–13

Write **NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS** *for each answer.*

7 How many Leatherback turtles are there in the world?

8 What is the most noticeable difference between other sea turtles and leatherbacks?

9 What can lead leatherback turtles to die in Irish waters?

10 Where did the four turtles probably come from?

11 By which means can sea turtles retrace their migratory paths?

12 For what purpose are Green Sea turtles killed by people?

13 What kind of species will benefit from a decline in Leatherback populations?

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Reading Passage 2

Thoughtful Computing System

A "YOUR BATTERY IS NOW FULLY CHARGED," ANNOUNCED THE LAPTOP COMPUTER to its owner, Donald A. Norman, with enthusiasm—perhaps even a hint of pride?—in its synthetic voice. To be sure, distractions and multitasking are hardly new to the human condition. "A complicated life, continually interrupted by competing requests for attention, is as old as procreation," laughs Ted Selker of the Massachusetts Institute of Technology Media Lab. But increasingly, it is not just our kids pulling us three ways at once; it is also a relentless barrage of e-mail, alerts, alarms, calls, instant messages and automated notifications, none of them coordinated and all of them oblivious to whether we are busy—or even present. "It's ridiculous that my own computer can't figure out whether I'm in front of it, but a public toilet can," exclaims Roel Vertegaal of Queen's University in Ontario.

B Humanity has connected itself through roughly three billion networked telephones, computers, traffic lights—even refrigerators and picture frames—because these things make life more convenient and keep us available to those we care about. So although we could simply turn off the phones, close the e-mail program, and shut the office door when it is time for a meeting or a stretch of concentrated work, we usually don't. We just endure the consequences.

C Numerous studies have shown that when people are unexpectedly interrupted, they not only work less efficiently but also make more mistakes. "It seems to add cumulatively to a feeling of frustration," Picard reports, and that stress response makes it hard to regain focus. It isn't merely a matter of productivity and the pace of life. For pilots, drivers, soldiers and doctors, errors of inattention can be downright dangerous. "If we could just give our computers and phones some understanding of the limits of human attention and memory, it would make them seem a lot more thoughtful and courteous," says Eric Horvitz of Microsoft Research. Horvitz, Vertegaal, Selker and Picard are among a small but growing number of researchers trying to teach computers, phones, cars and other gadgets to behave less like egocentric oafs and more like considerate colleagues.

D "Attentive" computing systems have begun appearing in newer Volvos and IBM has introduced Websphere communications software with a basic busyness sense. Microsoft has been running extensive in-house tests of a much more sophisticated system since 2003. Within a few years, companies may be able to offer every office worker a software version of the personal receptionist that only corner-suite executives enjoy today. But if

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such an offer should land in your inbox, be sure to read the print before you sign. An attentive system, by definition, is one that is always watching. That considerate computer may come to know more about your work habits than you do.

E Most people aren't as busy as they think they are, which is why we can usually tolerate interruptions from our inconsiderate electronic paraphernalia. James Fogarty and Scott E. Hudson of Carnegie Mellon University recently teamed up with Jennifer Lai of IBM Research to study 10 managers, researchers and interns at work. They videotaped the subjects and periodically had them rate their "interruptibility." The amount of time the workers spent in leave-me-alone mode varied from person to person and day to day, ranging from 10 to 51 percent. On average, the subjects wanted to work without interruption about one third of the time. In studies of Microsoft employees, Horvitz has similarly found that they typically spend more than 65 percent of their day in a state of low attention.

F Today's phones and computers, which naively assume that the user is never too busy to take a call, read an email, or click "OK" on an alert box, thus are probably correct about two thirds of time. To be useful, then, considerate systems will have to be more than 65 percent accurate in sensing when their users are near their cognitive limits.

G Bestcom/Enhanced Telephony, a Microsoft prototype based on Horvitz's work, digs a little deeper into each user's computer to find clues about what they are up to. Microsoft launched an internal beta test of the system in mid-2003. By last October, Horvitz says, about 3,800 people were using the system to field their incoming phone calls.

H Horvitz himself is one of those testers, and while we talk in his office in Redmond, Wash, Bestcom silently handles one call after another. First it checks whether the caller is listed in his address book, the company directory, or its log of people he has called recently. Triangulating these sources, it tries to deduce their relationship. Family members, supervisors and people he called earlier today ring through. Others see a message on their computer that he is in a meeting and won't be available until 3 P.M. The system scans Horvitz's and the caller's calendar and offers to reschedule the call at a time that is open for both. Some callers choose that option; others leave voice mail. E-mail messages get a similar screening. When Horvitz is out of the office, Bestcom automatically offers to forward selected callers to his cellphone-unless his calendar and other evidence suggest that he is in a meeting.

I Most large companies already use computerized phone systems and standard calendar and contact management software, so tapping into those "sensors" should be straightforward. Not all employees will like the idea of having a microphone on all the time

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in their office, however, nor will everyone want to expose their datebook to some program they do not ultimately control. Moreover, some managers might be tempted to equate a "state of low attention" with "goofing off" and punish those who seem insufficiently busy.

Questions 14–19

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 2?

TRUE *if the statement is true* • **FALSE** *if the statement is false* • **NOT GIVEN** *if the information is not given in the passage*

14 According to Ted Selker, human productivity has been disturbed by office competitors frequently.

15 If people are interrupted by calls or E-mails, they usually put up with it instead of taking uncooperative action.

16 Microsoft is now investigating a software which is compatible with ordinary office units.

17 People usually have misperception about whether they are busy or not.

18 Research conducted showed concentration-time span in office takes up only average a bit over than 65%.

19 Advanced phone and computer system will install a shortcut key for people to receive information immediately.

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Questions 20–26

Answer the questions in the diagram below. Choose **ONLY ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER** *from the passage for each answer.*

Bestcom Working Process

Bestcom system made further efforts in order to find (20) _____ about what are users doing.

In the office: check the (21) _____ between caller and user, whether callers have contact information of users, such as user's family or friends. If callers are not in directory, a (22) _____ will show up on their screen, saying that user is not available at the moment. Caller can (23) _____ a suitable time for both, or they can choose to leave a (24) _____ to user.

Out of office: Bestcom provides solution to transfer your call to user's (25) _____ if there is no (26) _____ in his schedule.

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Reading Passage 3

Irish Elk

Toothed cats, mastodons, giant sloths, woolly rhinos, and many other big, shaggy mammals are widely thought to have died out around the end of the last ice age, some 10,500 years ago.

A The Irish elk is also known as the giant deer (Megaloceros giganteus). Analysis of ancient bones and teeth by scientists based in Britain and Russia show the huge herbivore survived until about 5,000 B.C.—more than three millennia later than previously believed. The research team says this suggests additional factors, besides climate change, probably hastened the giant deer's eventual extinction. The factors could include hunting or habitat destruction by humans.

B The Irish elk, so-called because its well-preserved remains are often found in lake sediments under peat bogs in Ireland, first appeared about 400,000 years ago in Europe and central Asia. Through a combination of radiocarbon dating of skeletal remains and the mapping of locations where the remains were unearthed, the team shows the Irish elk was widespread across Europe before the last "big freeze." The deer's range later contracted to the Ural Mountains, in modern-day Russia, which separate Europe from Asia.

C The giant deer made its last stand in western Siberia, some 3,000 years after the ice sheets receded, said the study's co-author, Adrian Lister, professor of palaeobiology at University College London, England. "The eastern foothills of the Urals became very densely forested about 8,000 years ago, which could have pushed them on to the plain," he said. He added that pollen analysis indicates the region then became very dry in response to further climatic change, leading to the loss of important food plants. "In combination with human pressures, this could have finally snuffed them out," Lister said.

D Hunting by humans has often been put forward as a contributory cause of extinctions of the Pleistocene mega fauna. The team, though, said their new date for the Irish elk's extinction hints at an additional human-made problem-habitat destruction. Lister said, "We haven't got just hunting 7,000 years ago-this was also about the time the first Neolithic people settled in the region. They were farmers who would have cleared the land." The presence of humans may help explain why the Irish elk was unable to tough out the latest of many climatic fluctuations-periods it had survived in the past.

E Meanwhile, Lister cast doubt on another possible explanation for the deer's demise- the male's huge antlers. Some scientists have suggested this exaggerated feature-the result of females preferring stags with the largest antlers, possibly because they advertised a male's fitness -contributed to the mammal's downfall. They say such antlers would have been a serious inconvenience in the dense forests that spread northward after the last ice age. But,

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Lister said, "That's a hard argument to make, because the deer previously survived perfectly well through wooded interglacials [warmer periods between ice ages]." Some research has suggested that a lack of sufficient high-quality forage caused the extinction of the elk. High amounts of calcium and phosphate compounds are required to form antlers, and therefore large quantities of these minerals are required for the massive structures of the Irish Elk. The males (and male deer in general) met this requirement partly from their bones, replenishing them from food plants after the antlers were grown or reclaiming the nutrients from discarded antlers (as has been observed in extant deer). Thus, in the antler growth phase, Giant Deer were suffering from a condition similar to osteoporosis. When the climate changed at the end of the last glacial period, the vegetation in the animal's habitat also changed towards species that presumably could not deliver sufficient amounts of the required minerals, at least in the western part of its range.

F The extinction of megafauna around the world was almost completed by the end of the last ice age. It is believed that megafauna initially came into existence in response to glacial conditions and became extinct with the onset of warmer climates. Tropical and subtropical areas have experienced less radical climatic change. The most dramatic of these changes was the transformation of a vast area of north Africa into the world's largest desert. Significantly, Africa escaped major faunal extinction as did tropical and sub-tropical Asia. The human exodus from Africa and our entrance into the Americas and Australia were also accompanied by climate change. Australia's climate changed from cold-dry to warm-dry. As a result, surface water became scarce. Most inland lakes became completely dry or dry in the warmer seasons. Most large, predominantly browsing animals lost their habitat and retreated to a narrow band in eastern Australia, where there was permanent water and better vegetation. Some animals may have survived until about 7000 years ago. If people have been in Australia for up to 60 000 years, then megafauna must have co-existed with humans for at least 30 000 years. Regularly hunted modern kangaroos survived not only 10 000 years of Aboriginal hunting, but also an onslaught of commercial shooters.

G The group of scientists led by A.J. Stuart focused on northern Eurasia, which he was taking as Europe, plus Siberia, essentially, where they've got the best data that animals became extinct in Europe during the Late Pleistocene. Some cold-adapted animals, go through into the last part of the cold stage, and then become extinct up there. So you've actually got two phases of extinction. Now, neither of these coincide; these are Neanderthals here being replaced by modern humans. There's no obvious coincidence between the arrival of humans or climatic change alone and these extinctions. There's a climatic change here, so there's a double effect here. Again, as animals come through to the last part of the cold stage, here there's a fundamental change in the climate, reorganization of vegetation, and the combination of the climatic change and the presence of advanced Paleolithic humans causes this wave of extinction. There's a profound difference between

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the North American data and that of Europe, which show that the extinctions in northern Eurasia, in Europe, are moderate and staggered, and in North America severe and sudden. And these things relate to the differences in the timing of human arrival. The extinctions follow from human predation, but only at times of fundamental changes in the environment.

Question 27

Which paragraph contains the following information?

Q	Statement	Answer
27	a mention of human-made habitat destruction alongside hunting	

Questions 28–32

Complete the following summary using no more than three words from the passage.

It is commonly believed that large woolly mammals became extinct about (28) _____ at the end of last ice age. Having been preserved well in Europe and central Asia, the remains of the Irish elk was initially found approximately (29) _____. Around (30) _____ they were driven to live in the plain after being restricted to the Ural Mountains. Hunting was considered as one of the important factors of Irish elk's extinction. However, another major problem could be habitat destruction that happened due to settlement of Neolithic people around, until (31) _____ the Irish elk was able to withstand climatic fluctuation. Some scientists think that the huge antlers may also have possibly contributed to the Irish elk's extinction, but this explanation was highly controversial as they lived pleasantly during the (32) _____.

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Questions 33–35

Answer the questions below. Choose **NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** *from the passage.*

33 What man-made issue besides hunting suggests that the advent of human resulted in the extinction of Irish elk?

34 What kind of physical characteristics eventually contributed to the extinction of Irish elk?

35 What kind of nutrient substance was needed in maintaining the huge size of Irish elk?

Questions 36–39

Choose the letter A–D and fill in boxes 36–39.

LIST OF CONTINENTS

A Eurasia
B Australia
C Asia
D Africa

Q	Statement	Answer
36	the continents where humans imposed little impact on large mammals extinction	
37	the continents where the climatic change was mild and fauna remains	
38	the continents where both humans and climatic change are the causes	
39	the continents where the climatic change alone caused a massive extinction	

Question 40

Choose the correct letter A, B, C or D.

40 Which statement is true according to the Stuart team's finding?

A Neanderthals rather than modern humans caused the extinction in Europe
B Paleolithic humans in Europe alone killed the big animals such as Giant deer
C climatic change was not solely responsible for the mega fauna extinction in Europe
D moderate and staggered extinction was mainly the result of fundamental climatic change

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 8

Volume 1 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

The Brief History of Tea

A The story of tea began in ancient China over 5,000 years ago. According to legend, the Emperor Shen Nung was a skilled ruler, creative scientist and patron of the arts. His far-sighted edicts required, among other things, that all drinking water be boiled as a hygienic precaution. One summer day while visiting a distant region of his realm, he and the court stopped to rest. In accordance with his ruling, the servants began to boil water for the court to drink. Dried leaves from a nearby bush fell into the boiling water, and as the leaves infused the water turned brown. As a scientist, the Emperor was intrigued by the new liquid, drank some, and found it very refreshing. And so, according to legend, tea was created.

B Tea consumption spread throughout Chinese culture, reaching into every aspect of the society: the first definitive book was written on tea, a book clearly reflecting Zen Buddhist philosophy, 1,200 years ago. The first tea seeds were brought to Japan by a returning Buddhist priest, who had seen the value of tea in enhancing meditation in China. As a result, he is known as the 'Father of Tea' in Japan. Because of this early association, tea in Japan has always been linked with Zen Buddhism. Tea received the Japanese Emperor's support almost instantly and spread rapidly from the royal court and monasteries to other sections of society.

C Tea was elevated to an art form in the Japanese tea ceremony, in which supreme importance is given to making tea in the most perfect, most polite, most graceful, most charming manner possible. Such a purity of expression prompted the creation of a particular form of architecture for tea house: duplicating the simplicity of a forest cottage. The cultural/artistic hostesses of Japan, the geishas, began to specialize in the presentation of the tea ceremony. However, as more and more people became involved in the excitement surrounding tea, the purity of the original concept was lost, and for a period the tea ceremony became corrupted, boisterous and highly embellished. Efforts were then made to return to the earlier simplicity, with the result that, in the 15th and 16th centuries, tea was viewed as the ultimate gift. Even warlords paused for tea before battles.

D While tea was at this high level of development in parts of Asia, information concerning the then unknown beverage began to filter back to Europe. Earlier traders had mentioned it, but were unclear as to whether tea should be eaten or drunk. The first European to

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personally encounter tea and write about it was Portuguese - Portugal, with her technologically advanced navy, had been successful in gaining the first right of trade with China.

E Tea finally arrived in Europe in the 16th century, brought to Holland by the country's navy, and becoming very fashionable in the Dutch capital, the Hague. This was due in part to tea being very expensive (over $100 per pound), which immediately made it the domain of the wealthy. Slowly, as the amount of tea imported increased, the price fell, and by 1675 it was available in common food shops throughout Holland.

F As the consumption of tea increased dramatically in Dutch society, doctors and university authorities in Holland argued as to its benefits or drawbacks. The public largely ignored the scholarly debate and continued to enjoy their new beverage, though the controversy lasted from 1635 to roughly 1657. Throughout this period, France and Holland led Europe in the use of tea.

G As the craze for all things oriental swept through Europe, tea became part of the way of life. Adding milk to the drink was first mentioned in 1680. Around that time, Dutch inns provided the first restaurant service of tea. Innkeepers would furnish guests with a portable tea set complete with a heating unit. The Dutchman would then prepare tea for himself and his friends outside in the inn garden. Tea remained popular in France for only about fifty years, being replaced by a preference for wine, chocolate, and exotic coffees. Tea was introduced into England in 1660 by King Charles II and his Portuguese queen, who were both confirmed tea drinkers. Tea mania swept across England as it had earlier spread throughout France and Holland. By 1708 tea importation had risen to thirteen times the 1699 level. Tea was drunk by all levels of society.

H The Russian interest in tea began as early as 1618, when the Chinese embassy in Moscow presented several chests of tea to the Emperor, Czar Alexis. Later in the century, a trade treaty between Russia and China allowed caravans to cross back and forth freely between the two countries. Still, the journey was not easy. The average caravan consisted of 200 to 300 camels, and the 18,000-kilometre trip took over 16 months to complete. Eventually, however, tea became - as it still is - one of the most popular drinks in the country.

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Questions 1–8

Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.

LIST OF HEADINGS

i Not enough tea to meet demand
ii Religious objections
iii In - and sometimes out of - fashion
iv A connection between tea and religion
v A luxury item
vi News of tea reaches another continent
vii Is tea a good or bad thing?
viii A chance discovery
ix Tea-making as a ritual
x Difficulties in importing tea

Q	Paragraph	Answer
1	Paragraph A	
2	Paragraph B	
3	Paragraph C	
4	Paragraph D	
5	Paragraph E	
6	Paragraph F	
7	Paragraph G	
8	Paragraph H	

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Questions 9–13

Look at the following statements and the list of countries below. Match each statement with the correct country, **A–G**.

LIST OF COUNTRIES

A China
B Japan
C Portugal
D Holland
E France
F England
G Russia

Q	Statement	Answer
9	Claims that tea might be harmful failed to affect its popularity.	
10	Tea lost favour to other drinks.	
11	Special buildings were constructed in which to drink tea.	
12	Animals were involved in importing tea.	
13	A ruler's specialist knowledge led to an interest in tea.	

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Reading Passage 2

New filter promises clean water for millions

A An ingenious invention is set to bring clean water to the third world, and while the science may be cutting edge, the materials are extremely down to earth. A handful of clay, yesterday's coffee grounds and some cow manure are the ingredients that could bring clean, safe drinking water to much of the third world.

B The simple new technology, developed by ANU materials scientist Mr. Tony Flynn, allows water filters to be made from commonly available materials and fired on the ground using cow manure as the source of heat, without the need for a kiln. The filters have been tested and shown to remove common pathogens (disease-producing organisms) including E-coli. Unlike other water filtering devices, the filters are simple and inexpensive to make. "They are very simple to explain and demonstrate and can be made by anyone, anywhere," says Mr. Flynn. "They don't require any western technology. All you need is terracotta clay, a compliant cow and a match."

C The production of the filters is extremely simple. Take a handful of dry, crushed clay, mix it with a handful of organic material, such as used tea leaves, coffee grounds or rice hulls, add enough water to make a stiff biscuit-like mixture and form a cylindrical pot that has one end closed, then dry it in the sun. According to Mr. Flynn, used coffee grounds have given the best results to date. Next, surround the pots with straw; put them in a mound of cow manure, light the straw and then top up the burning manure as required. In less than 60 minutes the filters are finished. The walls of the finished pot should be about as thick as an adult's index finger. The properties of cow manure are vital as the fuel can reach a temperature of 700 degrees in half an hour and will be up to 950 degrees after another 20 to 30 minutes. The manure makes a good fuel because it is very high in organic material that burns readily and quickly; the manure has to be dry and is best used exactly as found in the field, there is no need to break it up or process it any further.

D "A potter's kiln is an expensive item and could take up to four or five hours to get up to 800 degrees. It needs expensive or scarce fuel, such as gas or wood to heat it and experience to run it. With no technology, no insulation and nothing other than a pile of cow manure and a match, none of these restrictions apply," Mr. Flynn says.

E It is also helpful that, like terracotta clay and organic material, cow dung is freely available across the developing world. "A cow is a natural fuel factory. My understanding is that cow dung as a fuel would be pretty much the same wherever you would find it." Just as using manure as a fuel for domestic uses is not a new idea, the porosity of clay is something that potters have known about for years, and something that as a former

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ceramics lecturer in the ANU School of Art, Mr. Flynn is well aware of. The difference is that rather than viewing the porous nature of the material as a problem, his filters capitalize on this property - after all, not many people want a pot that won't hold water.

F Other commercial ceramic filters do exist, but, even if available, with prices starting at US$5 each, they are often outside the budgets of most people in the developing world. The filtration process is simple, but effective. The basic principle is that there are passages through the filter that are wide enough for water droplets to pass through, but too narrow for pathogens. Tests with the deadly E-coli bacterium have seen the filters remove 96.4 to 99.8 per cent of the pathogen - well within safe levels. Using only one filter it takes two hours to filter a litre of water. The use of organic material, which burns away after firing, helps produce the structure in which pathogens will become trapped. It overcomes the potential problems of finer clays that may not let water through and also means that cracks are soon halted. And like clay and cow dung, it is universally available.

G The invention was born out of a World Vision project involving the Manatuto community in East Timor. The charity wanted to help set up a small industry manufacturing water filters, but initial research found the local clay to be too fine - a problem solved by the addition of organic material. While the problems of producing a working ceramic filter in East Timor were overcome, the solution was kiln-based and particular to that community's materials and couldn't be applied elsewhere. Manure firing, with no requirement for a kiln, has made this zero technology approach available anywhere it is needed. With all the components being widely available, Mr. Flynn says there is no reason the technology couldn't be applied throughout the developing world, and with no plans to patent his idea, there will be no legal obstacles to it being adopted in any community that needs it. "Everyone has a right to clean water, these filters have the potential to enable anyone in the world to drink water safely," says Mr. Flynn.

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Questions 14–19

Complete the flow-chart below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND A NUMBER** *from the passage for each answer.*

Step-by-step guide to making Flynn's water filters

► Making the mixture for the filter from organic material (e.g. tea, coffee, rice), (14) _____ and (15) _____.

► Shape into pots and place them in a fire made from (16) _____ and (17) _____.

► Fuel the fire to reach a maximum heat of (18) _____.

► Remove the filters from the fire.

► Bake the filters in the fire for a maximum period of (19) _____.

Questions 20–23

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 2?

TRUE *if the statement agrees* • **FALSE** *if it contradicts* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information*

(20) The clay in the Manatuto project was initially unsuitable for the project's purpose.

(21) Coffee grounds produce filters that are twice as efficient as those using other organic materials.

(22) It takes half an hour for a cow-manure fire to reach 950 degrees.

(23) E-coli is the most difficult bacterium to remove from water by filtration.

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Questions 24–26

Choose the correct letter, **A, B, C** *or* **D**.

24 The Manatuto project aimed to set up a

A charitable trust.
B filtration experiment.
C water filter factory.
D community kiln.

25 To be effective, the Flynn filters must

A remove all dangerous pathogens.
B be a particular thickness.
C filter water as quickly as possible.
D be made from 100 per cent clay.

26 Flynn does not intend to patent his filter because he

A wants it to be freely available.
B has produced a very simple design.
C cannot make a profit in poor countries.
D has already given the idea to a charity.

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Reading Passage 3

The Cause of Linguistic Change

A The changes that have caused the most disagreement are those in pronunciation. We have various sources of evidence for the pronunciations of earlier times, such as the spellings, the treatment of words borrowed from other languages or borrowed by them, the descriptions of contemporary grammarians and spelling-reformers, and the modern pronunciations in all the languages and dialects concerned. From the middle of the sixteenth century, there are in England writers who attempt to describe the position of the speech-organs for the production of English phonemes, and who invent what are in effect systems of phonetic symbols. These various kinds of evidence, combined with a knowledge of the mechanisms of speech-production, can often give us a very good idea of the pronunciation of an earlier age, though absolute certainty is never possible.

B When we study the pronunciation of a language over any period of a few generations or more, we find there are always large-scale regularities in the changes: for example, over a certain period of time, just about all the long [a:] vowels in a language may change into long [e:] vowels, or all the [b] consonants in a certain position (for example at the end of a word) may change into [p] consonants. Such regular changes are often called sound laws. There are no universal sound laws (even though sound laws often reflect universal tendencies), but simply particular sound laws for one given language (or dialect) at one given period.

C It is also possible that fashion plays a part in the process of change. It certainly plays a part in the spread of change: one person imitates another, and people with the most prestige are most likely to be imitated, so that a change that takes place in one social group may be imitated (more or less accurately) by speakers in another group. When a social group goes up or down in the world, its pronunciation of Russian, which had formerly been considered desirable, became, on the contrary, an undesirable kind of accent to have, so that people tried to disguise it. Some of the changes in accepted English pronunciation in the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries have been shown to consist in the replacement of one style of pronunciation by another style already existing, and it is likely that such substitutions were a result of the great social changes of the period: the increased power and wealth of the middle classes, and their steady infiltration upwards into the ranks of the landed gentry, probably carried elements of middle-class pronunciation into upper-class speech.

D A less specific variant of the argument is that the imitation of children is imperfect: they copy their parents' speech, but never reproduce it exactly. This is true, but it is also true that such deviations from adult speech are usually corrected in later childhood. Perhaps it

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is more significant that even adults show a certain amount of random variation in their pronunciation of a given phoneme, even if the phonetic context is kept unchanged. This, however, cannot explain changes in pronunciation unless it can be shown that there is some systematic trend in the failures of imitation: if they are merely random deviations they will cancel one another out and there will be no net change in the language.

E One such force which is often invoked is the principle of ease, or minimization of effort. The change from fussy to fuzzy would be an example of assimilation, which is a very common kind of change. Assimilation is the changing of a sound under the influence of a neighbouring one. For example, the word scant was once skamt, but the /m/ has been changed to /n/ under the influence of the following /t/. Greater efficiency has hereby been achieved, because /n/ and /t/ are articulated in the same place (with the tip of the tongue against the teeth-ridge), whereas /m/ is articulated elsewhere (with the two lips). So the place of articulation of the nasal consonant has been changed to conform with that of the following plosive. A more recent example of the same kind of thing is the common pronunciation of football as football.

F Assimilation is not the only way in which we change our pronunciation in order to increase efficiency. It is very common for consonants to be lost at the end of a word: in Middle English, word-final [-n] was often lost in unstressed syllables, so that baken 'to bake' changed from ['ba:kan] to ['ba:kɜ], and later to [ba:k]. Consonant-clusters are often simplified. At one time there was a [t] in words like castle and Christmas, and an initial [k] in words like knight and know. Sometimes a whole syllable is dropped out when two successive syllables begin with the same consonant (haplology): a recent example is temporary, which in Britain is often pronounced as if it were tempory.

Questions 27–30

Complete the summary below. Choose **NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

The pronunciation of a living language undergoes changes throughout thousands of years. Large scale regular changes are usually called (27) _____. There are three reasons for these changes. Firstly, the influence of one language on another; when one person imitates another's pronunciation (the most prestigious), the imitation always partly involves the factor of (28) _____. Secondly, the imitation of children from adult language is sometimes (29) _____ and may also contribute to this change if there are insignificant deviations, though later they may be corrected. Finally, for those random variations in pronunciation, the deeper evidence lies in the (30) _____ or minimization of effort.

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Questions 31–37

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 3?

TRUE *if the statement agrees* • **FALSE** *if it contradicts* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information*

31 It is impossible for modern people to find the pronunciation of words in an earlier age.

32 The great change of language in Russian history is related to the rising status and fortune of the middle classes.

33 All children learn speech from adults while they assume that certain language is difficult to imitate exactly.

34 Pronunciation with casual inaccuracy will not exert big influence on language changes.

35 The word scant can be pronounced more easily than skamt.

36 The [g] in gnat not being pronounced will not be spelt out in the future.

37 The sound of 'temporary' cannot wholly present its spelling.

Questions 38–40

Look at the following sentences and the list of statements below. Match each statement with the correct sentence, **A–D**.

A Since the speakers can pronounce it with less effort
B Assimilation of a sound under the influence of a neighbouring one
C It is a trend for changes in pronunciation on a large scale in a given period
D Because the speaker can pronounce [n] and [t] both at the same time

Q	Statement	Answer
38	As a consequence, 'b' will be pronounced as 'p'	
39	The pronunciation of [mt] changed to [nt]	
40	The omission of 't' in the sound of Christmas	

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 9

Volume 1 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

The Tuatara of New Zealand

Tuatara are lizard-like reptiles, found only in New Zealand. They are representative of ancient life forms.

Tuatara are the only living representatives of an ancient lineage of reptiles called Sphenodontia, which is over 250 million years old. Because tuatara still look like fossils of reptiles that lived during the age of dinosaurs, they are often called living fossils. Now just two species of tuatara survive, and only in New Zealand. One is the Brothers Island tuatara which, until recent re-introductions to sanctuaries (safe places for wildlife), only survived on North Brother Island. The other species is the common tuatara, which survives on many other offshore islands. Although the tuatara species appear similar, they have genetic differences. Tuatara bones have been found in many parts of New Zealand. Where dated, they are usually a few hundred to 5,000 years old. It is not known whether these bones are from the two living species or other species that are now extinct.

Many anatomical features distinguish tuatara from other living reptiles - for example, they have a defining pattern of openings in the skull and a unique type of haemoglobin in the blood, and males have no external reproductive organ. Adults are between 30 and 75 centimetres long, and weigh between 250 and 1,200 grams. Males are larger than females, and have more developed spines in the crest along the neck, back and tail.

The male tuatara courts the female by approaching her with a proud walk. Tuatara mate in late summer, and the female usually lays 6-10 eggs the following spring, in a shallow nest at ground level. She may guard the nest for a few nights, then return to her burrow underground. The eggs incubate for about a year, so hatchlings emerge about the time that eggs are being laid the following season. Evidence indicates the gender of tuatara hatchlings is determined by both genetic and environmental factors. It is said that it is more likely for warmer eggs to produce male tuatara, and cooler eggs to produce females. The hatchlings receive no parental care and need to find their own food.

Tuatara live for a relatively long time, reaching reproductive maturity at about 15 years, and may breed for many decades. Their maximum lifespan is not known for certain, but many tuatara have reached 80 years still looking vigorous and healthy. Tuatara live in underground burrows and are more active at night, but will come out during the day to bask in the sun. Both sexes are territorial, and males aggressively defend their territory by

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posing and fighting if necessary. Teeth are their main weapons, and a bite can cause serious injury. Tuatara are carnivorous, eating invertebrates, lizards and the baby seabirds with which they often share burrows.

Tuatara were once widespread and abundant on the New Zealand mainland, but when Polynesian settlers arrived in New Zealand, in about 1250-1300 AD, they brought with them Pacific rats which killed tuatara. By the time of European settlement, in the 1840s, tuatara were almost extinct on the New Zealand mainland. Some islands provided temporary havens, but soon these too began to be invaded by rats and other mammalian predators.

Gradually tuatara became restricted to 32 nearshore islands. Many of these islands were tiny, some as small as only one hectare. A few, such as the Poor Knights Islands off the north-eastern coast of New Zealand, and some islands in Cook Strait, were never invaded by rats, and had few of the other mammals that threaten native animals. The tiny, 4 hectare North Brother Island, in Cook Strait. However, two new populations of the Brothers Island tuatara have been created on Titi Island in the Marlborough Sounds, and on Somes Island in Wellington Harbour. The common tuatara lives on islands off the north-eastern coast of New Zealand, and on some islands in Cook Strait.

Tuatara can live in remarkably dense populations. Most tuatara islands have 50-100 tuatara per square hectare – so an island of only 10 hectares may have a population of hundreds. Larger islands with many seabirds and invertebrates, which tuatara eat, may have greater densities. The largest population is on Stephens Island, where there are estimated to be as many as 2,500 per hectare in some places, and a total of at least 30,000. The total number of tuatara on all the islands is estimated to be between 50,000 and 100,000.

Legal protection was granted to tuatara and the islands they occupied in 1895, but the reptiles continued to decline. Since then, active conservation management has reversed the decline, and new populations have become established on predator-free islands. In the mid-1980s the New Zealand Wildlife Service and its successor, the Department of Conservation, developed ways to eradicate rats from islands. Rats have now gone from almost all of the tuatara islands, making them safe for many threatened native species. In addition, the collection by conservationists of eggs for incubation in captivity, breeding in captivity, and moving tuatara to rat-free islands, have increased the number of islands that are inhabited by tuatara to 37. Many new tuatara populations are planned for islands and mainland reserves that have been freed of predators.

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Questions 1–6

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

1. The two living species of tuatara look alike.
2. Many of the tuatara bones that have been found are millions of years old.
3. The tails of male tuatara are a different colour from the tails of female tuatara.
4. The female tuatara lays eggs in a burrow.
5. There are higher numbers of female hatchlings than males.
6. Once they have hatched, young tuatara have to look after themselves.

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Questions 7–13

Complete the notes below. Choose **ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER** *from the passage for each answer.*

The tuatara

LIFESPAN

- maximum lifespan unknown
- many live to at least (7) _____ years old

BEHAVIOUR

- attack other creatures with their (8) _____
- eat young (9) _____ that live in the same burrows, invertebrates and reptiles

POPULATION

- abundant until rats were introduced by (10) _____ people
- by the 1840s, hardly any tuatara found on the (11) _____
- islands off the north-eastern coast and in Cook Strait now home to the (12) _____ tuatara
- Brothers Island tuatara found on North Brother Island
- density of tuatara on Stephens Island is up to (13) _____ tuatara for every hectare

PROTECTION OF THE SPECIES

- tuatara population dropped until rats eradicated from islands
- eggs were gathered by the Department of Conservation

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Reading Passage 2

The Tasmanian Tiger

The Tasmanian tiger, or thylacine, was a carnivorous marsupial (a meat-eating mammal which carries its young in a pouch). It was given the name "tiger" because it had striped fur, and because it was ferocious. Between 24 million and 15 million years ago, many types of thylacine roamed across Australia, their powerful jaws playing a role in maintaining a balance in the ecosystems of their day. Some species were far sized, while others were barely the size of kittens.

But when a period of climate change cooled Australia about 12 million years ago, the numbers of these ancient thylacines began to decline. By about 3 million years ago, only one species was left. About 4,000 years ago, these vanished completely from Australia. Tasmania was then the last remaining place where thylacines existed. They ruled the animal life of that island unchallenged until Europeans with sheep, dogs, and a great indifference to native flora and fauna, seem to have brought about their extinction. In 1936, the last captive Tasmanian tiger died in Hobart Zoo, but no definitive evidence has been found. Despite this, there are many who keep searching.

In 1981 Dutch-born zoologist Hans Naarding was in Tasmania conducting a survey of Latham's snipe, a species of endangered bird. One night he saw an animal in the light from the searchlight mounted on his vehicle. He described it as about the size of a large dog, but with slightly sloping hindquarters and a fairly thick tail continuing straight on from its backbone. He said that it had 12 distinct stripes on its back, running down to the point where the tail began. He reported the sighting to the Director of Tasmania's National Parks. When the news broke, said Naarding, "I was besieged by television crews, including four or five from Japan, and others from the United Kingdom, Germany, New Zealand and South America." Government and private search parties combed the region, but no further sightings were made. The tiger, as always, had escaped to its lair - a place that many insist exists only in the imagination. Others disagree. There have been more than 4,000 claimed sightings of the animal since it supposedly died out, and the average number of claims reported to the authorities each year is now 150. So is it out there? Even experts differ in opinion.

Randolph Rose, Associate Professor of Zoology at the University of Tasmania, says that he dreamed of seeing a thylacine, but is now convinced that his dream will go unfulfilled. The consensus among conservationists is that any animal with a population base of less than 1,000 was headed for extinction within 60 years. Sixty years ago, he says, "there was only one thylacine that we know of, and that was in Hobart Zoo. Take it from me, the tiger is gone." But Dr David Pemberton, curator of zoology at the Tasmanian Museum states that,

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despite scientific thinking that a relatively large number of animals is required to sustain a population, the Florida panther is down to a dozen or so animals, and, while it does have some inbreeding problems, is still ticking along. After all, animals can be notoriously elusive. The strange fish known as coelacanth, with its 'proto legs', was thought to have died out with the dinosaurs 700 million years ago until a specimen was dragged to the surface in a shark net off the coast of South Africa in 1938.

Wildlife biologist Nick Mooney has the unenviable task of investigating all so-called sightings of the tiger. It was Mooney who was first consulted in late February 2005 about the authenticity of new digital photographic images of a thylacine allegedly taken by a tourist. On the face value, Mooney says, this particular account of a sighting and the photographs submitted as proof amount to one of the most convincing cases for the species' survival that he has seen. Many other sightings have been hoaxes, and many sincere seekers are victims of obsession. "It is a blind optimism that something is, rather than a something isn't," Mooney says. "If something crosses the road, it's not a case of 'I wonder what that was?' Rather, it is a case of 'That's a thylacine!'"

However, Mooney treats sightings on face value. "I never try to embarrass people," he says, "but the fact that I don't pack the car immediately after they telephone can be taken as ridicule. Obsessive characters get angry that someone in my position is not out there when they think the thylacine is there."

Hans Naarding, whose sighting of a striped animal two decades ago was the highlight of a lifetime of animal spotting, remains puzzled by the time and money people waste on tiger searches. He says resources would be better applied to saving another endangered animal, the Tasmanian devil, and helping declining migratory bird populations. Could the thylacine still be out there? "Sure," Naarding says, "I know the vast south-west wilderness of Tasmania well. They could survive... (But) if this is the case, it will not be long before they do disappear completely." Naarding believes that any discovery of surviving thylacines would be rather pointless. "How do you bring a species back from extinction?" he asks, "what could you do with it? If there are thylacines out there, they are better off right where they are."

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Questions 14–18

Complete the summary below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** *from the passage for each answer.*

The thylacine was a dog-like animal which had a (14) ———— coat and was carnivorous. It was originally spread widely throughout the mainland of (15) ————, but started to disappear from that area around (16) ———— ago because of climate change. In the end, thylacines were found only on the island of (17) ———— until the arrival of (18) ———— with their farming practices brought about a drastic reduction in thylacine numbers. The last one is thought to have died in Hobart Zoo in 1936.

Questions 19–24

Match each statement with the correct person. Write **A, B, C** *or* **D**. **NB** *You may use any letter more than once.*

LIST OF PEOPLE

A Hans Naarding
B Randolph Rose
C David Pemberton
D Nick Mooney

Q	Statement	Answer
19	There is no longer any hope of finding a surviving Tasmanian tiger.	
20	It would be preferable not to disturb any surviving Tasmanian tigers.	
21	Many who claim to have seen Tasmanian tigers are not objective witnesses.	
22	Expert estimates of numbers needed to ensure species survival may be inaccurate.	
23	There is a great deal of international interest in Tasmanian tiger stories.	
24	Some fresh evidence provided by a visitor to Tasmania seems credible.	

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Questions 25–26

Choose the correct letter, **A, B, C** *or* **D**.

25 Hans Naarding's sighting of a Tasmanian tiger resulted in

A the capture of the tiger
B an extensive follow up
C many other sightings
D the death of the tiger

26 The example of the coelacanth is used to show that

A new animal species are still evolving
B animals can possess surprising physical characteristics
C species of sea animals can be saved from extinction
D opinions regarding extinction of animal species can be mistaken

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Reading Passage 3

The Cane Toad in Australia

A The cane toad was introduced into Australia in 1935 to control sugar cane pests in Queensland. One hundred and one cane toads arrived at Edmonton in June in 1935. Breeding occurred almost immediately. The cane toad is tough and adaptable, as well as being poisonous throughout its life cycle, and has few predators in Australia.

B Cane toads are large heavily-built amphibians with dry, warty skin. They have a bony head and over their eyes are bony ridges that meet above the nose. They sit upright and move in short rapid hops. Their hind feet have leathery webbing between the toes and their front feet are unwebbed. Adult cane toads have large swellings - the parotoid glands - on each shoulder behind the eardrum. Cane toads may be grey, yellowish, olive-brown or reddish-brown, and their bellies are pale with dark mottling. Average-sized adults are ten to fifteen centimetres long. The largest female measured in Queensland was twenty-four centimetres long and weighed one point three kilograms. Male cane toads are smaller and wartier than females. During the breeding season males develop dark lumps (nuptial pads) on their first two fingers; these help them cling to a female while mating. Their mating call is a long loud purring trill. Cane toad spawn is exclusive in Australia. It is laid in long strings of transparent jelly enclosing double rows of black eggs. The spawn tangles in dense dark masses around water plants, and hangs in ropy strands if picked up.

C The natural range of cane toads extends from the southern United States to tropical South America. In 2002, cane toads occurred throughout the eastern and northern half of Queensland and have extended their range to the river catchments surrounding Kakadu National Park in the Northern Territory. In New South Wales, they occur as far south as Yamba and Port Macquarie.

D Cane toads tolerate a broad range of environmental and climatic conditions and appear to be able to adjust and survive in almost any environment system, including sea water for short periods of time. This to a large extent explains their success in their spreading in Australia. Cane toads are found in environments ranging from sand dunes and coastal heath to the margins of rainforest and mangroves. They are most abundant in open clearings in urban areas, and in grassland and woodland.

E Cane toads eat almost anything they can swallow, including pet food, carrion and household scraps, but most of their food consists of living insects. Beetles, honey bees, ants, winged termites, crickets and bugs are eaten in abundance. Marine snails, smaller toads and native frogs, small snakes, and small mammals are occasionally eaten by cane

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toads. The tadpoles of cane toads eat algae and other aquatic plants which they rasp off with five rows of tiny peg-like teeth. They also filter organic matter from the water. Large tadpoles sometimes eat cane toad eggs.

F Cane toads were introduced to Australia to eat French's Cane Beetle and the Greyback Cane Beetle. The 'whitegrub' larvae of these beetles eat the roots of sugar cane and kill or stunt the plants. The Australian Bureau of Sugar Experimental Stations imported about a hundred toads from Hawaii to the Meringa Experimental Station near Cairns. The toads bred quickly and more than three thousand were released in the sugar cane plantations of north Queensland in July 1935. At that time, some naturalists and scientists warned of the dangers of liberating cane toads in Australia. Their protests resulted in a brief moratorium on the release of toads, but releases resumed in 1936. The protestors were right. Firstly, cane toads compete for the resources of native animals, like food, which affects native populations. Secondly, cane toads don't have as many established predators as native animals and so their population grows quickly. Finally, some native animals who would normally feed on frogs try to eat toads and get poisoned.

G All stages of the cane toad's life-cycle are poisonous. No humans have died in Australia from cane toad poison, but overseas, people have died after eating toads and even soup made from boiled toad eggs. Cane toads are also poisonous to pets. In Hawaii, up to fifty dogs a year have died after having cane toads in their mouths. Signs of dogs being poisoned through ingestion include profuse salivation, twitching, vomiting, shallow breathing, and collapse of the hind limbs. Death may occur by cardiac arrest within fifteen minutes. A cane toad responds to threat by turning side-on so its parotoid glands are directed towards the attacker. The poison usually oozes out of the glands, but toads can squirt a fine spray for a short distance if they want. The poison is absorbed through mucous membranes such as eyes, mouth and nose, and in humans may cause intense pain, temporary blindness and inflammation.

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Questions 27–33

Reading Passage 3 has seven paragraphs, **A–G**. *Choose the most suitable heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.*

LIST OF HEADINGS

i Diet
ii Habitat
iii Pollution Effects
iv Danger
v Arrival In Australia
vi Food for Snakes
vii Identification
viii Captivity
ix Distribution
x Environmental Impacts

Q	Paragraph	Answer
27	Paragraph A	
28	Paragraph B	
29	Paragraph C	
30	Paragraph D	
31	Paragraph E	
32	Paragraph F	
33	Paragraph G	

Questions 34–37

Which paragraphs (A–G) offer information on the following ideas? Write the appropriate letter A–G.

34 Male cane toads grow protuberances during mating periods.

35 The cane toad's unique way of laying eggs in Australia.

36 Opposition to the introduction of cane toads in Australia.

37 The danger of eating cane toad eggs.

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Questions 38–40

Complete each of the following statements with words taken from the box below.

WORD BOX

flowers · hearing · hair · walking · leaves · roots · smelling · tadpoles · stalks · rope · seeds · sleeping

When suspended, the eggs of the cane toad resemble (38) ————————.

Cane toads were introduced into Australia in order to stop beetle young eating sugar cane (39) ————————.

The text says that dogs affected by cane toad poisoning may have problems with (40) ————————.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 10

Volume 1 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

The pesticide-free village

Around 20 years ago, a handful of families migrated from the Guntur district of Andhra Pradesh, south-east India, into Punukula, a community of around 900 people farming plots of between two and ten acres. The outsiders from Guntur brought cotton culture with them, and this attracted resident farmers by promising to bring in more hard cash than the mixed crops they were already growing to eat and sell, such as millet, mung beans, chilli and rice. But growing cotton meant using pesticides and fertilisers - until then a mystery to the mostly illiterate farmers of the community.

Local agro-chemical dealers obligingly filled the need for information and supplies. These 'middlemen' sold commercial seeds, fertilisers and insecticides on credit, and guaranteed purchase of the crop. They offered technical advice provided by the companies that supplied their products. The farmers depend on the dealers. If they wanted to grow cotton – and they did - it seemed they had no choice.

A quick 'high' of booming yields and incomes hooked growers during the early years of cotton in the region. Outlay on insecticides was fairly low because cotton pests hadn't moved in yet. Many farmers were so impressed with the chemicals that they started using them on their other crops as well. The immediate payoffs from chemically-dependent cotton agriculture both ensured and obscured the fact that the black dirt fields had gone into a freefall of environmental degradation, dragged down by a chain of cause and effect.

Soon cotton-eaters, such as bollworms and aphids, plagued the fields. Repeated spraying killed off the most susceptible pests and left the strongest to reproduce and pass on their resistance to generations of ever-hardier offspring. As the bugs grew tougher and more abundant, farmers applied a greater variety and quantity of poisons, sometimes mixing 'cocktails' of as many as ten insecticides. At the same time, cotton was gobbling up the nutrients in the soil, leaving the growers no option but to invest in chemical fertilisers.

By the time some farmers tried to break free of their chemical dependence, insecticides had already decimated the birds, wasps, beetles, and other predators that had once provided natural control of crop pests. Without their balancing presence, pests ran riot if insecticide was cut back. As outlays for fertilisers and insecticides escalated, the cost of producing cotton mounted. Eventually the expense of chemical inputs outgrew the cash value of the crop, and farmers fell further and further into debt and poverty.

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Their vicious cycle was only broken by the willingness of a prominent village elder to experiment with something different. He had been among the first villagers to grow cotton, and he would be the first to try it without chemicals, as set out by a programme in Non-Pesticide Management (NPM). This had been devised for Punukula with the help of a Non-Government Organisation called SECURE that had become aware of the hardships caused by the pesticide trap.

It involved turning to neem, a fast-growing, broad-leaved evergreen tree related to mahogany. Neem protects itself against insects by producing a multitude of natural pesticides that have evolved specifically to defeat plant-eating insects. Thus they are generally harmless to humans and other animals, including birds and insects that eat pests.

The plant is native to India and Burma, where it has been used for centuries to control pests and to promote health. To protect cotton, neem seeds are simply ground into a powder, soaked overnight in water, and sprayed onto the crop at least every 10 days. Neem cake applied to the soil kills insect pests and doubles as an organic fertiliser high in nitrogen. As neem grows locally and is easy to process, it is much less expensive than the chemical insecticides sold for profit by the dealers and their corporate suppliers.

Quick, short-term gains had once pushed Punukula into chemical-dependent agriculture. Now they found that similar immediate rewards were helping to speed change in the other direction: the harvest of the next 20 NPM farmers was as good as the harvest of farmers using insecticides, and they came out ahead because they weren't buying insecticides, instead of investing cash (in short supply) in chemicals, they invested time and labour in NPM practices.

By the end of 2000, all the farmers in Punukula village were using NPM rather than chemicals for cotton, and they began to use it on other crops as well. The status and economic opportunities of women improved - neem became a source of income for some of them, as they gathered seeds from the surrounding area to sell for NPM in other villages. The improved situation meant that families could afford to put more land under cultivation.

In 2004, the panchayat (village government) formally declared Punukula to be a pesticide-free village. And they have big plans for the future, such as water purification. The village now serves as a model for disseminating NPM to other communities, with around 2000 farmers visiting each year. What began as a few farmers desperate to find a way to farm without poisons has become a movement with the potential to pull an entire region back from ecological disaster.

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Questions 1–4

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees* • **FALSE** *if it contradicts* • **NOT GIVEN** *if no information*

1. Cotton growing was expected to raise more money than other crops.
2. Some of the local agro-chemical dealers had been farmers in the past.
3. Initially the farmers' cotton yields were low.
4. At first, the farmers failed to notice the negative effects on their fields of pesticide use.

Questions 5–10

Complete the notes below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

NON-PESTICIDE-MANAGEMENT PROGRAMME

- Developed with the aid of SECURE
- Based on use of an (5) _____ called neem
- Neem contains many (6) _____ that target plant-eating predators

NEEM

- Used as a pesticide
- (7) _____ formed by grinding seeds
- Left (8) _____ to soak in water
- Sprayed regularly
- Used as a pesticide and as a fertilizer
- Added in (9) _____ form to soil
- Contains a lot of (10) _____

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Questions 11–13

Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** *from the passage for each answer.*

11 In which year did farmers finally stop using chemicals on cotton crops in Punukula?

12 What did the women of Punukula collect to make money?

13 What project do the authorities in Punukula hope to set up in the future?

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Reading Passage 2

Skyscraper Farming

A Today's environment scientists are in no doubt that the world's resources of fertile soil are rapidly deteriorating, and that new land for agriculture is becoming ever more sparse. Intensive farming urbanisation, desertification and sea-level rises are all putting growing pressure on the planet's agricultural land and therefore on food supplies. Currently 24 per cent of the world's 11.5 billion hectares of cultivated land has already undergone human-induced soil degradation particularly through erosion, according to a recent study by the UK Government Office for Science.

B The global population is expected to exceed nine billion by 2050 - up a third from today's level and studies suggest that food production will have to go up by 70 per cent if we are to feed all of those new mouths. This means that scientists will have to develop new ways of growing crops if we are to avoid a humanitarian crisis. Indeed, UN Food and Agriculture Organization figures suggest that the number of undernourished people is already growing. And with escalating climate change, crop yields in many areas have been projected to decline.

C With this in mind, some scientists and agricultural experts are advocating an innovative alternative to traditional farming whereby skyscrapers packed with shelf-based systems for growing vegetables on each storey - known as 'vertical farms' - could hold the key to revolutionising agriculture. Columbia University professor Dickson Despommier claims that vertical farming could boost crop yields many times over. A single 20-storey vertical farm could theoretically feed 50,000 people, according to Despommier. And if the theory translates into reality as proposed, 160 skyscraper-sized vertical farms could feed the entire population of New York City, while 180 would be needed to feed London, 289 to feed Cairo and 302 to feed Kolkata.

D It's a compelling vision, and one that has already been put into practice in Asia. Albeit on a smaller scale. But there are problems, such as initial investment and operating costs that are too great, says a spokesman for Japan's Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries. Nevertheless Tokyo-based mushroom producer Hokuto Corporation is a model example of how a vertical farm can be profitable. With 28 vertical mushroom farms operating across the country, it produces some 68,000 tonnes of mushrooms annually. Vertical mushroom farms have more advantages than ground-level farms, says Hokuto's Ted Yamanoko. Yamanoko goes on to highlight the relative cost-effectiveness of his organisation's farming practices together with reduced emissions of greenhouse gases.

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E And the impact of vertical farms could extend beyond feeding established urban populations. Despommier sees them as being capable of helping centres of displaced persons - such as refugee camps - in much the same way that Mobile Army Surgical Hospital (MASH) units are deployed in emergency situations. "Developing an emergency-response system for crop production inside specially constructed modular and highly transportable greenhouses would allow for humanitarian interventions, at least for refugees that are forced out of their countries by political turmoil," he says. "If you have three or four storeys of food already growing some place, they could become mobile units that could be picked up by helicopters and dropped into the middle of a crisis zone. The food would be ready to pick and eat. It could be designed to supply people with all the nutrition they need to make it through the crisis."

F But it isn't only about increasing food production. Despommier is concerned about the harm which farming has done to the world's landscape over a relatively short time span, particularly the elimination of hardwood forests. Farming is only 12,000 years old, he points out, and we now have for the first time the chance to feed everyone on earth and still return land to its original ecological function. Natalie Jeremijenko, associate professor at New York University, agrees. "The challenge that we have now is how we can design urban agriculture systems that not only reduce food miles, but also improve the world's ecosystems," she says. By significantly reducing the amount of land required for food production, vertical farms could help to enrich biodiversity. And according to Jeremijenko, this can, in turn, help to improve the productivity of conventional farms, as the health of agricultural land is often tied to the health of the surrounding ecosystems. Furthermore, vertical farming could dramatically cut the utilisation of fossil fuels. And also reduce geopolitical tensions in countries where poor farming conditions cause conflict and malnutrition.

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Questions 14–19

Reading Passage 2 has six paragraphs, A–F. Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.

LIST OF HEADINGS

- **i** Potential production capabilities of vertical farms
- **ii** Opposition to new ideas about food production
- **iii** A successful application of vertical farming technology
- **iv** The potential to provide urgent relief
- **v** The original inspiration for vertical farming
- **vi** Various environmental benefits of vertical farming
- **vii** An increasing problem for farmers worldwide
- **viii** A return to traditional farming methods
- **ix** A rising demand for food

Q	Paragraph	Answer
14	Paragraph A	
15	Paragraph B	
16	Paragraph C	
17	Paragraph D	
18	Paragraph E	
19	Paragraph F	

Questions 20–22

Complete the sentences below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

A UK Government study found that (20) ———— is a significant factor contributing to worldwide levels of soil degradation.

Disadvantages of vertical farming projects include the expense of setting them up, as well as their high (21) ————.

(22) ———— could potentially be used to take vertical farming facilities to areas where there is a critical food shortage.

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Questions 23–26

Match each statement with the correct person. Write **A, B** *or* **C**. **NB** *You may use any letter more than once.*

LIST OF PEOPLE

A Dickson Despommier

B Ted Yamanoko

C Natalie Jeremijenko

Q	Statement	Answer
23	Vertical farming can have financial benefits.	
24	Traditional farming has had a negative effect on the natural world.	
25	Vertical farming could dramatically increase world food production.	
26	Traditional farms may benefit from wider use of vertical farming.	

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Reading Passage 3

Marketing And Mind Control

While there had been a long tradition of giving rings as a commitment to marry, the custom of giving diamond engagement rings was in large part manufactured by one of the most effective marketing campaigns in history. In the early 1900s, diamond sales were declining, posing a serious problem for the company that essentially had control over the diamond market. In 1938, this company hired an advertising agency, which proposed reshaping social attitudes toward diamonds. As well as magazines showing film stars draped in diamonds, the agency arranged for movies to incorporate diamond engagement rings into their plots. The campaign culminated with the slogan: 'A diamond is forever'. At the time, the approach was unique. Rather than pushing a brand, the objective was to promote diamonds as the symbol of everlasting love. This was achieved by exploiting the associative nature of the brain: associating neurons activated by the concept of 'love' with neurons that encoded the concept of "diamonds". By 1941, diamond sales had increased by 55%.

Advertising comes in many forms, from blatant neon signs to subtly embedded products in movies. In each case, the goal is to mould our habits, desires and opinions. Our visual system is targeted by an avalanche of information on the internet, street posters, and billboards and in movie theatres. Our auditory system submits to catchy radio jingles and telemarketers. More surreptitiously, our olfactory system is targeted by variations of vanilla and citrus perfumes aimed at enticing us to linger in a retail outlet. It is difficult to measure how effective these campaigns are, but as in the 'A diamond is forever' campaign, they can be so successful that they change the fabric of our culture. In the case of bottled water, we are swayed by advertising into paying for something that we can obtain for free. Most people cannot distinguish bottled from tap water, much less between brands of bottled water, which is why you rarely hear of a bottled water company proposing a blind taste test.

So why is marketing such an effective mind-control technique? It is interesting to consider whether other animals exhibit anything analogous to humans' susceptibility to advertising. If we provide a lab rat with two types of cereal, it will consume approximately the same amount of each. However, if we put that rat with another rat that spent its day eating just one type, when faced with a choice, our rat will now show a preference for the same type as the other rat was eating. Psychologists call this 'socially transmitted food preference'.

What many regard as the first documented examples of cultural learning in primates started with a clever monkey that lived in a colony of Japanese monkeys on the island of Koshima. She began taking her dirt-covered sweet potatoes to the river to wash them

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before eating them. Upon seeing this, a few other open-minded monkeys picked up on the idea. Potato washing then spread from monkey to monkey and, over the course of a few years, most monkeys were eating clean potatoes. Humans are clearly not the only animals to engage in imitation and social learning.

Learning by observation can be an extraordinarily valuable brain feature; this is how we learn to communicate and perform motor skills as well as deal with many everyday problems. For example, a newcomer struggling to purchase tickets and navigate the subway system in a foreign city may step back to learn from the people nearby. Humans and other primates exhibit multiple forms of imitative learning and this is called cultural transmission.

A component of advertising relies on the marketer's ability to tap into the brain's propensity for imitation. Anybody who has watched TV knows advertisements are disproportionately populated with attractive, successful looking individuals. If we are going to imitate someone, we are more inclined to imitate those who appear to be popular and appealing.

Although not all researchers are convinced by the findings, a number of studies indicate that some animals also imitate dominant members of their group. Primatologist Frans de Waal provides anecdotal evidence of preferential imitation among chimpanzees. He noted that in one particular group the dominant male was hurt and was limping as a result. Soon unlikely if a non-dominant male had been injured.

Imitation is undoubtedly an invaluable ability, but often our propensity to imitate generalises indiscriminately, leading to poor decisions. When athlete Dick Fosbury revolutionised the high jump by jumping over the bar backward in 1968, imitators obviously copied his jumping style, not his brand of sports shoes. However, today, sports people appear in advertisements asking us to buy the laptops or sports drinks that they promote. Rationally, we know these people's success did not depend on these products, so it seems our propensity to purchase products relates more to neural programs that evolved to encourage imitation of those further up the social ladder.

Today, companies engage in stealth marketing campaigns in which people are paid to frequent bars or websites to covertly promote certain products. Companies also perform studies in which they track the eye movements of people viewing displays, and carefully craft names, packages and jingles associated with their products. While we may like to believe that manipulation on a grand scale would not be possible, that's not to say that advertising is innately harmful. To the contrary, the marketing of products or ideas is essential to human culture. The point is that we should ensure our choices reflect our actual goals and desires, and we must distinguish between the dissemination of information which is for our own good, and our manipulation for the benefit of companies.

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Questions 27–31

Choose the correct letter, **A, B, C** *or* **D**.

27 According to the writer, which marketing technique attempts to make consumers stay in a shop for longer?

A playing appealing music
B emitting pleasant scents
C displaying attractive posters
D making in-store announcements

28 The writer mentions bottled water in order to show that

A consumers buy it because of the fact that it is marketed.
B people purchase it despite the fact that it has no taste.
C marketers need not do taste tests when a campaign is effective.
D tests prove that people cannot differentiate it from tap water.

29 According to the writer, socially transmitted food preference occurs when

A only dominant members of an animal group influence what others eat.
B the same types of animals naturally prefer the same types of food.
C animals are influenced by what any other animals of the same species eat.
D a food type is more desirable because an animal views that food as scarce.

30 According to the writer, how is learning by observation and imitation a useful feature of the brain?

A it helps people overcome challenges.
B positive models can influence social behaviour.
C it can give an advantage when communicating with others.
D cultural norms and relationships can be understood more easily.

31 According to the writer, how does television advertising exploit the human tendency to imitate others?

A It shows buying behaviour that marketers want to encourage in viewers.
B It features people who have a desirable image.
C It shows older people whom teenagers admire.
D It features successful people endorsing products responsible for their success.

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Questions 32–36

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

YES *if the statement agrees* • **NO** *if it contradicts* • **NOT GIVEN** *if impossible to say*

32 The diamond campaign worked by making a connection in people's minds between diamonds and luxury.

33 People are more aware of visual marketing than auditory marketing.

34 The campaign advertising diamonds had a positive influence on society.

35 There is still some uncertainty about whether animals copy the behaviour of the most powerful animals among them.

36 Consumers make a logical connection between celebrities' achievements and the products they promote.

Questions 37–40

Complete each sentence with the correct ending, **A–G**, *below.*

SENTENCE ENDINGS

A people imitated behaviour that was linked with success.

B younger animals of a certain species are more likely to imitate each other.

C an animal would imitate another that had higher status.

D imitation of popular sportspeople has occurred for many decades.

E products are marketed to potential consumers who are unaware that marketing is occurring.

F animals can develop new habits by observation.

G incentives are provided for consumers who behave in a certain way.

37 The behaviour of the monkeys on the island of Koshima showed that ____

38 Primatologist Frans de Waal found that ____

39 Dick Fosbury is mentioned in order to show that ____

40 A feature of some modern marketing campaigns is that ____

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PART TWO

Answer Keys

Complete answer keys for Tests 1–10 of Volume 1. Check your answers only after finishing each test.

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 1 (Volume 1)

Passage 1 — The development of the silk industry

1. white

QUESTION KEYWORD	emperor wore ____ silk indoors
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the emperor is believed to have worn a robe of **white** silk"

2. paper

QUESTION KEYWORD	musical instruments, fishing strings and ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"even as the world's first luxury **paper**"

3. taxes

QUESTION KEYWORD	silk was used as payment of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Farmers paid their **taxes** in grain and silk"

4. gold

QUESTION KEYWORD	silk replaced ____ as a unit of value
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"calculated... as they had previously been calculated in weight of **gold**"

5. foreign

QUESTION KEYWORD	silk used as payment in ____ trade
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"silk became a currency used in trade with **foreign** countries"

6. mummy

QUESTION KEYWORD	hair of a ____ contained silk
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"An Egyptian **mummy** with a silk thread in her hair"

7. caves

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QUESTION KEYWORD	silk objects hidden inside ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"sealed... silk paintings, silk banners and textiles in **caves** near Dunhuang"

8. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	first sight of silk created **fear**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the Roman soldiers were so **startled**... that they **fled in panic**"

9. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	**quality** of imported silk **varied widely**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	No mention of quality variation — only that demand and price were high.

10. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	emperor **first acquired** eggs **from the Chinese emperor**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"two monks... appeared... with silkworm eggs which they had **obtained secretly**" — smuggled, not gifted.

11. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	price of **high-grade** silk **fell**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"high quality silk textiles... **continued to achieve high prices** in the West" — only ordinary-grade silk was undercut.

12. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Middle East **several centuries before** Europe
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Middle East: "**Around 550 AD**"; Europe: "not until the **13th century** that Italy began silk production".

13. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	global production has **declined**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"World silk production has approximately **doubled** during the last 30 years"

Passage 2 — The discovery of a baby mammoth

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14. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	similarities, **different parts of the world**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para D: Great Lakes (North America) tusks and Wrangel Island (Siberia) tusks "suggests the **same conclusion**".

15. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	uses of mammoth **body parts**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para B: humans "used their **bones and tusks** to make weapons, tools, and even dwellings".

16. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	theory explaining **damage to her face**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para E: sediment packed in her trunk possibly "flattened surrounding soft tissue", explaining the **dent**.

17. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	how an individual **identified** the corpse
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para A: Khudi "had seen many mammoth tusks... this **persuaded** him the corpse was a baby mammoth".

18. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	**comparison** with other young corpses
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para C: Fisher and Buigues had examined infant specimens before, but "Lyuba was **another story entirely**".

19. C — Adrian Lister

QUESTION KEYWORD	died as a result of **climate change**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Lister: "We have **strong evidence** that the temperature rise played a significant part in their extinction."

20. E — Dan Fisher

QUESTION KEYWORD	**teeth analysis** important to the puzzle
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para F: dental development is "a confirmation for Fisher that **dental research is useful**" for this question.

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21. D — Alexei Tikhonov

QUESTION KEYWORD	**better condition** than any other found
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Tikhonov: Lyuba is "the **best preserved** mammoth to come down to us from the Ice Age".

22. A — Yuri Khudi

QUESTION KEYWORD	a **mistake to ignore** the discovery
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Khudi "knew he **couldn't just return home and forget** all about it".

23. E — Dan Fisher

QUESTION KEYWORD	died when should have been in **good condition**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Fisher's samples "died in the **autumn, when they should have been at their peak** after summer grazing".

24. vegetation

QUESTION KEYWORD	changed the type of ____ available
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the sharp rise in temperature... dramatically altered the **vegetation**"

25. human hunting

QUESTION KEYWORD	tusks displayed signs of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the tusks often revealed telltale evidence of **human hunting**"

26. North America

QUESTION KEYWORD	replaced by a group that came from ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"another population migrating to Siberia from **North America** would take their place"

Passage 3 — What makes a musical expert?

27. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	who IS talented is someone ____

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Talent is "identifiable... **before** a person has achieved exceptional levels of performance" — i.e. very early, matching C.

28. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	what is **unclear** about Schlaug's findings
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"not clear if it starts out larger... **or if** the acquisition of AP makes the planum increase in size" — cause vs. effect.

29. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	established by studies of **violin players**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the region... **increases in size as a result of practice**" — a change occurring after practice.

30. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	findings on **amount of practice** suggest
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Top students practiced most "**irrespective of which 'talent' group** they had been assigned to".

31. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	Ericsson's work **influenced other researchers**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	His approach is described, but no claim is made about its influence on others.

32. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	different fields have **one thing in common**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	The 10,000-hour figure "**comes up again and again**" across composers, athletes, chess players.

33. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	practice must happen **every day**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	No mention of daily regularity being required — only total hours.

34. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	**anyone** can reach world-class level

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"this does not address **why some people do not seem to get anywhere** when they practice".

35. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	expert with **fewer than 10,000 hours**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"no-one has yet found a case... accomplished in **less time**".

36. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	brain science **supports** importance of practice
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"increased practice leads to a **greater number of neural traces**, which create stronger memory representation".

37. E — tuition

QUESTION KEYWORD	received a lot of ____ from his father
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Mozart had an **expert teacher** in his father" → tuition.

38. D — eight

QUESTION KEYWORD	symphony written at the age of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Mozart did not write it until he was **eight**".

39. A — popular

QUESTION KEYWORD	was not ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"received **little acclaim** and was **not performed very often**" → not popular.

40. G — inherited

QUESTION KEYWORD	not solely the result of ____ characteristics
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"there are no genetic factors... but **inborn traits** may not be the only cause" → inherited.

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 2 (Volume 1)

Passage 1 — The Clipper Races

1. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	company **faced a lot of competition**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the British East India Company **had the monopoly** on trade... no rival could legally import"

2. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	**cargo size** was the most important consideration
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"its priority was to **minimise costs by carrying as much as possible** on each ship"

3. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	at best, took **nearly two years**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"even with favourable sailing conditions, the round trip **lasted almost two years**"

4. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	voyages considered **highly dangerous**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	No mention of danger — only that voyages were slow and monopolised.

5. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	ships **stopped being used commercially**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"many were bought by merchants or their captains, who **continued to plough the seas**"

6. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	preferred tea from **mature** leaves
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the **fresher and earlier-picked** the tea, the better the resulting drink"

7. sails

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QUESTION KEYWORD	remarkable for the number of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"masses of **sails** on tall masts"

8. storms

QUESTION KEYWORD	affected when there were ____ at sea
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"making them less powerful during **storms**"

9. Challenger

QUESTION KEYWORD	ship called ____ competed successfully
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Richard Green, built the aptly named clipper **Challenger**"

10. ports

QUESTION KEYWORD	additional Chinese trading ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"new **ports** were opened up for trade in China"

11. paperwork

QUESTION KEYWORD	failed to complete the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"sometimes not even taking time to fill out the official **paperwork**"

12. tugs

QUESTION KEYWORD	needed the help of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"they would be towed by **tugs**"

13. money

QUESTION KEYWORD	motivated by both ____ and enthusiasm
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the cargo of the winning ship could earn a premium... rewarded by the owners of the cargo" — **money**

Passage 2 — Orientation of birds

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14. visual memory

QUESTION KEYWORD	rely on their sophisticated ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para C: "such birds possess a highly developed **visual memory**"

15. migration direction

QUESTION KEYWORD	select their accustomed ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para D: "they appear to choose their normal **migration direction**"

16. destination

QUESTION KEYWORD	may miss their ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para D: "fly west of their **destination**, and so fail to arrive"

17. landmarks

QUESTION KEYWORD	have no ____ to make use of
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para E: "couldn't rely on any **landmarks** over the vast expanse of the Pacific"

18. (laysan) albatross

QUESTION KEYWORD	bird with this skill is the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para E: "a **laysan albatross** returned to its nesting area on Midway Island"

19. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	effect of **distance** on finding nests
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para C: "if the birds are transported **800 kilometres** from their nest, it is only by good fortune that they find their way back"

20. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	**methodology** for testing homing ability
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para B: "they are taken to some spot, released, and the **percentage of returns is recorded**"

21. C

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QUESTION KEYWORD	physical ability in **humans and birds**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para C: "birds' eyes have a power of resolution **two to three times greater than ours**"

22. **G**

QUESTION KEYWORD	migration **delayed** for experiments
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para G: "Schuz caught first year... storks and **released them later**, after the departure of the adult storks"

23. **C**

QUESTION KEYWORD	domestic pigeon → **remember things seen before**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para C: pigeons trained on an aerial photograph "were still able to respond... four years later" — visual memory.

24. **F**

QUESTION KEYWORD	alpine swift → **high success rate**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para F: "seven out of nine alpine swifts were recaptured at their nests" — high return rate.

25. **A**

QUESTION KEYWORD	European stork → **without previous training**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para G: young storks "headed south-west" with "no adults to guide them" — innate, untrained.

26. **D**

QUESTION KEYWORD	starling → **effect of age**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para H: "behaviour differs in the different age groups" — adults vs. juveniles behaved differently.

Passage 3 — The role of accidents in business

27. **YES**

QUESTION KEYWORD	**delay** affected the final product

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"left cooked wheat untended for more than 24 hours... the rollers created **flat flakes**" instead of the usual long sheets.

28. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	Hodgkin's work was **logical and systematic**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Hodgkin himself says his papers give an impression "which **does not at all coincide** with the actual sequence of events."

29. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	Daguerre is an **exception** to the rule
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Daguerre's accidental discovery is given as **another example** of the same accidental-innovation pattern, not an exception.

30. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	saccharin, accident during **drug research**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"unintentional result of a medical scientist's work on a **chemical treatment for gastric ulcers**"

31. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	3M **should have funded** Fry's idea
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Only describes what Fry did with the adhesive paper — no claim about what 3M should have done.

32. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	usual business environment
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"in these sorts of environments, accidents are called failures and are discouraged" — **unlikely to lead to innovation**.

33. G

QUESTION KEYWORD	Geroski and Markides's book
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"companies... skilled at innovation were usually not... skilled when it came to commercialisation" — **good at either inventing or selling**.

34. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	Microsoft

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Consolidators... take clever ideas from other firms and turn them into mass-market items. Microsoft is a prime instance of this" — **success from someone else's invention**.

35. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	origin of useful accidents
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"accidents... come from unlikely mental associations such as **memories and vague connections**"

36. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	get out of the 'cone of expectation'
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"it means **throwing together groups from diverse backgrounds**"

37. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	'counter-intuitive' thinking implies
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"'**the cost of accidents** in business, people tend to call such efforts failure'"

38. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	Empire Lager disaster shows
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Foster's failure led to Pure Blonde, "now ranked as Australia's fifth-largest beer brand" — **success from failure**.

39. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	Pure Blonde more successful because
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"there has been **almost no promotion** and its sales are generated more by word of mouth"

40. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	culture that learns from mistakes
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"convincing employees and shareholders to tolerate failure... is a **big thing to ask**" — never easy.

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 3 (Volume 1)

Passage 1 — An important language development

1. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	produced in **different shapes and sizes**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"measuring several centimetres across, although occasionally, **larger tablets or cylinders** were used"

2. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	tablets were **dry** when marked
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"writers would impress these lines into the **wet clay** with a stylus"

3. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	difficult to read because of **size**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the signs were often **almost too small to see** with the naked eye"

4. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	number of **languages adopted** cuneiform
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"used for the writing of **at least a dozen languages**"

5. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	found in some **modern alphabets**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Only a comparison is made to how the Latin alphabet is used — no claim that cuneiform signs exist in modern alphabets.

6. stones

QUESTION KEYWORD	tokens, e.g. ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"they might take small **stones** and use them as tokens"

7. cloth

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QUESTION KEYWORD	containers made of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"placed in a **cloth** container"

8. receipt

QUESTION KEYWORD	a ____ to give when selling
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"provided to a buyer as a **receipt** for a transaction"

9. envelope

QUESTION KEYWORD	container that looked like a clay ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"putting tokens in a container resembling an **envelope**... now made of clay"

10. sheep

QUESTION KEYWORD	signs looked like what they indicated, e.g. ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"an image which resembled the drawing of a **sheep**"

11. triangles

QUESTION KEYWORD	signs shaped like ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the signs took the form of **triangles**"

12. accounting

QUESTION KEYWORD	mainly used for ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"cuneiform developed primarily as a tool for **accounting**"

13. paper

QUESTION KEYWORD	copied inscriptions onto ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"made impressions of the marks on large pieces of **paper**"

Passage 2 — Children's comprehension of television advertising

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14. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	recent innovations in **TV broadcasting**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para C: "escalated with the diffusion of **cable television and satellite technologies**"

15. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	main **goods/services** advertised to children
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para D: "80% of all advertising... falls within four product categories: **toys, cereals, candies, fast-food**"

16. G

QUESTION KEYWORD	current **limitation** on advertising to children
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para G: host-selling "is thus **restricted** in the US by the Federal Communications Commission"

17. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	two techniques to **encourage watching**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para D: "**unique sound effects and rapidly moving images**" and associating the product with playfulness.

18. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	makes children believe the **opposite of truth**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para E: "'part of a balanced breakfast'... leaves many children with the **misimpression** that cereal alone is sufficient"

19. B — Kunkel et al

QUESTION KEYWORD	brand is **fun** rather than informative
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para D: "(Kunkel et al, 1992)" — playfulness/happiness strategy.

20. D — Turow

QUESTION KEYWORD	only broadcast when adults **rarely watched**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para C: "relegated to time slots unpopular with their parents... (**Turow, 1981**)"

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21. C — McNeal

QUESTION KEYWORD	children's impact on **adult purchases**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para B: "influence $190 billion in family purchases (**McNeal, 1987**)"

22. F — Liebert et al

QUESTION KEYWORD	**simple words** help understanding
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para E: "'you have to put it together' more than doubled... (**Liebert et al, 1977**)"

23. scene

QUESTION KEYWORD	mistake ad for a ____ from the programme
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para F: "explaining them as if they were a **scene** in the program itself"

24. separators

QUESTION KEYWORD	announcements called ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para G: "these '**separators**' generally do not help children"

25. host-selling

QUESTION KEYWORD	technique called ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para G: "this is known as **host-selling**"

26. funnier

QUESTION KEYWORD	ads are ____ than actual TV
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para F: "'commercials are **funnier** than TV programs'"

Passage 3 — A New Voyage Round the World

27. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	writer's point in first paragraph

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Part travelogue, part historical record... **part scientific treatise**" — doesn't fall into one category.

28. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	refers to Swift and Defoe to
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"inspired to create two of the **most famous books**" — an example of Dampier's influence.

29. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	left western Australia because
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"out of **dislike for the cold** of more southerly latitudes"

30. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	more about Dampier in 2nd paragraph
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"able to endure a never-ending plague of discomforts... survive for **five weeks without help**" — physical hardship.

31. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	info about Dampier's early life
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the boy having shown very early inclinations to '**see the world**'"

32. F — Scientific observations

QUESTION KEYWORD	originality of Dampier's ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"would not have done so well purely on the merits of Dampier's findings regarding **meteorology and natural history**"

33. E — Writer

QUESTION KEYWORD	worked on the book with a mystery ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"other evidence exists to suggest that he was **assisted by an unknown source**"

34. C — Nature

QUESTION KEYWORD	descriptions of ____ inserted, distracted reader

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"his observations about **nature** are sometimes roughly dropped into the narrative"

35. D — Editor

QUESTION KEYWORD	responsibility lies with the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"James Knapton [was] responsible, as he was in charge of **checking and revising**"

36. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	biographies from **personal contact**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Only names biographers (Wilkinson, Gill) — no mention of whether they knew Dampier personally.

37. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	skilled at **making money**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Dampier was **not blessed in the art of wealth accumulation**"

38. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	Dampier's **patience** represented
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Characterised as "aloof, arrogant, **hot-tempered** and a weak leader" — the opposite of patient.

39. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	one of the most **modern** books
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Book is called important/influential, but never described as "modern".

40. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	supervised neighbour's **plantation in Jamaica**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a neighbour offered Dampier a position **overseeing his plantation in Jamaica**, which he took up"

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 4 (Volume 1)

Passage 1 — Why good ideas fail

1. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	sell products to make life **easier for older people**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"devices and gadgets specifically designed to **assist them with the problems associated with ageing**"

2. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	market research showed **people liked** products
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"TF's market research proved to be **very positive**, showing strong consumer support"

3. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	cost **more than expected**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Only the actual cost ($40 million) is given — no expected/budgeted figure to compare it to.

4. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	coffee shops sold **own brand**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Only mentions a coffee shop was added "to help increase traffic" — nothing about branding of what it sold.

5. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	customers **liked the atmosphere**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Customers complained that the new stores felt like a **senior center**" — disliked it.

6. surface

QUESTION KEYWORD	attitudes at a ____ level
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Tibal and his executives looked only at **surface** attitudes"

7. weight loss

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QUESTION KEYWORD	help people achieve ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Alli... a drug to aid **weight loss**"

8. name

QUESTION KEYWORD	giving the product a ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"we came up with a **name** that sounds like a helpful partner"

9. container

QUESTION KEYWORD	reusable ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"make the **container** both beautiful and functional... could later be used to store diet guides"

10. behaviour

QUESTION KEYWORD	studying the ____ of consumers
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"ethnographical observation... to examine their **behaviour**"

11. focus groups

QUESTION KEYWORD	we organised ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"We conducted what are known as **focus groups**"

12. (simple) surveys

QUESTION KEYWORD	basic, e.g. doing ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"we have conducted **simple surveys** in the lobby of our building"

13. instincts

QUESTION KEYWORD	executives should follow their ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the most important signals come from an executive's own **instincts**"

Passage 2 — Keeping the water away

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14. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	**legislation** forced designers to improve water use
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para F: "**Tough new rules** for new developments mean that drains will be prevented from becoming overloaded"

15. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	**two reasons** river isolated from flood plain
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para C: "aim was **partly to improve navigation, and partly to speed floodwaters**"

16. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	natural water courses **assisted flood control**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para B: "floodwaters lost force and volume while **meandering across flood plains**"

17. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	one river, affecting **three countries**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para D: Drava River protects towns "in Austria, but as far downstream as **Slovenia and Croatia**"

18. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	destroyed a **typical feature** to control water
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para E: Dutch "broken one of their most enduring national stereotypes by allowing engineers to **punch holes in dykes**"

19. G

QUESTION KEYWORD	comment on **cost effectiveness**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para G: "may sound expensive, until we realise **how much is spent**... and how little this method achieves"

20. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	true of the new approach
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para B: "sap the water's destructive strength by **dispersing** it" — slows movement to the sea.

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21. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	true of the new approach
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para E: Dutch will "return up to a **sixth of the country** to its former waterlogged state" — loss of land.

22. Europe (central Europe)

QUESTION KEYWORD	severe floods occurred in parts of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"winter floods on the rivers of **central Europe** have been among the worst for 600 to 700 years"

23. Mississippi

QUESTION KEYWORD	Rhine and the ____ rivers
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the same thing has happened in the US on the **Mississippi** river"

24. London

QUESTION KEYWORD	flooded to protect the city of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"To help keep **London's** feet dry, the UK Environment Agency is reflooding..."

25. Soft engineers

QUESTION KEYWORD	planners called ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a new breed of '**soft engineers**' wants cities to be porous"

26. Los Angeles

QUESTION KEYWORD	proposal for part of the city of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the test case could be **Los Angeles**"

Passage 3 — Australia's Megafauna Controversy

27. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	Field/Wroe argue findings show **coexistence**

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"claim that it provides **unequivocal evidence of a long overlap** of humans and megafauna"

28. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	**smaller** megafauna survived Ice Age
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	No mention of species size affecting survival — only aridity as the general cause.

29. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	**dating** up to 1.7m is unreliable
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The **dating of these layers is accurate**" — the writers dispute the layering/deposition, not the dates themselves.

30. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	artefacts preserved well enough to **reveal function**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"some of the stones show surface features indicating their use for processing plants" and residues "suggesting they were used for **butchering animals**"

31. B — stone

QUESTION KEYWORD	large quantity of charcoal, ____, artefacts
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"more than 3 tonnes of charcoal and more than 300 tonnes of **stone**"

32. F — water

QUESTION KEYWORD	impossible if covered with ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"hard to reconcile with a site that was only available for occupation **when the lake was dry**"

33. D — cooking

QUESTION KEYWORD	structures used for ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"no cultural features such as **oven pits** have been discovered"

34. C — sand

QUESTION KEYWORD	the ____ in same levels more recent

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**sand** in the two upper levels is considerably younger than charcoal from the same levels"

35. G — fossil bones

QUESTION KEYWORD	absence of tools and ____ nearby
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a deep drill core... recovered no stone artefact or **fossil bones** whatsoever"

36. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	conclusions about the inconsistencies
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"these points suggest strongly that the **sediments have been moved about**"

37. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	impact of a **natural phenomenon**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"flood events... could have **mixed old bones with fresh deposits**" — disturbed the evidence.

38. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	speculation about people in **1876**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"lining the surface with small stones **collected from further afield**, including prehistoric quarries"

39. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	final suggestion about megafauna
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a group of 10 people killing only **one juvenile**... each year would be sufficient to bring about extinction within 1,000 years"

40. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	writers' criticism of Field and Wroe
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	The whole rebuttal centres on "a number of **inconsistencies**" in the data underlying their conclusions.

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 5 (Volume 1)

Passage 1 — Voyage of Going Beyond the Blue Line

1. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	Cook expected **same language** as other islands
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	greeted "in a familiar tongue, one he had heard on **virtually every scrap of inhabited land** he had visited"

2. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	discovered **intentionally** by researchers
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"It came to light only **by luck**. A backhoe operator, digging up topsoil..."

3. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	team **went to Efate to find** the cemetery
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	The site was found by a plantation backhoe operator, "only by luck" — not a deliberate research expedition.

4. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	2,000 miles in **less than a century**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Within the span of **a few centuries** the Lapita stretched... at least 2,000 miles eastward"

5. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	**first inhabitants** of many islands
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"discovering and colonizing scores of tropical islands **never before seen by human eyes**"

6. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	pots used for **cooking**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Pots are mentioned as funerary/identifying items (a urn holding human bones) — no cooking use stated.

7. NO

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QUESTION KEYWORD	urn was **plain**, undecorated
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"human bones enshrined inside what is **unmistakably a Lapita urn**" — recognisable by its characteristic decoration.

8. rock

QUESTION KEYWORD	the ____ did not come from that area
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the chemical makeup of the obsidian flakes... indicates that the **rock** wasn't local"

9. teeth

QUESTION KEYWORD	examinations on the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"chemical tests on the **teeth** of several skeletons"

10. descendants

QUESTION KEYWORD	nearest ____ present-day
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"to find out... who their closest **descendants** are today"

11. canoes

QUESTION KEYWORD	what did they travel in
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the Lapita had **canoes** that were capable of ocean voyages"

12. trade winds

QUESTION KEYWORD	relied on for a **fast return**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"catch a swift ride home on the **trade winds**"

13. seabirds and turtles

QUESTION KEYWORD	sea creatures indicating land
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"detect abundant leads to follow to land: **seabirds and turtles**"

Passage 2 — Multitasks

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14. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	domestic situation, **no multitasking** needed
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para B: housewife "would sit down... chat, with **no laundry or sweeping**"

15. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	why we **always multitask**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para E: "others suggest that **new technology may be the problem**... never run out of distractions"

16. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	practical solution at work
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para F: "would be more efficient if we **banned cell-phones**" in group meetings

17. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	**prefrontal cortex** size
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para C: "studied the prefrontal cortex... the size of this cortex varies between species"

18. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	longer time for **two tasks**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para D: "the tasks took **more time** than if the person focused on a single task"

19. B — Earl Miller

QUESTION KEYWORD	visual stimulants, **one at a time**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the brain neurons only lit up in singular areas one at a time, and **never simultaneously**"

20. D — Gloria Mark

QUESTION KEYWORD	**faster but not better**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"may actually save time. However... it does not mean they are **more efficient**"

21. A — Thomas Lehman

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QUESTION KEYWORD	**never really** do two things together
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"believes people **never really do multiple things simultaneously**"

22. E — Edward Hallowell

QUESTION KEYWORD	causes lie in the **environment**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"losing a lot of efficiency in the workplace due to multitasking, **outside distractions** and self-distractions"

23. E — Edward Hallowell

QUESTION KEYWORD	**minor** workplace changes help
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the changes made to the workplace **do not have to be dramatic**"

24. email voice

QUESTION KEYWORD	term for ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Lehman called this phenomenon '**email voice**'"

25. prefrontal cortex

QUESTION KEYWORD	the ____ controls multitasking
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"studied the **prefrontal cortex**, which controls the brain while a person is multitasking"

26. group meetings

QUESTION KEYWORD	not allow cellphones in ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"certain common workplace tasks, such as **group meetings**, would be more efficient if we banned cell-phones"

Passage 3 — Grimm's Fairy Tales

27. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	believed they'd achieve **fame**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Such lasting fame would have **shocked** the humble Grimms"

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28. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	forced to work **in secret**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Mentions French occupation and endangered oral tradition, but no claim of secrecy.

29. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	parents today think **unsuitable**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Even today some protective parents **shy from** the Grimms' tales because of their reputation for violence"

30. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	sold **more widely in England**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Only Germany's modest sales are quantified; English publishers' books mentioned were other authors' works, not a Grimm sales comparison.

31. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	adults' reasons **differ** from children's
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"parents keep reading because they approve of the **finger-wagging lessons**" — different appeal from children's love of adventure.

32. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	Cinderella based on **Viehmann's life**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Viehmann simply "delivered tales" including "Aschenputtel" — she told it, the story wasn't about her life.

33. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	changes in Europe (para 4)
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a great flowering of children's literature... a **newly literate audience**"

34. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	changes in **later editions**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"refining and softening their tales... cruel mothers became nasty stepmothers" — **less violent** content.

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35. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	Marie Hassenpflug's contribution
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	her stories "blended motifs from the oral tradition and from Perrault's" book, "adapted from earlier **Italian tales**"

36. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	tales are "German" because
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Love of the underdog, **rustic simplicity**, creative energy — these are Teutonic traits"

37. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	abandoned children in tales
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the coarse texture of life during medieval times... **also coloured the narratives**" — reflects real life.

38. H

QUESTION KEYWORD	writing style is universal
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"no concrete descriptions of the land, or the clothes... makes the stories **timeless and placeless**"

39. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	pursuit of happiness means
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"become in our mind the **masters and mistresses of our own destinies**"

40. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	therapeutic value means
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"children find they can **master their anxieties**" by confronting fears symbolised in the tales.

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 6 (Volume 1)

Passage 1 — History of Tea

1. tombs

QUESTION KEYWORD	containers detected in ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Containers for tea have been found in **tombs** dating from the Han Dynasty"

2. book

QUESTION KEYWORD	wrote a ____ about tea
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"wrote the first **book** entirely about tea"

3. monks

QUESTION KEYWORD	____ from Japan brought tea
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"introduced to Japan, by Japanese Buddhist **monks**"

4. dutch

QUESTION KEYWORD	carried to Europe by the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"This was done by the **Dutch**"

5. smuggling

QUESTION KEYWORD	serious crime of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"an astonishing organised crime network" for **smuggling** tea to avoid tax

6. india

QUESTION KEYWORD	planted in ____ besides China
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"increased cultivation of tea in **India**, beginning in Assam"

7. clippers

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QUESTION KEYWORD	used ____ for the race
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"using fast new **clippers** which had sleek lines"

8. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	tea popular in Britain **16th century**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Britain... had yet to become the nation of tea drinkers" — it lagged behind.

9. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	tea **more fashionable than coffee**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	No comparison is made between tea and coffee's popularity in this period.

10. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	enjoyed by **all classes**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"tea was still **too expensive** to be widespread among the working classes"

11. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	adulteration prompted **Pitt to reduce tax**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"taxation also encouraged the **adulteration** of tea... government realised enough was enough" and cut the tax.

12. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	**initial problems** planting outside China
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a few **false starts**, including the destruction by cattle of one of the earliest tea nurseries"

13. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	**fastest vessels** were American
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Only mentions competition between British and American merchants — no winner of speed is stated.

Passage 2 — Biodiversity

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14. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	creatures + **environment** they live in
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"biodiversity comprises every form of life... and the **ecosystems** of which they are a part"

15. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	not researched because **unnecessary**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The **resources are simply not available**" — not a matter of it being unnecessary.

16. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	not necessary to investigate **all** creatures
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"it isn't necessary to observe **every single type of organism** in an area"

17. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	press focuses on **well-known** animals
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"large, charismatic animals such as pandas, elephants, tigers and whales **get all the attention**"

18. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	cactus moth **positive** in the US
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	moths reaching the US mainland are "**devastating** the native cactus populations of Florida"

19. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	hardwoods **forbidden**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Only "**minimising** the use of rainforest hardwoods" is mentioned — not a ban.

20. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	advise planting **single crops**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	sustainable techniques "**avoid monoculture**" — the opposite is advised.

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21. keystone (species)

QUESTION KEYWORD	creatures called ____ species
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"These are known as **keystone species**"

22. fig (family)

QUESTION KEYWORD	diet connections, such as ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the members of the **fig family** are the staple food for hundreds of... species"

23. sea urchins

QUESTION KEYWORD	decline in otters → boom of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the **sea urchin** population grows unchecked" when otter numbers fall.

24. cactus moth

QUESTION KEYWORD	imported ____ tackles cacti
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The **cactus moth**... was introduced to Australia to control the rampant cacti"

25. australia

QUESTION KEYWORD	tackles cacti in ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"introduced to **Australia** to control the rampant cacti"

26. public education

QUESTION KEYWORD	financial support in ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Action at a national level often means investing in **public education** and awareness"

Passage 3 — NatureWorks Polylactic Acid

27. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	scientists manage to
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"converting lactic acid made from corn into **plastic**" — produce plastic from plant.

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28. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	Cargill needs contacts with
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"needed a partner with **access to plastics markets**"

29. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	NatureWorks is used for
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"NatureWorks™ PLA is a family of **packaging** polymers"

30. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	Ingeo is used to
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Ingeo is a family of polymers for **fibers**" — used to make things like clothes.

31. starch

QUESTION KEYWORD	Corn → milling → ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"milled, separating **starch** from the raw material"

32. fermentation

QUESTION KEYWORD	____ → Lactic acid
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"turns the unrefined dextrose into lactic acid using a **fermentation** process"

33. condensation

QUESTION KEYWORD	____ → Lactide
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Through a special **condensation** process, a lactide is formed"

34. polymer

QUESTION KEYWORD	Vacuum distillation → get ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"purified through vacuum distillation and becomes a **polymer**"

35. B

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QUESTION KEYWORD	chosen for food packaging because
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"provide a better flavor and aroma barrier" — helps **save food freshness**.

36. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	PLA packaging used for
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"grocery retailers are increasingly using this packaging for their **fresh foods**"

37. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	correct for clothing/fabric
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"an inherent ability to **take moisture away from the skin**"

38. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	correct for clothing/fabric
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"resistance to ultraviolet light... **reduces the amount of fading**" in drape fabrics.

39. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	correct for environmental benefits
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the source is "using such **renewable feedstock**" like corn.

40. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	correct for environmental benefits
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"carbon dioxide in the atmosphere is **removed** when the feedstock is grown"

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 7 (Volume 1)

Passage 1 — Leatherback Turtles

1. i

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph B
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"four turtles have washed up along Irish coasts... **only occur in Irish waters when they stray off course**" — unusual locations.

2. iv

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph C
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"sea turtles can detect the angle and intensity of the **earth's magnetic fields**" — a method of route tracking.

3. ix

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph D
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	describes the full **North Atlantic Gyre** loop route — what the trip looks like.

4. viii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph E
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"their fate was sealed... get '**cold stunned**', then get hypothermia and die."

5. x

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph F
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	lists egg harvesting, pollution, fishing practices, habitat loss — **factors leading to decline**.

6. iii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph G
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the Leatherback may play an important role in the recovery of diminishing **fish populations**."

7. about 35,000

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QUESTION KEYWORD	how many Leatherbacks worldwide
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Scientists have estimated that there are only **about 35,000** Leatherback turtles"

8. bony carapace

QUESTION KEYWORD	most noticeable difference
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"it lacks the **bony carapace** of the other extant sea turtles"

9. cold/cooler waters

QUESTION KEYWORD	cause of death in Irish waters
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the body... begins to shut down as they get '**cold stunned**', then get hypothermia and die"

10. Florida, America

QUESTION KEYWORD	probable origin of the four turtles
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"they may have originated from **Florida, America**"

11. (earth's) magnetic fields

QUESTION KEYWORD	means of retracing migratory paths
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"sea turtles can detect the angle and intensity of the earth's **magnetic fields**"

12. meat

QUESTION KEYWORD	why Green Sea turtles are killed
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"unlike the Green Sea turtle, is not often killed for its **meat**" — implying Green Sea turtles are.

13. jellyfish

QUESTION KEYWORD	species that benefits from Leatherback decline
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Leatherback decline "accompanied by a significant increase in **jellyfish**"

Passage 2 — Thoughtful Computing System

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14. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	Selker: productivity disturbed by **office competitors**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Selker's quote is only about competing demands for attention being age-old — no specific "office competitor" claim.

15. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	people **put up with** interruptions
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"we usually don't [turn things off]... We just **endure the consequences**"

16. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	compatible with **ordinary office units**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Most large companies already use computerized phone systems... tapping into those 'sensors' should be **straightforward**"

17. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	misperception about being busy
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Most people **aren't as busy as they think they are**"

18. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	concentration span just over 65%
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	employees "spend more than 65 percent of their day in a state of **low attention**" — the opposite of concentrated.

19. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	**shortcut key** for immediate info
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	No mention of any shortcut key feature.

20. clues

QUESTION KEYWORD	find ____ about what users are doing
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"digs a little deeper... to find **clues** about what they are up to"

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21. relationship

QUESTION KEYWORD	check the ____ between caller and user
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"tries to deduce their **relationship**"

22. message

QUESTION KEYWORD	a ____ shows on screen
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Others see a **message** on their computer that he is in a meeting"

23. reschedule

QUESTION KEYWORD	caller can ____ a suitable time
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"offers to **reschedule** the call at a time that is open for both"

24. voice mail

QUESTION KEYWORD	leave a ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"others leave **voice mail**"

25. cellphone

QUESTION KEYWORD	transfer call to user's ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"forward selected callers to his **cellphone**"

26. meeting

QUESTION KEYWORD	if there is no ____ in his schedule
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"unless his calendar and other evidence suggest that he is in a **meeting**"

Passage 3 — Irish Elk

27. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	habitat destruction alongside hunting

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para D: "an additional human-made problem-**habitat destruction**... farmers who would have cleared the land"

28. 10,500 years ago

QUESTION KEYWORD	large mammals extinct about ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"died out around the end of the last ice age, some **10,500 years ago**"

29. 400,000 years ago

QUESTION KEYWORD	Irish elk first found approx ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"first appeared about **400,000 years ago** in Europe and central Asia"

30. 8,000 years ago

QUESTION KEYWORD	driven to plain around ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"eastern foothills of the Urals became very densely forested about **8,000 years ago**, which could have pushed them on to the plain"

31. 7,000 years ago

QUESTION KEYWORD	Neolithic settlement, until ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"We haven't got just hunting **7,000 years ago**-this was also about the time the first Neolithic people settled"

32. wooded interglacials

QUESTION KEYWORD	lived pleasantly during the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the deer previously survived perfectly well through **wooded interglacials**"

33. habitat destruction

QUESTION KEYWORD	man-made issue besides hunting
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"an additional human-made problem-**habitat destruction**"

34. (huge) antlers

QUESTION KEYWORD	physical characteristic contributing to extinction

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the male's **huge antlers**... contributed to the mammal's downfall" (theory)

35. minerals (calcium and phosphate)

QUESTION KEYWORD	nutrient needed for huge size
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"High amounts of **calcium and phosphate** compounds are required to form antlers"

36. B — Australia

QUESTION KEYWORD	little human impact
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para F: kangaroos "survived not only 10,000 years of Aboriginal hunting" — long human coexistence without wipe-out.

37. D — Africa

QUESTION KEYWORD	mild climate, fauna remains
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para F: "**Africa escaped major faunal extinction**" amid less radical climate change.

38. A — Eurasia

QUESTION KEYWORD	both humans and climate change
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para G: "the combination of the **climatic change and the presence of advanced Paleolithic humans** causes this wave of extinction" in northern Eurasia.

39. C — Asia

QUESTION KEYWORD	climate change alone, tropical region
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para F groups "tropical and sub-tropical Asia" with regions defined by climatic (not human) factors.

40. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	Stuart team's finding
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para G: extinction resulted from "the combination of the climatic change **and**... Paleolithic humans" — climate was not solely responsible.

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 8 (Volume 1)

Passage 1 — The Brief History of Tea

1. viii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph A
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Emperor Shen Nung's tea discovery happens by **accident** ("dried leaves... fell into the boiling water").

2. iv

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph B
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"tea in Japan has always been linked with **Zen Buddhism**"

3. ix

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph C
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	describes the elaborate **Japanese tea ceremony** — a ritual.

4. vi

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph D
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"information concerning the... beverage began to filter back to **Europe**"

5. v

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph E
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"tea being very expensive (over $100 per pound)... the **domain of the wealthy**"

6. vii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph F
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"doctors and university authorities... argued as to its **benefits or drawbacks**"

7. iii

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QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph G
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	tea swept Europe then "**remained popular in France for only about fifty years**, being replaced" — in and out of fashion.

8. x

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph H
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the 18,000-kilometre trip took over **16 months** to complete" — a difficult import route.

9. D — Holland

QUESTION KEYWORD	harmful claims didn't affect popularity
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"public largely ignored the scholarly debate and continued to **enjoy their new beverage**"

10. E — France

QUESTION KEYWORD	tea lost favour to other drinks
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"replaced by a preference for **wine, chocolate, and exotic coffees**"

11. B — Japan

QUESTION KEYWORD	special buildings for tea
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a particular form of **architecture for tea house**"

12. G — Russia

QUESTION KEYWORD	animals involved in importing
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the average caravan consisted of **200 to 300 camels**"

13. A — China

QUESTION KEYWORD	ruler's specialist knowledge
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Emperor Shen Nung, "a skilled ruler, **creative scientist**" — intrigued by tea as a scientist.

Passage 2 — New filter promises clean water for millions

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14. clay

QUESTION KEYWORD	organic material, ____ and water
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a handful of dry, crushed **clay**, mix it with a handful of organic material"

15. water

QUESTION KEYWORD	clay, organic material and ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"add enough **water** to make a stiff biscuit-like mixture"

16. straw

QUESTION KEYWORD	fire made from ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"surround the pots with **straw**"

17. cow manure

QUESTION KEYWORD	and ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"put them in a mound of **cow manure**, light the straw"

18. 950 degrees

QUESTION KEYWORD	maximum heat of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"will be up to **950 degrees** after another 20 to 30 minutes"

19. 60 minutes

QUESTION KEYWORD	bake for a maximum of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"In less than **60 minutes** the filters are finished"

20. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Manatuto clay **initially unsuitable**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"initial research found the local clay to be **too fine**"

21. TRUE

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QUESTION KEYWORD	coffee grounds give best results
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"used coffee grounds have given the **best results to date**"

22. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	half an hour to reach **950 degrees**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"reach 700 degrees in half an hour and will be up to 950 degrees **after another 20 to 30 minutes**" — longer than half an hour total.

23. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	E-coli **most difficult** to remove
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Only E-coli removal rates are given — no comparison with other bacteria's difficulty.

24. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	Manatuto project aimed to set up a
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"wanted to help set up a small industry **manufacturing water filters**"

25. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	to be effective, filters must
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"walls of the finished pot should be about as **thick as an adult's index finger**"

26. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	doesn't patent because he
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"no plans to patent... 'Everyone has a right to **clean water**'" — wants it freely available.

Passage 3 — The Cause of Linguistic Change

27. sound laws

QUESTION KEYWORD	large-scale changes called ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Such regular changes are often called **sound laws**"

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28. fashion

QUESTION KEYWORD	imitation involves factor of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"it is also possible that **fashion** plays a part in the process of change"

29. imperfect

QUESTION KEYWORD	children's imitation is ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the imitation of children is **imperfect**: they copy... but never reproduce it exactly"

30. principle of ease

QUESTION KEYWORD	the ____ or minimization of effort
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"One such force... is the **principle of ease**, or minimization of effort"

31. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	**impossible** to find earlier pronunciation
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"can often give us a very good idea of the pronunciation of an earlier age, though **absolute certainty is never possible**" — not impossible.

32. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	change in **Russian** tied to middle classes
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	The middle-class social mobility explanation is given for changes in **English** pronunciation, not Russian.

33. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	children **assume** language is hard to imitate
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Passage says imitation is imperfect in practice — it never discusses children's own assumptions.

34. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	casual inaccuracy, **no big influence**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"if they are merely random deviations they will **cancel one another out** and there will be no net change"

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35. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	scant easier than skamt
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Greater **efficiency** has hereby been achieved" through the /m/→/n/ assimilation.

36. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	[g] in **gnat**, future spelling
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	The word "gnat" and future spelling changes are never discussed in the passage.

37. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	'temporary' sound vs spelling
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"temporary, which in Britain is often pronounced as if it were **tempory**"

38. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	'b' pronounced as 'p'
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para B: "all the [b] consonants... may change into [p] consonants" — a **large-scale sound-law trend**.

39. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	[mt] changed to [nt]
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the /m/ has been changed to /n/ under the influence of the following /t/" — **assimilation**.

40. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	omission of 't' in Christmas
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	consonant-cluster simplification, done "in order to **increase efficiency**" (less effort).

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 9 (Volume 1)

Passage 1 — The Tuatara of New Zealand

1. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	two species **look alike**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Although the tuatara species **appear similar**, they have genetic differences"

2. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	bones are **millions of years** old
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"usually a **few hundred to 5,000 years** old" — not millions.

3. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	tails **different colour**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Only crest development is compared between sexes — no mention of tail colour.

4. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	lays eggs **in a burrow**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	eggs laid "in a **shallow nest at ground level**" — she returns to the burrow only afterward.

5. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	more **female** hatchlings than male
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Only egg temperature's effect on sex is given — no overall ratio is stated.

6. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	hatchlings **look after themselves**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"hatchlings receive **no parental care** and need to find their own food"

7. 80

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QUESTION KEYWORD	live to at least ____ years
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"many tuatara have reached **80 years** still looking vigorous"

8. teeth

QUESTION KEYWORD	attack with their ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**Teeth** are their main weapons"

9. seabirds

QUESTION KEYWORD	eat young ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the baby **seabirds** with which they often share burrows"

10. polynesian

QUESTION KEYWORD	rats introduced by ____ people
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**Polynesian** settlers arrived... they brought with them Pacific rats"

11. mainland

QUESTION KEYWORD	hardly any found on the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"tuatara were almost extinct on the New Zealand **mainland**"

12. common

QUESTION KEYWORD	home to the ____ tuatara
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The **common** tuatara lives on islands off the north-eastern coast"

13. 2500

QUESTION KEYWORD	up to ____ tuatara per hectare
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Stephens Island: "as many as **2,500 per hectare** in some places"

Passage 2 — The Tasmanian Tiger

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14. striped

QUESTION KEYWORD	had a ____ coat
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"it had **striped** fur"

15. australia

QUESTION KEYWORD	spread throughout mainland of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"many types of thylacine roamed across **Australia**"

16. 12 million years

QUESTION KEYWORD	disappear from area around ____ ago
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"climate change cooled Australia about **12 million years ago**"

17. tasmania

QUESTION KEYWORD	found only on the island of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**Tasmania** was then the last remaining place where thylacines existed"

18. europeans

QUESTION KEYWORD	arrival of ____ with farming
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**Europeans** with sheep, dogs... seem to have brought about their extinction"

19. B — Randolph Rose

QUESTION KEYWORD	no longer any hope
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	""Take it from me, the **tiger is gone**.""

20. A — Hans Naarding

QUESTION KEYWORD	preferable not to disturb
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"If there are thylacines out there, they are **better off right where they are**"

21. D — Nick Mooney

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QUESTION KEYWORD	witnesses not objective
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"many sincere seekers are **victims of obsession**"

22. C — David Pemberton

QUESTION KEYWORD	expert numbers may be inaccurate
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Florida panther "down to a dozen or so animals... **is still ticking along**" despite scientific expectations.

23. A — Hans Naarding

QUESTION KEYWORD	international interest
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"besieged by television crews... **Japan... United Kingdom, Germany, New Zealand and South America**"

24. D — Nick Mooney

QUESTION KEYWORD	fresh evidence from a visitor
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"digital photographic images... allegedly taken by a tourist... one of the **most convincing cases**"

25. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	sighting resulted in
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Government and private search parties **combed the region**"

26. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	coelacanth example shows
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	thought extinct 700 million years but found alive in 1938 — **extinction opinions can be wrong**.

Passage 3 — The Cane Toad in Australia

27. v

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph A
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The cane toad was **introduced into Australia in 1935**"

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28. vii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph B
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	detailed physical description — **identification** features.

29. ix

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph C
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"natural range... occurred throughout... Queensland" — **distribution**.

30. ii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph D
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"found in environments ranging from sand dunes... to... mangroves" — **habitat**.

31. i

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph E
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Cane toads eat almost anything..." — **diet**.

32. x

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph F
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"cane toads compete for the resources of native animals" — **environmental impacts**.

33. iv

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph G
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"All stages of the cane toad's life-cycle are poisonous" — **danger**.

34. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	protuberances during mating
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para B: "males develop dark lumps (**nuptial pads**) on their first two fingers"

35. B

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QUESTION KEYWORD	unique way of laying eggs
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para B: "Cane toad spawn is **exclusive in Australia**. It is laid in long strings..."

36. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	opposition to introduction
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para F: "naturalists and scientists warned of the dangers... **protests resulted in a brief moratorium**"

37. G

QUESTION KEYWORD	danger of eating eggs
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para G: "people have died after eating toads and even **soup made from boiled toad eggs**"

38. rope

QUESTION KEYWORD	suspended eggs resemble ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"hangs in **ropy strands** if picked up"

39. roots

QUESTION KEYWORD	beetle young eating sugar cane ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"'whitegrub' larvae... eat the **roots** of sugar cane"

40. walking

QUESTION KEYWORD	dogs may have problems with ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	signs include "**collapse of the hind limbs**" — affecting walking.

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 10 (Volume 1)

Passage 1 — The pesticide-free village

1. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	cotton expected to **raise more money**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"attracted resident farmers by **promising to bring in more hard cash** than the mixed crops"

2. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	dealers had been **farmers** in the past
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	No background is given about the dealers' previous occupations.

3. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	initial yields were **low**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"A quick 'high' of **booming yields** and incomes hooked growers during the early years"

4. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	failed to **notice** negative effects
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"immediate payoffs... both **ensured and obscured** the fact that the... fields had gone into a freefall of environmental degradation"

5. evergreen tree

QUESTION KEYWORD	use of an ____ called neem
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"neem, a fast-growing, broad-leaved **evergreen tree** related to mahogany"

6. natural pesticides

QUESTION KEYWORD	contains many ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"producing a multitude of **natural pesticides** that have evolved... to defeat plant-eating insects"

7. a powder

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QUESTION KEYWORD	____ formed by grinding seeds
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"neem seeds are simply ground into **a powder**"

8. overnight

QUESTION KEYWORD	left ____ to soak
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"soaked **overnight** in water"

9. cake

QUESTION KEYWORD	added in ____ form to soil
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Neem **cake** applied to the soil kills insect pests"

10. nitrogen

QUESTION KEYWORD	contains a lot of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"an organic fertiliser high in **nitrogen**"

11. 2000

QUESTION KEYWORD	year farmers stopped using chemicals
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"By the end of **2000**, all the farmers in Punukula village were using NPM"

12. neem seeds

QUESTION KEYWORD	women collected to make money
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"they gathered **seeds** from the surrounding area to sell for NPM"

13. water purification

QUESTION KEYWORD	future project
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"big plans for the future, such as **water purification**"

Passage 2 — Skyscraper Farming

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14. vii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph A
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the world's resources of fertile soil are **rapidly deteriorating**" — a growing problem for farmers.

15. ix

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph B
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"population... expected to exceed nine billion by 2050... food production will have to go up by 70 per cent" — **rising demand**.

16. i

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph C
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"vertical farming could boost crop yields many times over" — **production capabilities**.

17. iii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph D
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Hokuto's 28 vertical mushroom farms — a **successful application**.

18. iv

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph E
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"could become mobile units... dropped into the middle of a crisis zone" — **urgent relief**.

19. vi

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph F
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	biodiversity, fossil fuels, geopolitical tensions — **environmental benefits**.

20. erosion

QUESTION KEYWORD	factor in soil degradation
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"undergone human-induced soil degradation particularly through **erosion**"

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21. operating costs

QUESTION KEYWORD	expense of setting up, high ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"initial investment and **operating costs** that are too great"

22. helicopters

QUESTION KEYWORD	take farms to shortage areas
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"could be picked up by **helicopters** and dropped into the middle of a crisis zone"

23. B — Ted Yamanoko

QUESTION KEYWORD	financial benefits
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"highlight the relative **cost-effectiveness** of his organisation's farming practices"

24. A — Dickson Despommier

QUESTION KEYWORD	traditional farming, negative effect
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"concerned about the harm which farming has done to the world's landscape... **elimination of hardwood forests**"

25. A — Dickson Despommier

QUESTION KEYWORD	dramatically increase food production
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"vertical farming could **boost crop yields many times over**"

26. C — Natalie Jeremijenko

QUESTION KEYWORD	traditional farms may benefit
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"this can, in turn, help to **improve the productivity of conventional farms**"

Passage 3 — Marketing And Mind Control

27. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	keep consumers in shop longer

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"olfactory system is targeted by variations of vanilla and citrus perfumes aimed at **enticing us to linger** in a retail outlet"

28. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	bottled water example shows
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"we are swayed by advertising into **paying for something that we can obtain for free**"

29. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	socially transmitted food preference
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	rat "will now show a preference for **the same type as the other rat** was eating" — any peer, not only dominant ones.

30. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	observation/imitation useful because
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a newcomer struggling to purchase tickets... may step back to **learn from the people nearby**"

31. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	TV ads exploit imitation by
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"advertisements are disproportionately populated with **attractive, successful looking individuals**"

32. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	connected diamonds with **luxury**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the objective was "to promote diamonds as the symbol of **everlasting love**" — not luxury.

33. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	more aware of **visual** than auditory marketing
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Both channels are described, but their relative awareness levels are never compared.

34. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	diamond campaign, **positive** for society

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	The passage describes the campaign's commercial success, never whether it was socially positive.

35. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	**uncertainty** about copying powerful animals
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**Although not all researchers are convinced** by the findings, a number of studies indicate that some animals also imitate dominant members"

36. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	**logical** connection to celebrity success
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Rationally, we know these people's success **did not depend on these products**" — not a logical connection.

37. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	Koshima monkeys showed that
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Potato washing "spread from monkey to monkey" — **new habits developed by observation**.

38. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	de Waal found that
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Non-dominant males copied the limping of the **dominant male** — imitation of higher status.

39. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	Dick Fosbury mentioned to show
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"imitators obviously copied his jumping style" — **behaviour linked with success** was imitated.

40. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	feature of modern campaigns
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"stealth marketing campaigns in which people are paid to... **covertly promote** certain products"

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